UPSC CSE Mains 2027 · GS Paper III

INTERNAL SECURITY

Agriculture · Disaster Management · Security

Handwritten-style notes

Built from the Sarrthi IAS MMP+ handouts, class slides and PYQ sets.
Bracket trees · diagrams · mnemonics · keywords · current affairs
Right column and left binding margin are kept blank for your own use.

Personal study edition · for printing

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Agriculture and Food

Part I

Cropping Patterns, Irrigation and Water-Use Efficiency

PYQ 2016, 2017, 2020 (rice-wheat), 2020/24 (irrigation), 2021 (micro-irrigation), 2023, 2025

✎ *Wheat-paddy monoculture drains soil and groundwater. Diversification, millets/pulses and micro-irrigation are the fix.*

Monoculture = only one crop on a piece of land. ***Punjab case:*** wheat and paddy cover ***84.6%*** of cropped area, crowding out pulses, maize, bajra, oilseeds, cotton.

Issues with the system

→ ***Pests and disease*** rise with repeated crops (less genetic diversity)

→ Wheat and paddy do ***not fix nitrogen*** → soil nutrient depletion, more chemical fertiliser and pesticide

→ ***Aquifer depletion:*** CGWB 2024 Punjab — 153 blocks: ***115 over-exploited, 4 critical, 12 semi-critical, 22 safe***

→ Biodiversity loss; climate stress; paddy gives ***fewer man-days***

Why cropping patterns change

→ Five factor groups: ***resource · technology · household · price · institutional/ infrastructure***

→ ***Small farms:*** food/fodder self-sufficiency, size, investment limits; ***large farms:*** relative prices; better irrigated areas more market-driven

→ Economic factors dominate with irrigation, infrastructure, rural markets, ***short-duration and drought-tolerant varieties***

Economic Survey data: agri and allied ≈ ***20%*** of national income, ***46.1%*** of workforce. FY16-25 growth: ***fishing 8.8% > livestock 7.1% > crops 3.5%. Horticulture 362.08 MT > foodgrain 329.68 MT***. Foodgrain ***3,577.3 LMT*** (AY 2024-25, +254.3 LMT). India: largest dry-onion producer (~25%), 2nd in vegetables, fruits, potatoes. ***Yields below world*** in cereals, maize, soybean, pulses (groundnut exception).

El Nino and La Nina (PYQ 2014)

→ ***El Nino:*** 15 of 27 years hurt pulses; area -2 to -9%, output -6 to -30%; 2023-24 pulse imports ***+84% to 4.739 MT***

→ ***La Nina:*** 13 of 25 years gained; 8 still lost (excess/ill-timed rain)

→ ***MP and Gujarat*** lead pulses (black soil rotations; short-duration varieties; high SRR) — NITI Aayog 2025

IRRIGATION

Why irrigation

→ Water certainty, nutrient uptake, resilience, ***diversification, multiple cropping***

Steps

→ ***PMKSY:*** coordinated farm-level investment, assured irrigation, on-farm efficiency, precision irrigation, aquifer recharge, private investment

→ ***Per Drop More Crop:*** ***55%*** aid to small/marginal, ***45%*** others

→ Gross irrigated share ***41.7% (2001-02) → 55.8% (2022-23)***

Challenges and way forward

→ Disparity: <***15%*** millets, ~***26%*** pulses, ~***67%*** rice

→ Priority: lagging states and crops; ***rejuvenate water bodies and surface storage*** (best returns); reuse treated wastewater peri-urban

PYQ hook (WUE 2016): water-use efficiency = crop per drop; micro-irrigation (drip, sprinkler) raises it by cutting evaporation and conveyance losses; link to PMKSY-PDMC and 2021 water crisis answer.

DIVERSIFICATION SUCCESS

Beed (Maharashtra) experiment: Krishikul / Global Vikas Trust — farmers moved from soybean/cotton to fruit (papaya, custard apple, sweet lime, guava, pomegranate, mulberry, banana). ***TISS 2024:*** per-acre income ~₹38,700 → ~₹3.93 lakh (10X).

Crop Diversification Programme (RKVY) promotes alternate crops and legumes to restore fertility.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Punjab wheat+paddy share?	84.6%
Per Drop More Crop aid?	55% small/marginal, 45% others
Irrigated share 2022-23?	55.8%
N:P:K recommended?	~4:2:1

Pulses, Edible Oils, NFSNM and Krishonnati

PYQ 2018 (millets), 2024 (millets), 2026 (policies)

✎ *Food security now means food + nutrition. Missions push pulses and oilseeds to cut import dependence.*

Krishonnati Yojana = umbrella of 8 schemes: ***MIDH*** · ***NFSNM*** · ***SAME*** · ***ISAM*** · ***Digital Agriculture Mission*** · ***NMEO-OS*** · ***NMEO-OP*** · ***MOVCDNER***.

NFSNM (renamed FY25 from NFSM)

→ Shift from ***calorie to food + nutrition security***; crop diversification; pulses and millets (***Shree Anna***) tackle ***hidden hunger***; climate-resilient dryland crops

Edible oils

→ Import dependence ***63.2% (2015-16) → 56.25% (2023-24)***; import 15.66 MT

→ ***NMEO-OP:*** 6.5 lakh ha by 2025-26 (NE focus); ***Viability Price*** for FFB; planting aid ₹12,000 → ₹29,000/ha

→ ***NMEO-OS:*** 600+ value-chain clusters; +40 lakh ha on rice/potato fallows; ***SATHI*** 5-year seed plan; 65 seed hubs; 432 ICAR varieties; Krishi Mapper; ***Krishi Sakhis***

→ Import duty on crude oil raised 5.5% → 16.5%; PM-AASHA procurement; ***target 70 MT by 2030-31***

Mission for Atmanirbharta in Pulses	***Interventions***
Productivity	HYV, pest-resistant, climate-resilient varieties; multi-location trials
Seed system	5-year plans; ICAR breeder seed; SATHI traceability; free seed kits
Area expansion	Rice fallows; intercropping
Procurement	Assured MSP purchase of ***tur, urad, masoor*** via NAFED/NCCF (PSS/PM-AASHA)
Value chain	Storage, grading, processing
Convergence	Soil health, mechanisation, plant protection

Target: self-sufficiency in pulses by ***Dec 2027***; ***≥20%*** of mission funds for women farmers.

PM Dhan-Dhaanya Krishi Yojana: 100 low-productivity districts; ₹24,000 cr by convergence of ***36 schemes***; modelled on Aspirational Districts; ***117 indicators*** tracked monthly; Agri universities as technical partners.

Horticulture → MIDH · ***Clean Plant Programme*** · Horticulture Cluster Development Programme

Recall drill: cover and answer

Edible oil import dependence 2023-24?	56.25%
PMDDKY outlay?	₹24,000 cr
Pulses self-sufficiency target?	Dec 2027

Inputs and Support: Seeds, Soil, Pesticides, Credit, Machines, Extension

PYQ 2014 (agri finance), 2015, 2023 (e-tech)

✎ *Productivity depends on quality seeds, balanced fertiliser, safe pesticides, credit, machines and advice.*

Seeds

→ **6.85 lakh Seed Villages** (SMSP); **National Mission on High-Yielding Seeds** (Budget 2025-26, 100+ varieties); **MGR 100 (CO 52)** rice success

→ Challenge: research needs; monoculture risk; farmers use old/saved seeds

Draft Seeds Bill 2025 replaces Seeds Act 1966: quality, curbs spurious seeds, liberalises imports, decriminalises minor offences; farmers may **grow, save, exchange, sell** farm seeds (restriction only on branded sale); minimum germination, genetic/physical purity, seed health; registration of processing units; Registrar and National Register; Central Accreditation; testing labs; inspectors under **BNSS**. Align with **PPV&FR Act 2001, CBD, ITPGRFA**.

Soil health

→ Falling organic carbon; N:P:K ratio far from **4:2:1** because **urea is cheap**

→ Tools: Soil Health Card (**25.55 crore**), NSMP, NOSUIS, nutrient-based pricing, neem-coated urea, Aadhaar-linked PoS, iFMS — all **supply-side**

→ **Economic Survey proposal:** raise urea price modestly, give per-acre income support (zone/crop indexed) via **PM-KISAN**; pilot first (tenancy issue)

Draft Pesticides Management Bill 2025 replaces Insecticides Act 1968: broad pesticide definition (incl. growth regulators, defoliants), mandatory lab accreditation, digital registration, higher penalties on spurious pesticides, **Central Pesticides Board**, promotion of biological pesticides.

Credit

→ Non-institutional credit **90% (1950) → 23.4% (2021-22)**; Lead Bank Scheme, PSL

→ **KCC + MISS:** 7% loan, **3%** prompt-repayment incentive; **Kisan Rin Portal**

→ Disparity: Central region 35.4% of PM-KISAN but 14.7% of MISS

Mechanisation

→ **SMAM**; **25,689 Custom Hiring Centres** (2014-15 to 2025-26)

→ Barriers: fragmented holdings, labour shortage; fix via FPOs, PACS, SHGs

Extension

→ **SMAE**, **ATMA**, **DAESI** (48-week dealer course; 1.07 lakh dealers), Kisan Call Centres (22 languages), KVKs as district knowledge centres; digital advisories; FPOs

Infrastructure and marketing

→ **AMI** (74,000+ projects) · **AIF** ₹1 lakh cr · **e-NAM** 1,522 mandis, 1.79 cr farmers · 10,000 FPOs · AHIDF, PMMSY, FIDF · **Digital Agriculture Mission / AgriStack**

→ Gaps: cold chains, post-harvest logistics, narrow export basket

Recall drill: cover and answer

Seeds Act replaced?	1966
KCC loan rate?	7% with 3% incentive
CHCs created?	25,689

Storage, Transport and Marketing of Agro-Produce

PYQ 2014 (APMC), 2015, 2018, 2020, 2022, 2025

✎ *Marketing reform needs private investment, e-markets, FPOs and cold chains; MSP/ procurement alone is not enough.*

Need → Crowd in private investment · price discovery · competitive buyers · value addition · cut post-harvest losses (crops, livestock, fish)

Steps → ***AMI*** credit-linked subsidy (74,000+ projects) · ***AIF*** ₹1 lakh cr · ***e-NAM*** · 10,000 FPOs · ***AHIDF, PMMSY, FIDF*** · ISRO ***Vessel Communication and Support System*** · ***AgriStack***

Challenges → Processing must grow faster to widen export basket; ***cold chain and logistics gaps***, esp. inland and remote regions

Post-harvest distress sale eased by ***Credit Guarantee Scheme for Electronic Negotiable Warehouse Receipt (e-NWR) pledge finance***.

PYQ lens: APMC reform, e-commerce in supply chain, small processing units, supermarkets and intermediaries, upstream/downstream bottlenecks, contract farming and land leasing (2015), land reforms (2016-24).

Recall drill: cover and answer

AIF size?	₹1 lakh cr
e-NAM mandis?	1,522

Economics of Animal Rearing, Fisheries and Fodder

PYQ 2013 (pink revolution), 2015

✎ *Allied sectors drive growth, but feed and fodder shortages squeeze dairy.*

Fodder gap: feed and fodder >***70%*** of milk production cost; fodder only ***4.61%*** of gross cropped area; gaps: green fodder 11–32%, dry 23%, concentrates 28–40%.

Steps

→ ***FMD control:*** ~125 crore vaccinations since 2020; digital animal ID

→ ***AI:*** 76.23 m (2017–18) → 88.32 m (2024–25); 126 districts at 50% coverage

→ ***PM-MKSSY*** fisheries; ***Nucleus Breeding Centres*** (shrimp); ***28 lakh*** on National Fisheries Digital Platform; PMMSY, FIDF, AHIDF

Way forward

→ Feed-fodder security; better aquaculture genetics; formalise fisheries; aquatic health, biosecurity, quality standards

Recall drill: cover and answer

Fodder share of cost?	>70% of milk cost
AI inseminations 2024–25?	88.32 m

MSP, Crop Insurance, Procurement and Food Management

PYQ 2013, 2015, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2026

✎ *MSP helps mostly wheat and paddy; insurance suffers claim and trust gaps; procurement is skewed. Reform: diversify support and move to income and market development.*

BEFORE PRODUCTION: PRICE

MSP: 22 mandated crops; since Budget 2018-19 at least **50% over weighted average cost** (A2+FL). Wheat MSP ₹2,585/qtl ≈ **109%** above A2+FL. **PM-KISAN:** ₹4.09 lakh cr over 21 instalments; **PM-Kisan Maandhan** 24.92 lakh enrolled (Dec 2025).

Problems

→ Cost data lag 2-3 years (input shocks, e.g. Hormuz 2026)
→ Wheat gets stronger support than other rabi crops
→ **MSP works only where procurement works** (wheat, paddy); weak for pulses, oilseeds, millets

Measures

→ Update cost data (index fuel, fertiliser, labour) · align MSP with diversification · income support (PM-KISAN, per-hectare) · link price to procurement, offtake, processing

DURING PRODUCTION: PMFBY

PMFBY: 4.19 crore farmers insured (2024-25, +32% over 2022-23); 86 crore applications; **₹1.90 lakh cr** claims since 2016-17. Tools: **DigiClaim, NCIP, YES-TECH, WINDS**. From Kharif 2025 States must open **escrow** for premium share; from Kharif 2024 delayed claims attract **12% penalty**.

Problems

→ Farm-level loss missed (Palghar farmer ₹2.30) · trust deficit · **voluntary enrolment → adverse selection** · fiscal stress (Bihar, Jharkhand, WB opted out) · tenants excluded

Measures

→ Farmer-sensitive tech + local verification · timely settlement · link insurer pay to claim performance · **parametric insurance** · keep insurance as real risk cover

AFTER PRODUCTION: PROCUREMENT

Problems

→ High buffer stock and carrying cost; public money locked; imports of edible oil (56%) and pulses persist; **rice-wheat bias**

Measures

→ Crop-shift incentives (per-acre/quintal) starting in eastern and central India · link with national priorities (maize, oilseeds for ethanol/feed) · Centre-State partnership · **price-deficiency payments**, bonuses, assured offtake · phased, flexible buffer norms

FOOD MANAGEMENT (PDS)

Problem	Measure
Basic security	**NFSA 2013**: ~67% of population
Crisis	**PMGKAY** free grain (Centre funded)
Migrants	**ONORC**: all 36 States/UTs, ~80 crore
Ghost beneficiaries	Aadhaar seeding: 99.8% cards, 98.9% beneficiaries

Leakage	***ePoS*** at 99.6% of 5.43 lakh FPSs; >98% digital
Targeting	Inter-database checks (CBDT, GSTN, PM-KISAN) flagged 8.51 crore; ***2.12 crore removed***
Choice	***DBT*** pilots: ₹267.6 cr (FY24)
Logistics	***Anna Chakra***; ***VLTS*** GPS tracking
Nutrition	Fortified food
Distress sale	e-NWR pledge finance

PYQ lens: subsidies and WTO distortions (2013, 2023, 2026), DBT (2015), buffer stocks (2024), NFSA (2013, 2021), PDS reforms (2019, 2022). For WTO subsidy parts add static material (not in the handout).

Recall drill: cover and answer

MSP formula?	≥50% over cost
ONORC reach?	All 36 States/UTs
PMFBY late claim penalty?	12% (from Kharif 2024)

Genome-Edited Rice, Swaminathan and Seed Sovereignty

PYQ Technology missions 2026

✎ *India released two genome-edited rice varieties (not GM). Swaminathan's legacy points to an evergreen revolution.*

Genome-edited rice (ICAR): ***DRR Dhan 100 Kamala*** (from Samba Mahsuri; CKX2 gene → more grains/panicle; ~20 days earlier; +19% yield; less water and methane) and ***Pusa DST Rice 1*** (from MTU 1010; drought, salinity, alkalinity tolerance; +9.66–30.4% in saline/alkaline soils). Made with ***CRISPR-Cas SDN-1/SDN-2***; no foreign DNA, so ***not GM*** (SDN-3 not used).

Significance	Concerns
Yield without more area	Biosafety: Coalition for a GM-Free India says edits not always precise; SDN-1/2 deregulation challenged
Climate resilience, water, methane	IPR ownership and seed sovereignty
Biotech leadership	Labelling; loss of rice genetic diversity

Way forward

→ Transparent trials and post-release monitoring · crop-specific guidelines · affordable public seed · conserve indigenous varieties (e.g. ***Pokkali*** saline-tolerant paddy) · local training

M.S. SWAMINATHAN

Contributions

→ Green Revolution: mid-1960s import of ***18,000 t*** Mexican dwarf wheat seed; with ***Borlaug***: Kalyan Sona, Sonalika; wheat ***12 MT (1965) → 55+ MT (1970s)***

→ ***Farmer-first science***; institutions (CRRI, IARI, IRRI), ***MSSRF*** Chennai

→ ***National Commission on Farmers***: MSP = cost + 50%

Legacy

→ Food → ***nutrition security*** · ***Evergreen Revolution*** (no cost to soil, water, biodiversity) · farmer income debate · mangroves and coastal protection · pro-poor, pro-women, pro-nature

Book: The Man Who Fed India by Priyambada Jayakumar.

Recall drill: cover and answer

SDN-3 used?	No — so not GM
Kamala yield gain?	19%

Role of Women in Agriculture

PYQ 2026 International Year of the Woman Farmer

✎ *Most rural women farm, but few own land. Recognition, titles, tools and collectives are the fix.*

UNGA declared **2026 International Year of the Woman Farmer**. ~80% of rural women in agri/allied; women's share **57% (2017-18) → 64.4% (2023-24)**; but own only **13-14%** of holdings (NFHS 8.3%); ~half are unpaid family workers; earn 20-30% less.

Programmes → **MKSP** · **DAY-NRLM** · **Krishi Sakhis** · **Namo Drone Didi** · **SMAM** · **AIF** · **ISAM/AMI** (higher subsidy) · **PM-KISAN** (~25% women) · women-led FPOs · **ICAR-CIWA** · pulses mission (≥20%) · **NBHM**

Roles → Production · allied sectors · nutrition (kitchen gardens; Odisha Shree Anna) · seed conservation (Ao and Angami women millet festivals) · climate resilience (WCRF model) · rural enterprise (Kudumbashree, SEWA)

Challenges → No land titles/recognition · unpaid and low pay · weak decision power · tools not designed for women · market barriers · climate burden

Way forward → Recognise women as farmers (records, IDs) · ***joint titles*** · drudgery-reducing tech and CHCs · women-led FPOs · **BHASHINI** voice advisory · climate-smart training · more Krishi/Pashu Sakhis

Recall drill: cover and answer

Women own holdings?	13-14%
Women share of agri workforce 2023-24?	64.4%

Cotton: Productivity Crisis and Policy Dilemma

PYQ Cropping patterns, trade

✎ *Cotton output has stagnated since 2015; removing the import duty helps textiles but hurts farmers.*

2nd-largest producer (after China); **~60 lakh** farmers; value chain employs **4.5 crore**. Production **13.6 m bales (2002-03) → 39.8 m (2013-14)** with Bt cotton, then stagnated; yield **~441-448 kg/ha** (20+ countries higher). Arrivals ~292 lakh bales vs need ~337 lakh. **11% import duty temporarily removed.**

Issues → Old Bt technology, pink bollworm · policy uncertainty (price controls, royalty caps; Bollgard II RRF and Bollgard III not released) · farmer distress · industry pressure

Stakeholder	Impact of duty removal
Textiles	Cheaper, available cotton
Farmers	Lower prices; may quit cotton
Economy	Risk of import dependence

Way forward → Flexible duty · CCI procurement on price fall · revive seed innovation with stable approvals · Cotton Productivity Mission · balance value chain · rainfed varieties

Recall drill: cover and answer

Cotton yield?	441-448 kg/ha
Import duty removed?	11%

Biofuels and Ethanol Blending (E20 and beyond)

PYQ Energy security, farm income

✎ *India reached E20 early. Biofuels cut oil imports and boost farm income but raise food-vs-fuel and vehicle issues.*

E20 achieved five years early (target 2030, advanced to ESY 2025-26 by 2022 amendment). ***E85*** launched at 48 outlets on World Environment Day 2026 (500 by Dec 2026; ~5,000 by Dec 2027); E100 rules drafted. ***BIS IS 19850:2026*** for E22/E25/E27/E30. SAF targets: ***1% (2027), 2% (2028), 5% (2030)*** for international flights.

Generations

1G: food crops (sugar, wheat); fuel vs food → 2G: waste, residues, non-food biomass → 3G: engineered crops, algae → 4G: biomass + carbon capture → carbon negative

Benefits

→ ***Economic:*** import substitution, rural value chains, farmer income, residue use

→ ***Social:*** jobs; less stubble burning

→ ***Environment:*** E20 cuts CO ~50% (2-wheelers), ~30% (4-wheelers); HC ~20%; circular economy

→ ***Strategic:*** energy security, oil-shock resilience, Global Biofuels Alliance, bridge to EV and hydrogen

Challenges

→ ***Food vs fuel:*** maize ethanol price grew 11.7% CAGR (FY22-25); maize area +6.68%, pulses fell, oilseeds +1.7% — energy vs food Atmanirbharta trade-off

→ Water: sugarcane + paddy ≈ 70% of irrigation; sugar price rise

→ NOx not uniformly lower; carbonyls; mileage loss; older vehicles; engine tuning and ethanol-resistant parts; storage/blending logistics; 2G scaling; chokepoints (Hormuz)

Steps

→ ***National Policy on Biofuels 2018*** (replaced 2009; 20% ethanol, 5% biodiesel); ***Ethanol Blending Programme 2003***; feedstock diversification; GST 5%; ***PM JI-VAN*** (2G); ***SATAT*** (CBG); ***National Bioenergy Programme***; ***RUCO***; SAF push; ***Global Biofuels Alliance***

Brazil: Proalcool (1975) → E27 via R&D, subsidies, tax breaks and flex-fuel vehicles. ***New fuels:*** SAF (CORSIA needs ≥10% lifecycle cut), iso-butanol (higher energy, less water absorption; Tata 2% diesel trial), drop-in fuels, biohydrogen.

Way forward

→ Shift to 2G · lifecycle assessment · keep E10 protection-grade · uniform quality and labelling · recalibrate targets/feedstock incentives · use biofuels as strategic buffer

Recall drill: cover and answer

E20 target year (original)?	2030
Biofuel policy year?	2018
SAF 2030 target?	5%

Disaster Management

Part II

Disaster Management: Concepts, Institutions and DM Act 2005

PYQ 2013, 2019, 2020, 2024, 2026 (community)

✎ *A disaster happens when a hazard meets vulnerability and low coping capacity. India moved from reactive relief to proactive risk reduction with the DM Act 2005.*

Disaster = serious disruption of a community causing widespread human, material, economic or environmental loss that ***exceeds its own coping capacity***. ***Hazard*** = potential source of harm (not certain). ***Vulnerability*** = conditions that raise susceptibility to harm. ***Exposure*** = assets in hazard-prone areas.

Disaster = Hazard × Vulnerability ÷ Capacity to cope · ***Risk = Hazard × Exposure × Vulnerability*** · Hazard groups: geophysical, hydrological, climatological, meteorological, biological.

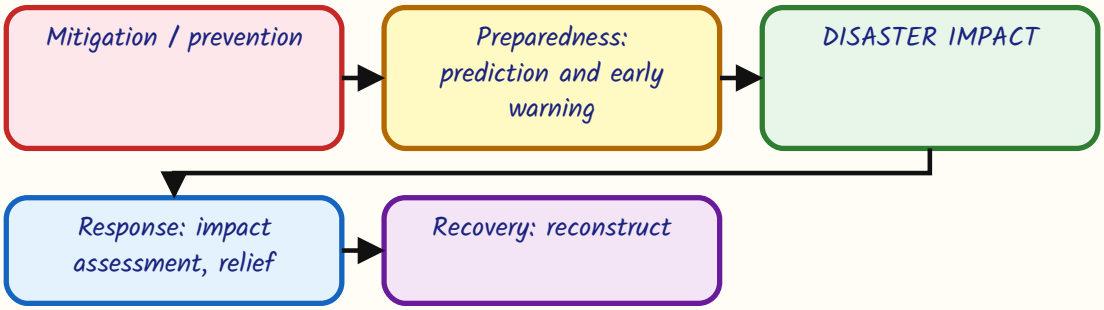
Types of vulnerability (PYQ 2019)

→ ***Physical*** (wooden houses)
→ ***Economic*** (low ability to cope)
→ ***Social*** (vulnerable sections)
→ ***Environmental*** (loss of wetlands)
→ ***Attitudinal*** (community attitudes)

DM and its goals

→ UN: systematic use of administrative decisions, organisation and skills to lessen hazard impact — ***before, during, after***
→ Goals: ***reduce losses***, ensure ***prompt assistance***, achieve ***rapid and effective recovery***

Disaster cycle



DM Act 2005 covers: prevention; mitigation; capacity-building; preparedness; prompt response; severity assessment; evacuation, rescue, relief; rehabilitation and reconstruction.

INDIA'S EVOLUTION — Shift



Institutions

→ ***CCS → NCMC*** (national crisis management; command, control, coordination; CBRN emergencies)
→ ***NDMA*** — policies, plans, guidelines; ***chaired by PM***
→ ***NEC*** — assists NDMA (Home Secretary leads)
→ ***NDRF*** — assists states; ***NIDM*** — training, capacity building
→ ***State:*** SDMA → ***DDMA*** → local bodies

NDRF record

→ Successes: ***Nepal earthquake 2015***, ***Chennai floods 2015***, ***Cyclone Fani 2019*** — "golden hours", advanced preparedness
→ Challenge: ***CBRN*** emergencies

Issues with the Act

→ ***Financial devolution*** to State authorities weak
→ ***Centralisation***
→ ***Definition of disaster not expanded*** (no objective severity threshold)
→ Response funds do ***not*** cover prevention, mitigation, risk reduction
→ "Visible goals" (relief) outrank "foundational goals" (prevention, training, awareness)

Plans and policy

→ ***NDM Policy 2009*** (framework for all phases) · ***NDMP 2019*** (dynamic document, aligned to Sendai, aims at risk understanding, DRR investment, governance, ***Build Back Better***)

PRIs AND COMMUNITY (2026 PYQ)

National Project for Strengthening Community-Based DRR in PRIs (MoPR + NDMA): ***₹507.37 cr***; 20 States, ***81*** hazard-prone districts, ***20 GPs per district*** in clusters; ***20 Model GPs*** (₹5 cr per State = ₹100 cr) for flash floods, landslides, coastal erosion, cyclones, drought, earthquakes. Village DM plans integrated into ***GPDPs***; builds on DMP-MoPR 2022.

Community participation answer: first responders; local knowledge; cyclone shelters and early warning dissemination; challenges — low awareness, resource gap, top-down plans, gender and equity gaps; measures — training, village plans in GPDP, SHGs, volunteers (Aapda Mitra), local-language alerts.

PYQ map: 2013 vulnerability/risk assessment · 2014 drought, El Niño/La Niña · 2015 earthquake · 2016 urban floods, cloudburst · 2017 tsunami · 2018, 2024 Sendai/DRR · 2019, 2021 landslides · 2020 proactive measures · 2022 cloudburst, coastal erosion · 2023 dam failure · 2024 urban floods · 2025 seawater intrusion · 2026 infrastructure vs DRR; community participation.

Recall drill: cover and answer

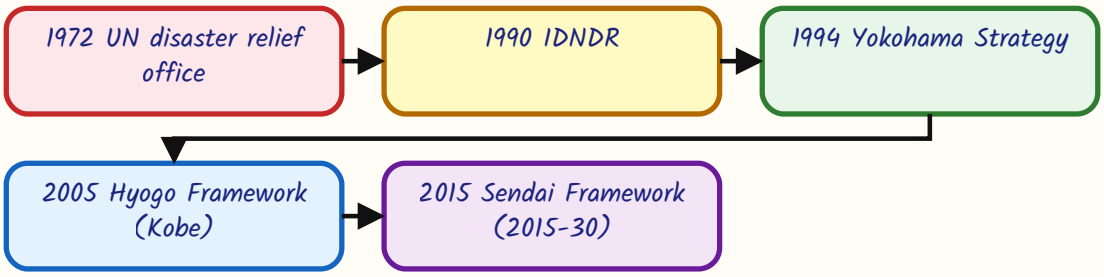
Risk formula?	Hazard × Exposure × Vulnerability
NDMA chair?	Prime Minister
NDM Plan year?	2019
PRI project outlay?	₹507.37 cr

Global Frameworks and DRR Financing

PYQ 2018, 2024 (Sendai, resilience)

✎ *Yokohama, Hyogo and Sendai gave the world DRR frameworks. India funds DRR through the 15th Finance Commission funds and leads CDRI.*

Evolution



Hyogo → Sendai

→ ***Hyogo successes:*** reduced mortality, cost-effectiveness of DRR, a global platform, first plan from all sectors
→ ***Challenges:*** disasters still take a heavy toll; economic losses; need for a more comprehensive framework → ***Sendai***
→ ***Sendai shift:*** from managing disasters to ***managing risk*** (general knowledge: 4 priorities, 7 targets — verify)

Three post-2015 frameworks are coherent: ***Sendai*** · ***Paris Agreement*** · ***SDGs***. India's ***10-Point Agenda***: mainstream DRR in development; risk coverage for all; ***women's leadership***; global risk mapping; ***technology***; university network; ***social media and mobiles***; local capacity; learn after every disaster; coherent international response.

Other mechanisms

→ ***CDRI*** (India-led, now ~40 countries) · ***Suva Expert Dialogue*** on Loss and Damage · ***Loss and Damage Fund*** · ***Global Platform for DRR*** reviews Sendai · ***EW4All*** (WMO + UNDRR, universal early warning by end-2027) · ***ARISE India*** (CII, FICCI) · Nature-based solutions (Mula-Mutha Pune)

FINANCING IN INDIA

15th FC: created ***SDRMF and NDRMF***; split ***80% response funds*** (SDRF/NDRF) and ***20% mitigation funds***. Within 80%: ***40% response and relief*** · ***30% recovery and reconstruction*** (₹20,539 cr NDRF; ₹48,046 cr SDRF; needs PDNA) · ***10% preparedness***. SDRF contribution ***75:25***, ***90:10*** for NE and Himalayan States.

Challenges

→ ***Outdated relief norms*** (₹4 lakh for life; ₹1.2 lakh full house loss)
→ ***Rigid spending*** (relief only)
→ ***No objective classification*** of severe disaster
→ ***Procedural delays***: State memorandum → IMCT → HLC

Way forward

→ Update norms · ***Disaster Risk / Vulnerability Index*** triggers · drone surveys, digital assessment, ***PFMS*** tracking · PPPs, targeted funds, tax incentives

UNDRR GAR 2025 "Resilience Pays": DRR is investment; disaster costs > ***$2.3 trn/yr*** including cascading; direct costs rose from ~$70-80 bn/yr (1970-2000) to ~$180-200 bn/yr (2001-20).

Recall drill: cover and answer

Sendai period?	2015-2030
Response vs mitigation split?	80:20

CDRI launched by?	India

Space Technology and Cell Broadcast Alerts in DM

PYQ 2020 (government initiatives)

✎ *Satellites map risk, track hazards and assess damage. Cell Broadcast alerts reach every phone without personal data.*

Component	Use and example
Risk mapping	Hazard zonation; **NRSC Landslide Atlas 2023**; Flood Hazard Atlas (Assam, Bihar)
Early warning	**INSAT-3D / 3DR** for IMD forecasting
Monitoring	**Cyclone Dana 2024** tracking; forest fire alerts (FSI, MODIS/VIIRS)
Response planning	**Bhuvan** portal
Communication	Satellite links; **National Cyclone Risk Mitigation Project** dissemination
Navigation / SAR	Track relief teams and fishing boats
Damage assessment	**RISAT** for Wayanad landslide extent; insurance and compensation
International	**NISAR** maps land and ice every 12 days

Conclusion line: space technology moves DM from relief-centric to **risk-informed, anticipatory governance**; integrate with community action.

CELL BROADCAST SYSTEM

CBS — DoT + NDMA; indigenous, built by **C-DOT**. Sends alerts to **all mobile devices in a defined area at once**, without straining networks (unlike SMS). Upgrades **SACHET** (CAP standard, SMS, also C-DOT).

Why useful

→ Near real-time · works on almost all handsets · **no personal data** · no app or subscription · **multilingual** · distinct tone even on silent · message stays until acknowledged

Recall drill: cover and answer

CBS built by?	C-DOT
Alert standard in SACHET?	Common Alerting Protocol

Internal Security

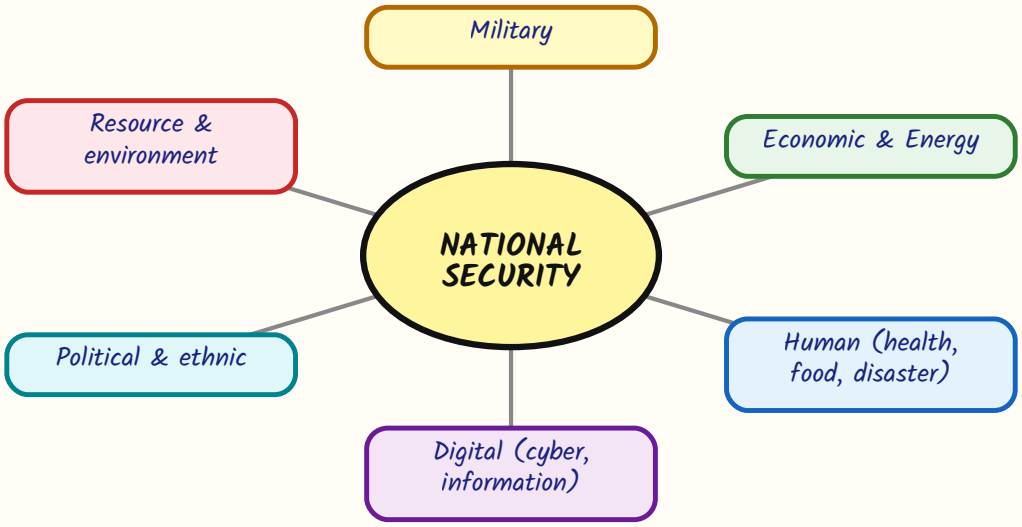
Part III

Elements of National Security

PYQ Foundation for GS3 answers

✎ *National security is not only army and borders. It is every thing that keeps the state, economy and people safe: 13 elements.*

The big picture (my grouping to remember 13 elements)



Element	What it means	Detail to quote
Military	Protect from external military threats; manage physical threats	Invasion, terrorism, cyber attacks · border and coastal security
Economic	National wealth, economic freedom of state and citizens	Supply-chain resilience · critical infrastructure · financial stability · ***critical minerals*** · resilience vs ***economic coercion***
Energy	Uninterrupted supply of energy	Security of international and energy assets
Environmental	Climate change; pollution	Internal displacement, warming war, migration · pollution is transnational
Ethnic	Avoid sectional conflict	Maintain ***national integration***, promote harmony
Cyber	Protect digital infrastructure	Develop cyber ***offence and defence*** capacity
Health	Disease surveillance, early warning	Rapid response and emergency preparedness
Information	Citizen's right to privacy; data as public good	***DPDP Act 2023*** and ***DPDP Rules 2025***; protect information that affects national security
Resource	Water conflicts	Internal: ***Cauvery*** · External: ***Indus*** water dispute
Political	Sovereignty, stability of government	Honour ***human rights*** of citizens by the state
Geostrategic	Military co-operation; strategic autonomy	Defence purchase · training
Food	Address nutritional poverty	Measures to avoid starvation
Disaster	Mitigation and quick response	

Answer hook: "Security is multi-dimensional — a failure in food, water or data can become a failure of the state." Use this opener for any internal-security question.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Name 5 non-military elements	Economic, energy, environmental, cyber, health, information, resource, food...
Internal vs external water dispute?	Cauvery vs Indus
Data laws under information security?	DPDP Act 2023 + Rules 2025

National Security Doctrine

PYQ Debate on NSS; theaterisation link

✎ *A doctrine is the written "rule-book" of principles for how the state uses military, diplomacy and intelligence. India has none public.*

National Security Doctrine = a set of ***basic principles***, based on the ***core interests*** of the State, shaping how different elements of national power protect and further the Republic's interests; a concise summary of strategic vision and objectives. It identifies missions and principles for the ***armed forces, diplomatic and intelligence communities***.

> *"The new frontiers of war — fourth-generation warfare — is* ***civil society.*** *" — **Ajit Doval***

> *"Half-done reforms create new vulnerabilities without solving old ones. You cannot cross a chasm in two leaps." — **Shivshankar Menon** (Bipin Rawat's reforms incomplete)*

In the news: India still debates a public, comprehensive ***National Security Strategy***; meanwhile elements are codified through ***domain-specific doctrines*** (counter-terrorism, cyberspace, multi-domain operations).

NEED FOR A DOCTRINE

New domains of warfare

→ ***Complex threats*** — traditional + non-traditional (cyber, narco-terror, eco-terror)
→ ***Technology*** expands the battlefield and nullifies traditional advantage
→ ***Grey-zone warfare*** — ambiguous space between peace and war
→ ***Digital age*** reshapes battlespace; ***proxy wars*** rise

Recommended by committees

→ ***Kargil Review Committee*** — integrate security; GoM + 4 task forces, recommendations not implemented
→ ***Naresh Chandra Task Force 2011*** — doctrine-level national security strategy

Before theaterisation

→ ***Gen. M.M. Naravane***: theaterisation without an NSS is ***putting the cart before the horse***

Clarity and integration

→ Efforts on military, paramilitary, intelligence are ***scattered*** — a document gives foresight
→ Internal and external threats ***blur***: ***2.5-front war*** (China + Pakistan + internal) — Gen. Bipin Rawat
→ ***Galwan 2020***: a failure in ***managing*** intelligence, not only in gathering it

Practised response

→ Doctrine = ***algorithm*** for policymakers, not ad hoc; e.g. ***IC-814 hijack*** confusion
→ Enhances ***Comprehensive National Power***

Changing world

→ ***US-China/Russia*** rivalry and proxy wars
→ ***Afghanistan*** again epicentre of terror after US exit; China keeps links with jihadi elements
→ ***Pak-China axis***; ***Hamas-Israel*** war energises jihadi groups

GLOBAL EXAMPLES

Country	Document
USA, UK, Russia	Regularly updated ***National Security Strategy***
China	***Comprehensive National Security*** strategy tied to governance

Pakistan	***National Security Policy 2022-2026***

WHAT WILL IT CONTAIN?

Contents

→ ***National interests and values*** → translated into goals

→ ***Strategic culture and diplomacy***: amicable solutions first, right to use force; expand diplomatic cadre

→ ***Communicate objectives and redlines*** (deterrence). E.g. if Pakistan had known Kashmir attack = riposte to Lahore, ***1965*** avoided

→ ***Periodic updates***

WHY NOT YET? — CHALLENGES

What has not been done

→ ***Only political direction:*** Raksha Mantri's ***Operational Directive 2009*** (Gen. N.C. Vij) — dated

→ ***Political hesitation*** — Menon: 3 attempts, accountability fear

→ No whole-of-government effort

→ ***Deliberate non-disclosure*** — strategic ambiguity

Challenges in framing

→ ***Poor civil-military relations***: no joint leadership; chiefs have operational autonomy but little policy say

→ ***Strategic restraint*** — Cohen & Das Gupta: India rejected colonisers' instruments

→ ***Divergent goals*** (Walter Ladwig): Army short wars with tech; Navy blue water + nuclear subs; Air Force reach Gulf to Malacca → need ***joint war-fighting doctrine***

Counter-view: CDS Gen. Anil Chauhan — no written NSS ≠ no strategy; ***Art. 370 revocation, Uri and Balakot*** show it exists. ***Doval Doctrine*** (2014) = "***double squeeze***" strategy.

Conclusion: Competition + tech domains + grey-zone tempo make threats lethal; a ***vigilant, adaptive*** national security craft is essential.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Who proposed an NSS before theaterisation?	Gen. M.M. Naravane
Which 2009 document is the only political direction?	Raksha Mantri's Operational Directive
Doval Doctrine?	Double squeeze
3 committees that urged a doctrine?	Kargil Review, GoM task forces, Naresh Chandra 2011

National Security Council and Indian Coast Guard

PYQ Higher defence organisation, NSA role

✎ *NSC is the PM-led apex advisory body for security. NSA runs the secretariat. It advises; it does not decide.*

Source note: this chapter comes from handwritten class slides read by OCR; confirm details against the Cabinet Secretariat site before quoting.

NSC was constituted on the recommendation of the ***K C Pant Task Force***. ***Prime Minister*** is chairman; it is the apex ***inter-ministerial mechanism*** for integrated thinking and coordinated application of resources on national security.

Three tiers

→ ***Strategic Policy Group (SPG)***: headed by ***Cabinet Secretary***; Defence, Foreign, Home Secretaries, Service Chiefs and others
→ ***National Security Advisory Board (NSAB)***: long-term analysis and perspective
→ ***Joint Intelligence Committee (JIC)***: assesses inputs from various intelligence agencies

Members (as per slide)

→ Prime Minister (chair)
→ Home, Defence, Finance, External Affairs Ministers
→ NSA (Secretary to the Council); permanent invitees

NSCS AND NSA

NSC Secretariat (NSCS)

→ Provides ***analysis and coordination***; follows up decisions
→ Headed by ***NSA***
→ Interface with ***R&AW, IB, NTRO***
→ ***No decision-making authority***

Functions of NSA

→ ***Principal adviser*** to the PM on national security
→ ***Leads national response*** to a security crisis
→ ***Inter-ministerial coordination***
→ Supervises nuclear command and control architecture (slide)
→ Supported by ***Deputy NSAs***, Military Adviser, ***National Maritime Security Coordinator***

Recent context (slide): Government appointed an ***Additional NSA*** to the NSCS. Verify the name and date before using.

INDIAN COAST GUARD

ICG

→ ***Coast Guard Act, 1978***
→ Coastal ***surveillance and patrol***; anti-poaching; anti-smuggling
→ ***Search and rescue*** (Maritime Rescue Coordination Centres); ***Operation Sajag*** (coastal security drill with stakeholders)
→ Pollution response
→ Fleet modernisation; ***Coastal Surveillance Network*** and interagency coordination (see Maritime Security chapter)

Key weakness to write: NSC advises only; no statutory basis; coordination depends on the PM and NSA. General knowledge, verify before using.

Recall drill: cover and answer

NSC set up on whose recommendation?	K C Pant Task Force
Chair?	Prime Minister
Three tiers?	SPG, NSAB, JIC
Coast Guard Act year?	1978

Defence Reforms: Modernisation, Agnipath, Navy, Exports

PYQ Linked to Doctrine, Agnipath debates

✎ *Reforms aim at jointness, indigenisation, young and tech-savvy forces and a defence-export push.*

Defence modernisation = upgrading military capability through new weapons (imported or indigenous), **new doctrines, organisational structures, manpower management and training regimes**. Areas: combat capabilities; procedures, structures and systems (arms acquisition: speed, transparency; higher defence structure; ITC; Agnipath).

AGNIPATH SCHEME (2022)

> *"Agnipath is also a potential game-changer because it will help collapse the walls of granite between... the civil and military domains."* — **Lt Gen Raj Shukla**

Feature	Detail
Model	**4-year** recruitment (incl. 6 months training), below officer rank; **17.5–21 years**
After 4 years	**25%** absorbed for 15 more years; **75%** leave with **Seva Nidhi** (30% of salary) ≈ **₹11.71 lakh**; no pension or gratuity
Certification	AICTE, NSDC, NCVET; CAPF/Assam Rifles pathways
Ex-Agniveer 2026	**50% reservation** in CAPF/AR constables; 3 yr age relaxation (5 for first batch); exempt from PST, PET, written; dedicated MHA wing

Objectives
- → **Financial efficiency**: pay + pension take 50–55% of defence budget, modernisation only 3–4%
- → **Youthful forces**: lower average age from 32
- → **Tech-skilled**: AR/VR, simulation, AI training
- → **Nation-building**: discipline, patriotism

Positives
- → Younger, future-ready force; saves pension; youth employment; skilled workforce; border-area workforce
- → Inspired by 1960s–70s colour service; parallels USA, Israel, South Korea; shift from "womb to tomb" model

Concerns
- → **No pilot** testing; dilution of military ethos; morale; PTSD and reintegration; unclear re-enlistment; no pension, no CSD canteen; 60,000 PBOR retire yearly (vacancies)

Way ahead
- → Holistic skill empowerment (corporates, startups, NITI Aayog); inter-ministerial effort (Skill, Education, Labour); talent pipeline; combat effectiveness balance; absorb in civil/administrative roles; continuous evaluation

INDIAN NAVY MODERNISATION

Navy
- → **Atmanirbhar by 2047** (Adm. R. Hari Kumar); greater jointness
- → **New ensign** (INS Vikrant, Kochi) based on **Shivaji's octagonal seal**; **INS Shivaji** (Lonavla); **INS Angre** (Kanhoji Angre, Mumbai)
- → Shivaji: "**Jalameva yasya, balameva tasya**"; Marathas strong in **littoral** waters

DEFENCE EXPORTS & INDIGENISATION

Data: defence production FY2025-26 **₹1.78 lakh cr** (+15.6%; PSU 76%, private 24%). **Exports ₹38,424 cr** (+62.66% from ₹23,622 cr). 2015-19 India 2nd largest importer; now top-25 exporter. Exports to US >50% (>$2.8 bn in 5 years). **iDEX:** 676 startups/MSMEs, 551 contracts; **ADITI** ₹750 cr. FDI: 74% automatic, 100% government route; ₹6,670.59 cr cumulative.

Efforts

→ **Positive Indigenisation Lists** (411 items services; 10 lists, 5,521 items DPSUs)
→ **75%** of capital acquisition budget for Indian firms; **IDDM** priority (DAP 2020)
→ Simplified licensing; **SRIJAN** portal; **Defence Industrial Corridors** (UP, TN); **Mission DefSpace**
→ Lines of credit, Exim, offset; **MEA and embassies** promote

Challenges

→ **Distorted market**: monopsony (armed forces sole buyer), DPSU supply monopoly, orders in dozens-hundreds
→ **Lack of cohesion** among stakeholders; no single-point agency
→ **Ad-hoc policy** (DPEPP 2020 needs sustained focus)
→ **DPSU-private asymmetry**

Recommendations

→ Widen **whole-of-government** approach; **Defence Export Promotion Agency (DEPA)** under PMO
→ Focus on **high-value platforms**: Tejas, BrahMos, Pinaka, Akash
→ Use export revenue for DPSU R&D; **avoid autarkic** production

Recall drill: cover and answer

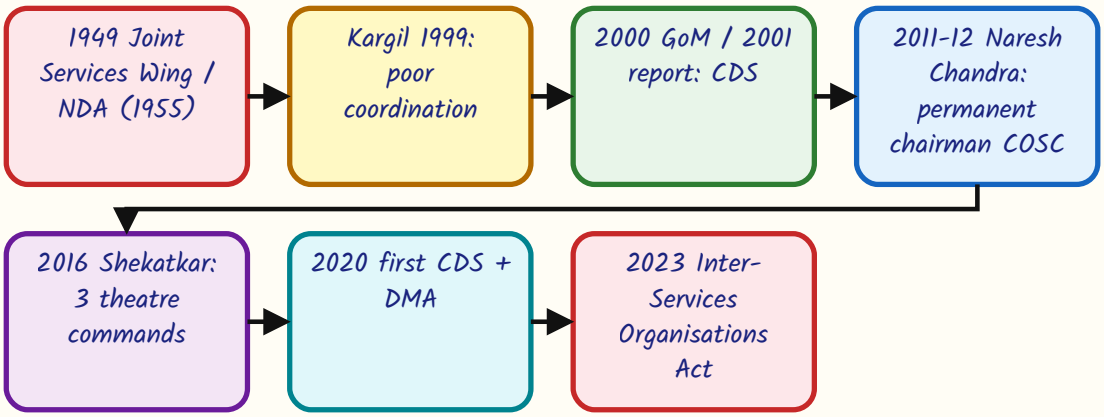
Agnipath age and tenure?	17.5-21; 4 years
Seva Nidhi comes from?	30% of salary
Defence exports FY26?	₹38,424 cr
Ex-Agniveer CAPF reservation?	50%

Integrated Theatre Command and CDS

PYQ Higher defence reforms

✎ *India has 17 single-service commands. The CDS (2020) and DMA push towards theatre commands, but critics say build jointness and doctrine first.*

Road to jointness



Early tri-service institutions

→ Joint Services Wing (Dehradun 1949); **NDA** (inaugurated 1955); DSSC Wellington; NDC Delhi — but operational jointness limited

Commands today

→ **Unified:** Andaman & Nicobar Command (2001, theatre) · **Strategic Forces Command** (2003, functional)

→ **17 single-service commands:** Army 7 · Air Force 7 · Navy 3

→ **Air Defence Command** (2020 idea) — **not operationalised** (June 2023): IAF says air defence and offence are interdependent

→ Specialised: **Defence Cyber Agency** (could become Information Warfare Command), **AFSOD**, Defence Space Agency; proposed Logistics, Training and Doctrinal commands

Inter-Services Organisations (Command, Control and Discipline) Act 2023: enabling law; Centre can constitute inter-service organisations; **Commander-in-Chief / Officer-in-Command** has disciplinary powers over all personnel irrespective of service; existing Service Acts unchanged; Centre can issue directions.

CHIEF OF DEFENCE STAFF

Evolution

→ Post-1947: **Chiefs of Staff Committee** (triumvirate, Chairman-COSC = title only)

→ **Kargil 1999 → GoM 2000 → 2001 report**: CDS (deferred); **Naresh Chandra 2011-12**: CDS as **permanent chairman COSC** compromise; both urged integrating HQs with MoD, cross-staffing

About CDS

→ **Four-star**, pay equal to service chiefs; **no command** over chiefs; **primus inter pares**; precedence **12th**

→ **Permanent Chairman COSC** · **Principal Military Adviser** to Defence Minister · **Secretary, Department of Military Affairs (DMA)**

→ Command over **DCyA, DSA, AFSOD** via Integrated Defence Staff; promotes jointness in procurement, training, staffing

→ Equivalents: Pakistan CJCSC · UK CDS · US CJCS

Issues

→ No operational command; limited political involvement in planning; DMA reduced civilian oversight (promotions, postings); Defence Secretary role diluted

Way forward

→ Define CDS operational role vs chiefs' administrative duties; ***Vice CDS***; empower command over theatres; professional independence; continuous evaluation

ISSUES WITH THEATRE COMMANDS

Issues

→ ***Lack of true jointness*** (training, operations, planning); successes by good fortune

→ ***Premature push***; separate land/maritime/air-defence proposal makes one service dominant

→ Service-specific war plans; ***air power*** contested (IAF proprietary view); ***rotational leadership*** debate

→ Need ***National Security Doctrine*** before theatrisation

Way forward

→ ***Jointness first***; ***pilot one theatre*** (northern: Kargil, Ladakh)

→ Develop "***purple***" ***personnel*** with multi-service experience

→ ***Joint war-fighting doctrine***; learn from global examples

Shekatkar Committee (Dec 2016) under Manohar Parrikar's MoD recommended three integrated theatre commands.

Recall drill: cover and answer

First CDS year?	2020
Which committee proposed 3 theatre commands?	Shekatkar 2016
Air Defence Command status?	Not operationalised (June 2023)
CDS ranks?	12th in precedence; four-star; primus inter pares

Mission Sudarshan Chakra

PYQ Air defence, Operation Sindoor, indigenisation

✎ *A 10-year plan (to 2035) to build an indigenous, multi-layer air and missile defence shield that can also hit back, covering military and civilian places.*

Announced in the PM's ***Independence Day 2025*** address: ***10-year mission, shield by 2035***. Name from Krishna's Sudarshan Chakra: ***protection and precise retaliation***.

Core objective

- → Indigenous ***multi-level air and missile defence***
- → ***Neutralise attacks and counter-punch***
- → Protect ***military, strategic and civilian*** assets and public places
- → Work across ***air, land and sea***

KEY FEATURES

Features

- → ***Indigenous*** R&D and manufacture (Aug 2025 DRDO integrated air-defence test hit ***3 targets together***, called first step by Raksha Mantri)
- → ***Multi-layered***: different ranges and altitudes
- → ***Defence and offence***
- → ***Networked architecture*** (sensors, radars, command centres, weapons)
- → ***Foundation:*** IACCS, Akashteer, BMD, S-400, Akash, BrahMos
- → ***Cyber and space layer***, EW, AI decision support
- → Adds ***maritime and land*** layers to air defence

WHY IT MATTERS

Reasons

- → ***Changing warfare***: drones, missiles, hypersonics, cyber, EW
- → ***Operation Sindoor*** showed strength and need for wider shield
- → ***Two-front*** challenge (China, Pakistan)
- → ***Civilian security***: cities, hospitals, railways
- → ***Strategic autonomy***; ***deterrence***

Challenges

- → Meeting the ***2035*** deadline
- → Integrating Army, Navy, Air Force, space, cyber, civil networks
- → ***Production at scale***, not just tests
- → Cyber and data-manipulation risk
- → Enough indigenous sensors, interceptors, radars, ***directed-energy*** systems
- → Balance automation and ***human decision***

Link: Defence Reforms (jointness), Atmanirbhar Bharat, Grey Zone (drones and missiles), Smart Border (counter-drone).

Recall drill: cover and answer

Announced when and by whom?	PM, Independence Day 2025
Target year?	2035
Existing systems it builds on?	IACCS, Akashteer, BMD, S-400, Akash, BrahMos

Grey Zone and Hybrid Warfare

PYQ Theme in NSD, theatre command, China-Pakistan answers

✎ *Grey zone = hostile actions below the threshold of war (cyber, debt traps, proxies, disinformation). Hybrid = conventional + irregular forces. India faces both from China and Pakistan ("2.5 front").*

Grey Zone (US DoD) = strategic space between ***peace and total war***; actors use all authority to reach politico-military goals beyond peaceful limits while staying ***below all-out overt confrontation***. Tools: ***nefarious economic practices, influence operations, cyberattacks, mercenaries, assassinations, disinformation, debt traps, sanctions***.

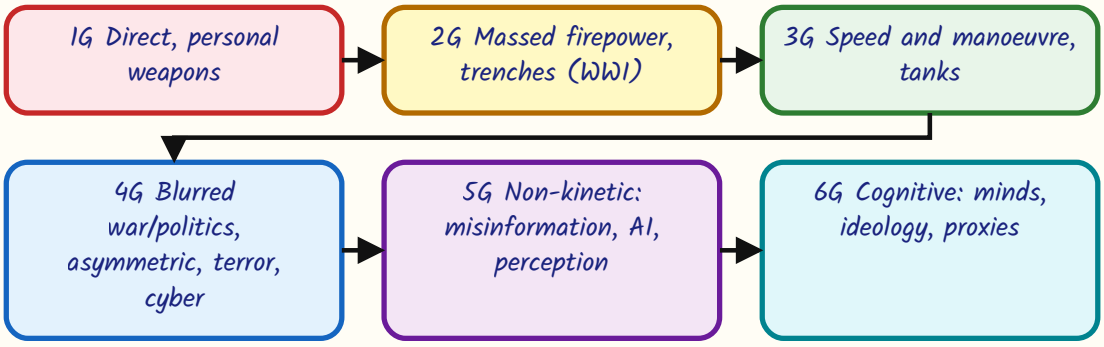
Why it happens

→ ***Technology*** + high cost and risk of conventional conflict in nuclear era → covert aggression with ***obfuscated attribution***

→ ***Strategic advantage*** over conventionally stronger adversary

→ ***Perpetual conflict*** wears down adversary; boundaries of acceptable action expand → risk of inadvertent escalation

SIX GENERATIONS OF WARFARE — Generations



DFMANC — "**D**on't **F**ight **M**en — **A**ttack **N**arratives, **C**ontrol minds": Direct · Firepower · Manoeuvre · Asymmetric · Non-kinetic · Cognitive (in order)

GREY ZONE vs CONVENTIONAL vs HYBRID

Aspect	Grey zone	Conventional / Hybrid
Provocation	Baits other side to escalate; then claims ***self-defence***	Conventional: declared hostilities
Territory	***Normalises*** claims by repeated presence (***salami slicing***)	Clear military victory and occupation
Escalation	Escalates in ***many dimensions***	Usually one dimension
Operations	***Covert***, non-military pressure	Overt combat
Level	Tactical, operational, ***strategic***; protracted	Hybrid: tactical + operational; with conventional ops
Aim	Global/regional ***revisionist***	Concept is operational/tactical
Symmetry	Symmetric and asymmetric	Mainly asymmetric

Grey zone during conventional war

→ **DIME** (diplomacy, information, military, economy) over protracted period
→ May spiral into full war — e.g. **2001 standoff, Operation Parakram** after Parliament attack
→ Extension of **non-contact warfare** (cyber, space, information, diplomatic, economic)
→ India: **"two and a half front"** — half front fought in grey zone

CHARACTERISTICS OF GREY ZONE

Seven features

→ **Level of aggression**: just short of triggers
→ **Protracted**: gradual (Chinese **salami slicing**; Pakistan's terror in the valley)
→ **Non-attributability**: deniability via cyber, disinformation, non-state actors
→ **Historical and legal claims**: China in South China Sea, Indo-China border; Pakistan in Kashmir
→ **Policy of denial**: stop short of vital concerns (China's fishing boats)
→ **Remain below threshold**: Pakistan's TNW threat, China in **Galwan**
→ **All-out non-military efforts** and **target fault lines** (polarisation, ethnic and communal divides)

Do autocracies fare better?

→ **Centralised** whole-of-state marshalling
→ **Democracies vulnerable**: fragmented, slow
→ **Doctrine integration** (Russia, China)
→ **Not bound** by rules-based order

COUNTERING GREY ZONE

"No proxy war or insurgency has been defeated by military force alone" — **French in Algeria**: tactical wins, strategic loss. India has fought a hybrid war in J&K for decades.

Government & society

→ **Whole-of-government** approach (common language, interagency options)
→ **Remove vulnerabilities** (root causes, grievance redress)
→ **Free and open press** (calls out secrecy-based activities)
→ **Partnerships** with like-minded states

Military & technology

→ **Bridge technology gap**: AI, drones, big data, space, EW, autonomous, swarm, cyber, bio, quantum
→ **Conventional deterrence**; **doctrine and training**; **combined arms** → joint theatre command to brigade level
→ **Information operations** (cyber, strategic communication); **hybrid capabilities** (Special Forces, agile units, long-range artillery, drones); **military reforms**

First-mover advantage: grey-zone gains go to who moves first — Chinese artificial islands would have been easier to contest at the start.

HYBRID WARFARE

Hybrid warfare = conflict combining **conventional forces and irregulars** (guerrillas, insurgents, terrorists), state and non-state, for a common political purpose. Features: **asymmetry · military + non-military mix · weaponised information · psychological and cyber · coercion and intimidation · subversion and espionage · integrated campaigns for surprise · psychological dominance**.

Example	Technique
China "Unrestricted warfare" (late 1990s)	Hacking, viruses, banking subversion, market/currency manipulation, urban terror, media disinformation; **Three Warfares** (psychological, media, legal / lawfare)
Hezbollah 2006 (Israel)	Guerrilla + conventional + strategic communication
Russia, Crimea 2014	Conventional + political protests, economic coercion, cyber, disinformation

INDIA'S CASE: CHINA

China's hybrid war

→ **Territorial aggression** at LAC (coercive gradualism)
→ **Economic colonisation**: BRI, debt traps in IOR
→ **Cyber and information** (Three Warfares)
→ Economic-diplomatic pressure; collusion with Pakistan
→ **Maritime**: Malacca vulnerability vs India's ability to block sea lanes
→ **Resource security** drives expansion

India's way forward

→ **Economic resilience**: reduce import dependence (electronics, pharma, rare earths); Atmanirbhar; ASEAN, EU, US; **Blue Dot Network, B3W**
→ **Military modernisation**: joint cyber/EW; air and naval strength; deep-strike specialised units
→ **Border infrastructure**: all-weather roads, tunnels, airfields
→ **Strategic partnerships** with US, Japan, Israel (AI, quantum, cyber)
→ **Maritime security** vs string of pearls; **connectivity**: India-Myanmar-Thailand Highway, BBIN
→ **Diplomacy**: CBMs, BRICS, SCO; **soft power**: ISA

INDIA'S CASE: PAKISTAN

Pakistan's hybrid war

→ **Proxy**: LeT, JeM, Hizbul
→ **Narco-terror and counterfeit currency**
→ **Separatism**: Khalistan; Indian Mujahideen
→ **Cyber and economic sabotage**
→ **Intifada-style protests**
→ **Strategic depth**; Indus water security

India's way forward

→ **Joint military planning**: covert ops, drone strikes, limited wars
→ **Politico-military diplomacy**: isolate; aid conditional on terror crackdown; CBMs suspended
→ **Economic** measures; **National Strategic Communications Advisory Committee**
→ **Escalation control**: proportionate response under nuclear backdrop

Conclusion: unrestricted grey-zone wars are the commonest form of conflict (India-Pakistan); India needs a **proactive, institutionalised whole-of-nation strategy** with synergy of political, military, economic and information infrastructure.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Define grey zone (one line)	Space between peace and total war; hostile acts below war threshold
6 generations in order?	Direct, Firepower, Manoeuvre, Asymmetric, Non-kinetic, Cognitive
DIME?	Diplomacy, Information, Military, Economy
Example of salami slicing?	China at LAC / South China Sea

India's "2.5 front"?	China + Pakistan + half front in grey zone

Left Wing Extremism (LWE)

PYQ 2013 · 2015 · 2018 · 2020 · 2022 · 2025

✎ *Naxalism = armed ideology fed by land, forest and governance failures. Now: no LWE-affected district (2026); focus shifts to relapse prevention.*

LWE = political ideology seeking ***radical change*** by abolishing capitalism, setting up a socialist/communist order and ***dismantling existing power structures***; uses bombings, assassinations, armed insurrection. Teacher keywords: ***disaffection*** · ***disinformation*** · ***displacement*** → protracted people's war → overthrow of government.

> *"Naxalism is not merely a law-and-order issue... directly related to* ***underdevelopment****... tribal areas are the main battleground."* — **Dr Manmohan Singh**

> *"The Constitution intends that the land always should remain with the Tribals."* — **Samatha judgement**

Naxal Mukt Bharat: target ***31 Mar 2026*** (Centre-State strategy, 24 Aug 2024). Handout: ***no district LWE-affected***; 2026 to 29 Jul: ***33 incidents, 11 deaths***. (Slide/map show 2 districts — Bijapur, Sukma — on 30 Mar; handout text says zero.)

DATA: PEAK TO PRESENT (PYQ 2018)

Indicator	Then	Now
Districts affected	126 (2014)	***0*** (Mar-Apr 2026); ***38*** Legacy & Thrust (13 in Chhattisgarh)
Violent incidents	1,936 (2010) · 870 (2014)	234 (2025) = ***−88%***
Deaths (civil + SF)	1,005 (2010) · 310 (2014)	100 (2025) = ***−90%***
Police stations with violence	465 (2010)	119 (2025)
2025 ops		364 neutralised · 1,022 arrested · 2,337 surrendered (3,927 in 2024-Mar 2026)

Shift: from the expanding "Red Corridor" to ***consolidating LWE-free areas and relapse prevention.*** Two-tier policy: ***Legacy & Thrust*** (insurgency ended) · ***District of Concern*** (network dismantled, targeted work).

Evolution: four phases

1967-72 Naxalbari · CPI(ML) 1969 → 1975-2004 4 factions · PU+PWG 1998 → 2004-12 CPI-Maoist · Salwa Judum → 2013- Decline · zero districts 2026

1st phase 1967-72

→ ***Naxalbari*** (WB) + Bihar + ***Srikakulam*** (AP) → ***CPI (ML) 1969***, ***Charu Majumdar***

→ Spread to rural WB, Bihar, AP, urban Kolkata; crushed by 1972 (United Front + Indira Gandhi govts)

2nd phase 1975–2004

→ Factions in Emergency: ***MCC, PWG, Party Unity, CPI-ML (Liberation)*** (Liberation contested elections)

→ ***1998*** PU + PWG → CPI-ML (People's War); MCC in Bihar/Jharkhand, PWG north Telangana

→ Bihar caste war: Dalits (MCC) vs ***Ranvir Sena, Sunlight Sena***

3rd phase 2004–12

→ ***2004:*** PU + MCC + PWG → ***CPI-Maoist***, unified command

→ ***Salwa Judum*** 2005–09 · ***Operation Green Hunt*** 2009–12 · ***2010 Dantewada***: 76 killed (75 CRPF)

4th phase 2013–

→ Violence below 1990s average: ***Integrated Action Plan***, roads, police stations, NREGA; Maoist ***tactical retreat***

DRIVERS OF NAXALISM (PYQ 2020 · 2022) Expert Group, Planning Commission, ARC II

PLEDGES — unkept state ***pledges*** opened the door: **P**olice/state repression · **L**and & agrarian · **E**conomic-social · **D**isplacement · **G**overnance · **E**mpowerment (psychological) · **S**ocial exclusion

P — Police & state repression

→ Arbitrary police action, forest-staff harassment; ***TADA/POTA*** on tribals leave land fallow, Naxals encroach

L — Land & agrarian

→ ***Land reforms failed*** (ceilings evaded, special tenures exempt)

→ Encroached govt/community land; no title for landless; tribal→non-tribal transfer in Fifth Schedule areas; ***LARR 2013*** not implemented

→ Bihar: Naxals helped ***Musahars*** take land

E — Economic & social

→ Land rights, jobs, discrimination; cash-credit shortage → moneylenders

→ PDS corruption; lost common-property rights; ***Minimum Wages Act*** not applied (Naxals enforce wages)

D — Displacement (PYQ 2015)

→ ***FCA 1980*** kept forest dwellers near eviction

→ ***40% of displaced*** are tribal evictees; projects without rehabilitation

G — Governance

→ ***73rd Amendment*** unfulfilled; absent staff, poor health/schools; police misuse

→ ***Circular trap*** (forest security → less local connect → more insecurity)

→ No rural dispute resolution → Naxal ***People's Courts***

E — Empowerment (psychological)

→ Youth gain power and identity by challenging traditional power holders

S — Social exclusion

→ Atrocity, civil-rights, bonded-labour laws poorly enforced (***Karimnagar 1980***); alienation from land and culture

Teacher (slide 12): Governance deficit → Naxals gain ***legitimacy*** → vicious cycle. Keywords: ***Xaxa*** (40% tribal victims) · land to the tiller · CFR lacking · SC/ST Act not enforced · judicial alienation.

COUNTER-LWE SCHEMES (PYQ 2018 · 2025)

Physical infrastructure

→ Special Infrastructure Scheme (fortified police stations); ***LWE Mobile Tower Project***, USOF

→ ***NETRA*** micro-UAVs (CRPF); GIS mapping; rail in Bastar; ***15,189 km*** roads (RRP / Road Connectivity Project)

Institutional

→ ***SRE Scheme***; ***Unified Command*** (Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha, WB); ***SCA*** for 30 districts; Civic Action Programme

→ ***Multi Agency Centre*** (State MACs: Jagdalpur, Gaya); India Reserve Battalions

Social

→ ***NYKS***, ***Roshni***, Livelihood Colleges, ***179 Eklavya schools***
→ PM Janjatiya Unnat Gram Yojana · ***PM PVTG Mission*** · GOAL · ABP Sampoornata

Financial & other

→ ***6,000+ post offices*** with banking
→ ***Aspirational Districts*** (35 LWE districts); ***Godavarman case*** (no dereservation without SC); ***National Policy and Action Plan 2015***

Forces and operations

→ ***COBRA, Black Panther, Bastariya Battalion, C-60*** (Gadchiroli), ***Greyhounds*** (AP); STRACO (WB)
→ Op ***Octopus*** (Bihar-Jharkhand), ***Double Bull***, ***Anaconda***, ***Black Forest*** (Chh-Telangana); NSG first in Gadchiroli

SAMADHAN — (faculty) **S**mart leadership · **A**ggressive strategy · **M**otivation & training · **A**ctionable intelligence · **D**ashboard KPIs · **H**arness technology · **A**ction plan per theatre · **N**o access to financing

Post-Naxalism governance: ***Shaheed Veer Gunda Dhur Seva Dera*** (70 ex-CAPF camps → Jan Seva Kendras); Education Cities (₹100 cr each); 3 medical colleges; Bastar Olympics; ***PM-JANMAN***, ***DAJGUA***; 46 ITIs. ***Bastar*** to be most developed tribal division by Dec 2030. Case studies: ***Niyad Nellanar*** (Chh) · ***Mission Gramodaya*** (Odisha, 453 villages).

SURRENDER POLICY (PYQ 2015)

Surrender & rehabilitation

→ Paired with firm police action; aim = gainful employment so cadres do not return
→ ***₹5 lakh*** (higher cadres), ***₹2.5 lakh*** (others), weapon incentives, ***₹10,000/month*** for 3 years training

GOVERNMENT APPROACH & ARC II STRATEGY (PYQ 2018 · 2020 · 2022)

Approach

→ ***Police & public order = State subjects*** (7th Schedule); Centre supplements
→ ***Three-pronged:*** (1) necessary force (2) address grievances via infrastructure (3) political demands with timelines
→ ***Clear, hold and develop***; low-key (North-East) not Sri Lanka's "hammer and tongs"

ARC II capacity building	***Key points***
Security forces	Temporary development role (WB police kept schools running); SOPs within constitution; task forces like Greyhounds
Administration	Strengthen field formations; ***Oversight Committee for FRA 2006***
Personnel	Train at LBS Academy; reimburse States for incentives in difficult areas
Local bodies	Implement ***PESA 1996***
Civil society	Bridge between extremists and govt; ventilate grievances legally
Cut finances	BRO builds roads directly; anti-extortion wing

NAXALISM — (handout's own, ARC II way forward) **N**egotiations · **A**dministrative monitoring · e**X**tend legal frameworks (FRA committees) · **A**ugment forces (SOPs) · **L**earning & sensitisation of police · **I**mplementation monitoring (PESA) · **S**trengthen local police · **M**aximise infrastructure security (BRO)

Teacher keywords: tactical → structural (contain → disintegrate leadership, cadre, support) · ***3C*** = road, mobile, financial connectivity · dual approach = peace through inclusion + no-holds-barred against violence. Conclusion (Expert Group): the State owed these rights even if Naxalites did not exist.

CASE STUDY: SALWA JUDUM (2005, CHHATTISGARH)

Salwa Judum

→ "Peace March / Purification Hunt" (Gondi); state-backed vigilantes, successor to ***Jan Jagran Abhiyan 1991***; mining ties alleged

→ ***Impact:*** 600+ villages burned, ~300,000 displaced, 98 SPOs and up to 800 killed; Darbha Ghat massacre

→ ***Nandini Sundar v. State of Chhattisgarh:*** excessive delegation in Chhattisgarh Police Act 2007; SPOs in combat with only 25 h law + 12 h Constitution training; honorarium → ***Art. 14***; endangered lives → ***Art. 21***

FIFTH SCHEDULE: NON-IMPLEMENTATION (PYQ 2013 · Art. 244)

STAR — the guiding ***star*** of tribal governance: **S**pecial provisions · **T**ribes Advisory Council · **A**dministration of Scheduled Areas · **R**eports to the President

Provisions

→ ***Administration:*** President declares area after consulting Governor; ***Governor regulates land transfer, allotment, money-lending*** for STs

→ ***TAC:*** up to 20 members, ¾ ST; advises on welfare

→ ***Special:*** Governor can bar or modify any Act in Scheduled Areas

→ ***Reports:*** Governor reports annually; Union ensures implementation

Failures

→ Tribal-majority areas without Fifth Schedule status; laws extended routinely; Governor's office lacks capacity

→ ***Land alienation:*** MP Land Regulation 1959 allows transfer to non-tribals; Chhattisgarh acquisition on small loan default; Rajasthan: district can overturn Gram Sabha

→ Reports casual (***Mungekar***); AP, MP sent none 1999–2000; Maharashtra, Orissa from 2000–01 (***Bhuria***); no TAC discussed land alienation 2005–11

Quote Mungekar and Xaxa (teacher, slide 15): "particularisation, not generalisation; discretion, not rule by rote." ***PESA is "indicative" (ARC II)*** — works only if States amend Panchayati Raj Acts. Failure creates a ***governance vacuum Maoists fill.***

PESA status (Mar 2026): Fifth Schedule areas in ***10 States***; 9 have framed PESA Rules, Odisha only draft; MoPR has 10 PESA indicators; Jharkhand PESA Rules 2025.

WOMEN IN THE RED CORRIDOR

Women

→ ***Appeal:*** all-women squads (***KAMS***) vs forced marriage, abduction, domestic violence, police brutality; NCRB 2019: 84,938 crimes in AP, Chh, Jharkhand, MP, Odisha

→ ***Problems:*** 35–40% of members but 1 of 20 in central committee; no menstrual hygiene; anaemia; forced vasectomy/abortion; sexual exploitation

→ ***Way forward:*** gender-sensitive alternatives to cadre life; diminish motivations, don't demean them

FOREST POLICY & THE FOREST RIGHTS ACT (PYQ 2015)

TURF — who holds the ***turf*** (FRA 2006 rights): **T**itle (max 4 ha) · **U**se (MFP, grazing) · **R**elief & development · **F**orest management

FRA 2006

→ Historical injustice (British 1865–1894, ***IFA 1927, FCA 1980***) → course correction (***BK Roy Burman***, FRA)

→ ***FDST + OTFD*** (3 generations / 75 years before 13 Dec 2005); ***Gram Sabha initiates*** → SDM Committee → District Committee; free informed consent for National Parks/Sanctuaries

→ ***Issues:*** vague terms; FCR 2022 needs no Gram Sabha consent at preliminary stage; ***only 40% claims accepted***; Forest Dept resists CFR; rejections without appeal; women named in <10% titles

Teacher's Gadchiroli triangle: infrastructure development vs recognition of ***CFR*** vs rehabilitation of surrendered Naxals.

2026 FRAMEWORK, EMERGING ISSUES & VALUE ADDITION (PYQ 2022 · 2025)

Emerging issues

→ ***Adivasi paradox*** (between Maoists and police raids)
→ ***Urban Naxalism***; dissent vs terrorism (UAPA vs Jal-Jangal-Zameen activists)
→ Development trap in mineral lands; weak grassroots institutions

Way forward

→ ***Conflict transformation*** (PMRDF, fast-track undertrials)
→ ***Gram Sabha controls MFP*** via Van Dhan Vikas Kendras; Odisha ***SETU*** model (Malkangiri)
→ Local police replace CAPF (like Greyhounds)

Keywords: soft-power approach · Maoism survives in ***security vacuums*** · political legitimacy deficit · radicalisation pathways · insurgency as development failure · ideological anachronism (1920s Marxism) · penetration-integration gap.

Urban Naxalism and law: PM: "vanishing from jungles but taking roots in urban centres"; 4 LWE special courts in Chhattisgarh; ***Maharashtra Special Public Security Bill 2024*** — vague "unlawful activity", no legal vetting.

PYQ	Skeleton
2013 · 10 · Fifth Schedule	Art. 244 + PESA → land alienation, tokenistic TAC, casual Governor reports → governance vacuum → Samatha
2015 · 12.5 · Displacement	40% displaced → FRA/CFR, PESA, clear-hold-develop, 3C, surrender, SETU
2018 · 10 · GoI approach	State subjects → National Policy 2015; security + development + rights
2020 · 15 · Determinants	PLEDGES → roles of GoI, administration, forces
2022 · 15 · Emerging issues	Not merely law and order → urban Naxalism, Adivasi paradox → ARC II layers + NAXALISM
2025 · 10 · Eliminate by 2026	Definition → displacement, FRA, women, Salwa Judum → Naxal Mukt Bharat, SAMADHAN

Recall drill: cover and answer

1969 CPI(ML) leader?	Charu Majumdar
2004 merger?	PU + MCC + PWG → CPI-Maoist
PLEDGES — expand	Police repression, Land, Economic, Displacement, Governance, Empowerment, Social exclusion
TURF rights?	Title, Use, Relief, Forest management
Court case on SPOs?	Nandini Sundar v. State of Chhattisgarh
Surrender money?	₹5 lakh / ₹2.5 lakh + ₹10,000 pm
Legacy & Thrust districts?	38 (13 in Chhattisgarh)

Urban Naxals and MSPC Act 2024

PYQ LWE emerging issues (2022)

✎ *"Urban Naxals" = alleged intellectual and logistical support network in cities. Maharashtra's Special Public Security Bill 2024 targets such fronts, with a broader definition than UAPA.*

Urban Naxals (as alleged)

→ ***Ideological support*** to urban middle class, students
→ ***Logistical support***: funds, shelter, communication
→ ***Recruitment*** of urban youth and intellectuals

MSPC Bill 2024

→ ***Why:*** Naxalism spreading to cities via ***front organisations***; existing laws inadequate; similar Acts in Chhattisgarh, Telangana, AP, Odisha (***48 front organisations banned***)
→ ***Powers:*** declare organisation ***unlawful***; 4 offences — membership, raising funds, managing/assisting, committing unlawful activity
→ ***Penalties:*** 2–7 years, fine ₹2–5 lakh; ***cognizable and non-bailable***
→ ***"Unlawful activity"***: threat to public order; interfering with administration of law; overawing public servants; propagating violence; ***encouraging disobedience***; using firearms/explosives; disrupting transport

Aspect	UAPA 1967	MSPC Bill 2024
Confirmation	Tribunal headed by ***High Court judge***	***Advisory Board*** of 3 (HC judge + retired District Judge + HC Government Pleader)
Threshold	Cession, secession, sovereignty — settled interpretations	***Lower threshold***, broad: any threat to public order

Value addition: vague "unlawful activity" and an executive-influenced board risk chilling ***dissent***; answer with ***proportionality*** and Art. 19 safeguards.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Penalty range in MSPC?	2–7 years; ₹2–5 lakh
Review body difference?	UAPA Tribunal (HC judge) vs MSPC Advisory Board (3)

North East Insurgency

PYQ 2017 (10) · 2025 (15)

✎ *Northeast = 98% international border, 200+ ethnic groups. Insurgency grew from secession, identity, migration and neglect; fell sharply since 2014 via accords and development.*

North East Insurgency = the many armed conflicts and movements in the region, rooted in long-standing grievances over ***political representation, economic development and cultural preservation***.

Fact	Detail
Borders	About **98%** of NE borders are international
Share	**8%** of India's area, **~4%** of population; **200+** ethnic groups
Trend	Incidents **824 (2014) → 294 (2024)**, −64%; SF deaths −85%, civilian −86%
2025 (to 30 Nov)	143 incidents · 5 civilian · 2 SF deaths
2023-24 rise	Due to ***ethnic strife in Manipur***

Typology of conflict

→ ***Asymmetrical***, ambiguous (friend vs enemy unclear), unconventional (political + psychological means), tends to ***wars of attrition***

→ Where State fails to give security → ***private ethnic militia***; Army seen as partisan

CAUSES OF INSURGENCY (PYQ 2017)

Secession & statehood

→ ***Naga*** insurgency (peak 1956): ***NNC*** sought secession; radicals formed ***Federal Government of Nagaland*** + Naga Army

→ ***Manipur*** merger seen as involuntary; Nagaland statehood 1963 by violence; foreign support from East Pakistan and China

Cultural & development

→ ***Assamese made official language 1960*** ignoring Mizo → ***MNF*** (Laldenga, 1966)

→ ***Refinery Movement*** 1956-57 (Barauni, not Assam)

→ Uneven industrialisation, limited private investment, poor market access

Demography & migration

→ ***Tripura 1980s***: migrants from East Bengal/Bangladesh pushed Tripuris to hills

→ ***Assam Movement 1979-85*** (AASU, AAGSP) → ***Assam Accord 1985***

Governance & neglect

→ Mizoram: ***Mautam famine*** — Centre failed to help → militancy; statehood 1987

→ ***Nido Tania 2014*** death → feeling of neglect → ***Bezbaruah Committee***

Ethnic & external

→ ***Manipur: Kuki vs Meitei***

→ ***ULFA, NDFB*** camps in Bhutan → Royal Bhutan Army ***Operation All Clear***

INITIATIVES (PYQ 2025)

Security

→ ***CAPFs*** deployed · ***SRE*** reimbursement · state police modernisation · ***India Reserve Battalions***

→ ***UAPA 1967***: 16 NE groups unlawful/terrorist

→ ***SoO/MoS***: tripartite SoO with ***UPF + KNO (Manipur)***, 4 Sep 2025, valid to 3 Sep 2026

→ Op ***All Clear*** (Bhutan) · Op ***Sunrise*** (Myanmar) · border fencing and regulation

Rehabilitation

→ ***Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation Scheme***; ***Civic Action Programme***; Helicopter Subsidy Scheme

Special packages	Amount
Bodo Accord 2020	₹1,500 cr
Karbi Anglong 2021	₹1,000 cr / 5 yrs
Adivasi groups 2022	₹1,000 cr / 5 yrs
DNLA/DPSC 2023	₹1,000 cr / 5 yrs (NC Hills + Dimasa areas)

Infrastructure & development

→ **NLCPR** (10% of GBS to NER) · **NESIDS** · **HADP** (Tamenglong) · **NERSDS** roads
→ **PM-DevINE** ₹6,600 cr (48 projects sanctioned) · SIDF · Aspirational Districts
→ **Vibrant Villages** I (northern border) and II (other land borders, ₹6,839 cr to 2028-29)

ARC II SOLUTIONS

Area	Key recommendations
Administration	Officers serve outside NE; more incentives; regional training via NEC; regional cadres for technical posts
Police	Upgrade **NEPA**; exchange NE police ↔ CAPFs
Local governance	**Sixth Schedule**: State Finance + Election Commissions for councils; review Meghalaya; amend Para 14; village bodies; codify customary law; Sixth Schedule hills of Manipur
Regional (NEC)	Amend **NEC Act 1971** (conflict resolution); link with MHA; **10-year perspective plan**; NEHU, NEIGRIHMS
Misc	**Act East through NE**: Kaladan Multi-Modal, India-Myanmar-Thailand Highway; rail, banks, land records

RECENT PEACE ACCORDS (PYQ 2025: map them)

Year	Accord	Key point
2019	**NLFT-SD** (Tripura)	₹100 cr package
2020	**Bru**	6,935 families (37,584 persons) rehabilitated in Tripura, ₹793.65 cr
2020	**Bodo**	₹1,500 cr; 1,615 NDFB cadres surrendered
2021	**Karbi**	1,926 cadres; Assam integrity
2022	**Tribal Peace** (8 groups)	1,182 surrendered (tea-garden workers)
2022	**Assam-Meghalaya** boundary	6 of 12 areas resolved
2023	**Assam-Arunachal** boundary	123 villages, final
2023	**DNLA**	181 cadres; ₹1,000 cr
2023	**UNLF** (Manipur)	First valley-based group to renounce violence
2023	**ULFA**	₹5,000 cr package
2024	**TIPRA**	Land, political rights; Joint Working Group
2024	**NLFT-ATTF**	4 Sep 2024; ₹250 cr
2026	**Eastern Nagaland**	5 Feb 2026; Frontier Nagaland Territorial Authority, 6 districts, 46 subjects

RESOLVED — (handout's own) **R**esolution via negotiations · **E**conomic development & empowerment · **S**ecuring international collaboration · **O**pening institutional structure (NE councils) · **L**aw and order (CAPFs, AFSPA) · **V**aluing administrative efficiency · **E**volving strategies for all stakeholders · **D**evelopment-oriented security forces (Civic Action)

Recall drill: cover and answer

% of NE borders that are international?	98%
Incidents 2014 → 2024?	824 → 294
Operation by Royal Bhutan Army?	All Clear
Bodo Accord year and package?	2020 · ₹1,500 cr
First valley-based group to renounce violence?	UNLF 2023
RESOLVED — what is "L"?	Law and order

Manipur Conflict

PYQ Part of NE questions; ethnic conflict

✎ *May 2023 Meitei-Kuki ethnic violence began after the ST-status order; hill-valley divide, land, identity and Myanmar border feed it. President's Rule 2025, government restored Feb 2026.*

RECENT CONTEXT

Where things stand

→ **Free movement:** Sept 2025, Kuki-Zo Council agreed to reopen **NH-02**
→ **President's Rule** imposed **13 Feb 2025** (CM resigned); government restored **4 Feb 2026 – Yumnam Khemchand Singh** CM with two Deputy CMs
→ **Weapons:** looted from State armouries; disarmament central to response
→ **SoO renewed 4 Sep 2025** (KNO + UPF): territorial integrity reaffirmed, camps relocated and reduced, weapons nearer CAPF camps, stricter verification
→ **21 Jul 2026:** 46 cadres of KCP (People's War Group) surrendered

Data source	Number
MHA, Apr 2025	**260 killed**; no fresh deaths in 4 months
IDMC 2024	**~67,000** displaced in 2023 (almost all in South Asia)
MHA relief	₹247.26 cr (2023-24), ₹349.48 cr (2024-25)
Parliamentary Committee 2026	Women and children long in relief camps; needs nutrition, shelter, psychosocial support

Background: since the 1960s militant groups claim to represent ethnic communities; **Kukis and Nagas** seek separate homelands vs Meiteis defending **territorial integrity**. Long **Myanmar border** (ungoverned) and cross-border ethnic ties compound it.

CAUSES OF THE CONFLICT

Trigger

→ **27 Mar 2023** Manipur HC directed State to act on Meitei **ST inclusion**; **Tribal Solidarity March 3 May 2023** → violence
→ **Feb 2024** HC deleted para 17(iii): ST inclusion must follow **Article 342** procedure

Contestation over indigeneity

→ Competing narratives (Meitei, Naga, Kuki-Zo) on settlement, homeland
→ **Migration anxiety**: Chin migration after **2021 Myanmar coup**; Kuki-Zo reject "outsider" label
→ Result: migration, land, citizenship become **existential ethnic-security** issues

Territory & land

→ Kuki-Zo demand **separate administration**; SoO 2025 reiterates integrity
→ **Land:** Meiteis cannot buy land in Kuki/Naga areas; ST status would give access → Nagas, Kukis fear Meitei monopoly

Hill-valley divide	Status
Development	Valley-centric, benefits Meiteis
Representation	Hills ~40% population but **19 seats**; Meiteis 50% hold **40 seats**
Governance deficit	Insurgents run parallel governance; weak decentralisation
ADCs	**Art. 371C + District Council Act 1971**: six councils with limited powers
Autonomy	Demand **Sixth Schedule** for hills; recommended by NCRWC (Mar 2002)

Illegal immigration, drugs, economy

→ **Meitei view:** Chin migration threatens demographic balance
→ **Kuki view:** accusations are majoritarian marginalisation
→ **Economic:** dumping of Chinese goods; poppy cultivation and drug trade (linked by some to Kukis)

MANIPUR — (handout's own way forward) **M**eaningful dialogue · **A**ddressing violence (disarm) · **N**ew political representation · **I**nterrogate land ownership · **P**olitical will · **U**niform governance (decentralise) · **R**einforce fraternity

Conclusion: meaningful dialogue must precede confidence-building; State government's ***political will*** is key.

NEW ULFA PEACE ACCORD (29 Dec 2023)

ULFA accord

→ Signed in New Delhi: ***pro-talks faction (Arabinda Rajkhowa)*** + Centre + Assam; ***852 cadres*** surrendered; disbanded ***23 Jan 2024***

→ ***₹5,000 cr*** package (₹3,000 cr Centre + ₹2,000 cr Assam); ***97 of 126 seats*** reserved for indigenous people at delimitation; ***AFSPA lifted from 85% of Assam***

Unresolved

→ ***ULFA (Independent)*** under ***Paresh Baruah*** outside; UAPA Tribunal 2025 recognised two factions

→ Myanmar bases enable infiltration, extortion

Recall drill: cover and answer

Date of ST order and violence?	27 Mar 2023; 3 May 2023
President's Rule imposed?	13 Feb 2025
Hill vs valley seats?	19 vs 40
MANIPUR "I"?	Interrogate land ownership
ULFA package?	₹5,000 cr

Jammu and Kashmir

PYQ 2019 (10) · 2023 (10)

✎ *J&K militancy moved from indigenous political alienation to externally driven terror. Violence is at historic lows after Art. 370 removal, but infiltration, Pir Panjal and soft targets remain.*

Intro: J&K security evolved from cross-border terrorism + indigenous militancy + political alienation into an ***increasingly externally driven*** challenge. Declining: violence, local recruitment, street disturbances. Persisting: ***infiltration, foreign terrorists, proxy outfits, narco-terror finance, soft-target attacks.***

RECENT TRENDS

Pahalgam attack, 22 Apr 2025: 26 killed (25 Indians + 1 Nepali). ***Operation Sindoor*** 6–7 May 2025: 9 terror camps in Pakistan and PoJK targeted. ***2024 Assembly election:*** turnout ***63.88%*** (LS ~58.6%); ***Omar Abdullah CM*** 16 Oct 2024. ***Pir Panjal / Poonch-Rajouri*** activated as proxy theatre in 2023–24.

Indicator	2018	Latest
Terrorist-initiated incidents	228	***12*** (2025)
Civilian fatalities	55	28 (2025)
SF fatalities	91	16 (2025)
Stone-pelting		near-zero since 2022
Organised strikes	52	zero 2023–Apr 2026
Tourists		2.3 crore in 2024 (record)

DRIVERS OF MILITANCY

Political → Unfulfilled ***autonomy / self-determination*** aspirations; instability; ***1987 election rigging***; human-rights abuse allegations

Socio-economic → Marginalisation, poverty, weak education/skills, corruption, little industrialisation → radicalisation of youth

Historical → Partition legacy; ***Plebiscite Front*** (1950s); 1990s insurgency
→ ***1971 war*** → Pakistan's ***Zia doctrine*** (asymmetric warfare, "bleed India with 1000 cuts"); ***Kargil 1999*** reinforced

External → ***Mujahideen*** after Soviet invasion of Afghanistan; ***ISI*** role (FBI 2011 court admission); proxy warfare; geostrategic importance
→ ***Virtual groups:*** The Resistance Front (LeT front), ***PAFF*** (JeM proxy); asymmetric warfare

Identity → Muslim-majority State in Hindu-majority nation; ***99 acres forest land*** transfer for pilgrim shelters heightened alienation

GOVERNMENT STRATEGY (PYQ 2019 · 2023)

Three goals → Safeguard borders and contain militancy · sustain democratic process, restore civil primacy · sustain peace process with opportunities for those who shun violence

Security → ***SRE Scheme*** · ***SPOs*** · ***Village Defence Guards*** · subsidised helicopter · ***5 IR + 2 Border + 2 Women battalions*** for J&K Police

Rehabilitation → Ex-militant rehabilitation · ***RDP*** (displaced persons) · ***Safe Passage and Surrender Policy***

Hearts & minds (PYQ 2023) → ***Awaam Ki Awaz*** · ***Operation Sadbhavana*** · ***School Outreach*** · Civic Action · Bharat Darshan tours · Nasha Mukt Bharat · Youth Volunteer Programme

Development → ***PMDP 2015***: ~63 projects ~₹80,000 cr (53 completed, >₹51,000 cr invested) · ***NCSS*** ₹28,400 cr · ***Back to Village*** · ***Industrial Policy 2021-30*** · AB-PMJAY-SEHAT · Mission Indradhanush · Himayat · Udaan · SKEWPY

KASHMIR — (handout's own) ***K*** Kashmiri Pandits & IDPs rehabilitate · ***A*** cases against terrorists · ***S*** Sufism and Kashmiriyat · ***H*** humane counter-terror · ***M*** manage public perception (media) · ***I*** issues and grievances · ***R*** rehabilitation of surrendered militants · ***R*** reconstruction

ARTICLE 370 REMOVAL

Step	Detail
Art. 370 / 35A	Special status; 35A (1954 order): permanent-resident rules, property; women marrying outside lost rights (HC 2002 protected)
5 Aug 2019	Presidential Order under 370(1), superseded 1954 order; Statutory Resolution in RS
J&K Reorganisation Act 2019	Two UTs: ***J&K (with Assembly)*** and ***Ladakh (without)***
6 Aug 2019	Lok Sabha passed; ***C.O. 273*** — all clauses of 370 inoperative except clause 1

After 370 (value addition)

→ ***SC verdict*** upheld: "Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat"

→ All central laws apply; ***3-tier Panchayati Raj***, BDC elections; Saubhagya, Ujjwala saturation; ODF Plus

→ Pre-2019 per capita income less than half of Himachal; govt spending >50% of GSDP; new land laws aid investment

→ Tourism boom (2 crore+), cinema returned, hartal/stone-pelting gone; "Azadi" sentiment receding; ***AFSPA/PSA*** remain until full normalisation

Slide keywords: Insaniyat, Jamhooriyat, Kashmiriyat (Atal ji); "from disillusionment, disappointment, despondency to ***development, democracy, dignity***".

PYQ	Skeleton
2019 · 10 · OGWs	Define OGW (over-ground workers: logistics, shelter, intel, funds) → Jamaat-e-Islami ban → measures: UAPA, PSA, financial action, counter-radicalisation, community policing
2023 · 10 · Hearts and minds	Back to Village, Sadbhavana, Awaam Ki Awaz, youth schemes, PMDP, rehabilitation → trust through development + civil primacy

Recall drill: cover and answer

Pahalgam attack date/toll?	22 Apr 2025; 26 killed
Terror incidents 2018 → 2025?	228 → 12
J&K reorganisation → UTs?	J&K (Assembly) and Ladakh (no Assembly)
KASHMIR "S"?	Sufism and Kashmiriyat
PMDP outlay?	~₹80,000 cr

AFSPA

PYQ 2015 (12.5)

✎ *AFSPA gives armed forces special powers in "disturbed areas": shoot, arrest, search, with immunity. Supreme Court upheld it in 1998 but demands review every six months.*

AFSPA 1958: Act of Parliament giving armed forces special powers to maintain public order in "**disturbed areas**".

History

→ **1942 Ordinance** to suppress Quit India
→ **1947** Bill by Baldev Singh (called "black bill")
→ **1958** Act first for **Naga Hills** (Assam); **1972 amendment**: Centre also may declare disturbed area

Section	Provision
3	Governor or Centre declares **disturbed area**
4(a)	Use force, even lethal, against law-breakers
4(b)	Destroy arms dumps, fortified positions
4(c)	**Arrest without warrant**
4(d)	**Search without warrant**
5	Hand arrested persons to **nearest police station** with least delay
6	**Immunity**: prosecution needs Centre's sanction

Disturbed area

→ Declared by notification under **S.3** for disputes between religious, racial, language, regional groups, castes or communities
→ No automatic 3-month duration; **Naga People's Movement**: must be **reviewed within six months**

AFSPA footprint 2026: Assam Tinsukia, Charaideo, Sivasagar (from 1 Apr 2026, 6 months) · **Arunachal** Tirap, Changlang, Longding + parts of Namsai · **Nagaland** 9 districts + 5 districts partly · **Manipur** whole State except 13 police-station areas.

Case	Principle
Inderjit Barua (Delhi HC 1983)	Governor's power not arbitrary; needs guidelines
Naga People's Movement (SC 1998)	**Upheld** constitutionality; S.4, 5 not arbitrary; periodic review within 6 months
Luithukia v. Rishang Keishing (1988)	Forces act **with district administration**, not independently
Horendi Gogoi (1991)	Hand over arrested persons to police without delay

ANALYSIS

Centre-State

→ Governor **or** Centre declares → friction; Nagaland says not disturbed, Centre overrides
→ **J&K 2009-15**: tried to withdraw from Srinagar, Budgam etc.; Army opposed

Operational

→ Operational autonomy bypasses state police
→ No mandated periodic review → prolonged application
→ **Immunity** → accountability and human-rights concerns (Manipur, J&K)

Utility

→ **Army manages SoO camps** (prevents extortion, clashes)
→ **Operation Sadbhavana** (J&K civic programme)
→ Maintains public order; empowers forces; **upheld by SC**

Answer line (2015 PYQ): oppose S.4 and S.6 (immunity) → SC in ***Naga People's Movement*** upheld but asked ***review every 6 months***; balance security with rights.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Which sections do activists oppose?	S.4 (lethal force, arrest/search) and S.6 (immunity)
SC case 1998?	Naga People's Movement of Human Rights
Review period?	Six months
1972 amendment?	Centre can also declare disturbed area

Central Armed Police Forces (CAPF)

PYQ Security forces and agencies (mandate)

✎ *Seven forces under MHA (~9.64 lakh personnel) guard borders, fight insurgency, protect infrastructure and respond to terror.*

CAPFs = uniformed forces under the **Ministry of Home Affairs** for internal security, law and order, counter-insurgency, disaster relief and protecting vital installations. Strength **~9,64,000** (≈80% of Army).

CABINS — Force list: **C**RPF · **A**ssam Rifles · **B**SF · **I**TBP · **N**SG · **S**SB (+ **C**ISF) — "**CABINS**" for the cabins of internal security

Force	Key facts
Assam Rifles	1835 Cachar Levy → AR 1917; **Indo-Myanmar border** (1,643 km) + NE counter-insurgency; Army officers lead
CRPF	Crown Representative Force 1939 → CRPF 1949; **largest** (~3.13 lakh, 246 bn); **RAF**, **COBRA**
ITBP	1962; ~89,000, 60 bn; **3,488 km** Karakoram Pass to Jachep La; 9,000–18,700 ft; Water Wing
BSF	1965; 2.5 lakh, 186 bn; Indo-Pak and Indo-Bangladesh (**6,386 km**) + parts of LoC; world's largest border guard
CISF	~1.45 lakh; industrial units, Delhi Metro, VIP security, Fire Wing
NSG	**1984**; ~7,000; counter-hijack, bomb disposal, hostage rescue; hubs Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad; modelled on GSG 9 and SAS
SSB	Special Service Bureau until 2001; border force post-Kargil; **Indo-Nepal 1,751 km** and **Indo-Bhutan 699 km**

ISSUES WITH CAPF

Resources & welfare

→ **~98%** of allocation is revenue expenditure (salaries etc.)
→ **~9,000** leave yearly (housing, stress, leave); ~98% of training companies diverted
→ **700 suicides (2000–18)**; 2021: 48 suicides, 13 fratricides; heart ailments

Duties & mandate

→ **Diversion** from border/CI to law and order (Kargil Review Committee); States prefer CAPFs (cheaper)
→ **Role confusion**: BSF used for law and order unarmed
→ **Strain on COBRA, RAF**; remote terrain (ITBP cold)

Legal & coordination

→ CAPF Acts: no external **judicial oversight**; need **security force courts**
→ Lack of integration with military and state police

ROLE OF CAPF & WAY FORWARD

Role

→ **AR** Myanmar border; **BSF**: Punjab 2,086 kg heroin = **58%** of India's 3,567 kg (NCB), anti-narcotics with ANTF
→ **NSG** quick response; **CRPF** camps in Sukma, Bijapur; **241 Bastariya Battalion**; **ITBP** mountain rescue; **CISF** infrastructure
→ **UN missions**; IPS leadership (Punjab, Greyhounds)

Modernisation & welfare

→ **Modernisation Plan IV** (1 Feb 2022–31 Mar 2026): **₹1,523 cr** — firearms, UAVs, mine-protected vehicles, comms
→ PM scholarship, medical-college reservation; leave policy; **Chaupal** meetings; yoga; **Phalnikar 2016 study**

Way forward

→ Tech for ***riverine belt*** in Punjab (UAV, thermal imagers); shorter modernisation cycles; local-context equipment; ***AR withdrawal from Myanmar border*** and CAPF redeployment; community engagement (Bastariya model)

CISF took over Parliament security (May 2024) after the ***Dec 2023 breach***, replacing Delhi Police outer access control; Parliament Security Service (since ***1929***, after Bhagat Singh-Dutt bomb) remains; ***Art. 98*** — each House has own secretariat; ***P.D.T. Achary*** objects; 13 Dec 2001 martyrs ***Matbar Singh Negi, Jagdish Prasad Yadav***.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Largest CAPF?	CRPF
Border length guarded by BSF?	6,386 km
NSG founded?	1984
Modernisation Plan IV outlay?	₹1,523 cr

Border Management: Challenges, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Nepal

PYQ 2013, 2016, 2019, 2020 (x2), 2024

✎ *Seven land neighbours, difficult terrain, porous borders and many forces. Each border has its own crime pattern and its own guarding force.*

Data (Dec 2025): Bangladesh border **4,096.7 km**, fenced **3,239.92 km = 79.08%**. Pakistan IB **2,289.66 km** under fencing programme, fenced **2,135.136 km = 93.25%**. **2024 infiltration attempts:** Bangladesh 977 · Pakistan 41 · Myanmar 37 · Nepal-Bhutan 23. (Note: handout also quotes sanctioned length 4,223.04 km and 3,232.218 km fenced as of Feb 2025 — different dates.)

Border management = securing borders against hostile interests while **facilitating legitimate trade**; integrates administrative, diplomatic, security, intelligence, legal, regulatory and economic agencies, and builds border infrastructure. Land neighbours: **Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Afghanistan**.

National Border Policy needed — treat border as **national security**, not law and order. BSF jurisdiction raised **15 km → 50 km**. "What enters through the border permeates the hinterland like a virus through the bloodstream."

BROAD CHALLENGES

Border challenges

→ **Terrain:** Rajasthan desert · Gujarat swamp (Rann) · Ladakh cold desert · J&K snow mountains
→ **Porosity:** ethnic communities straddle the border; infiltration; inadequate fencing
→ **Under-resourced forces:** weak training/equipment, bureaucratisation, manpower shortage, dual-force dilemma (army + police)
→ **Poor infrastructure:** BOPs without electricity
→ **Weak intelligence** sharing; **many agencies**, different reporting lines

Border	Guarding force
Bangladesh	**BSF**
China	**ITBP** (LAC: **Army**)
Myanmar	**Assam Rifles**
Nepal and Bhutan	**SSB**
Pakistan (IB)	**BSF**
Pakistan (LoC)	**Army**

INDIA-BANGLADESH BORDER

Profile

→ **4,096.7 km**, 5 States (WB, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram); plains, rivers, hills, jungle; dense population and cultivation up to the line
→ **Challenges:** FICN, arms, narcotics; human trafficking; radicalism; **cattle smuggling (>20 lakh/yr)**; engineered demographic change; WB 2,216.7 km, 1,647.696 fenced, 569.004 unfenced

Measures

→ **Non-lethal weapons** (rubber bullets) for zero border killings
→ **162 enclaves exchanged** (2015) — residents chose citizenship
→ **1,096 BOPs**; fencing + floodlights; **BOLD-QIT** (sensors, radars, automation); July 2026 MHA reviewed radio fence-breach detection and infrared alarms for rivers/gaps (smart border); **LCTS** 281 km

INDIA-MYANMAR BORDER

Profile and fencing

→ ***1,643 km***: Arunachal, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram; ***1,472 km demarcated***; ~186 pillars; Parva Salient (Mizoram) difficult

→ Fencing: ***BRO*** at Moreh; Dec 2025: 9.214 km done; ***July 2026: programme for ~1,610 km, ~₹31,000 cr***; smart fence 100 km; critics: fencing even if only 70% effective = success

→ Manpower: ***Assam Rifles*** do border + counter-insurgency — should it only guard?

Free Movement Regime (FMR) — 2018 (Act East): ***16 km*** visa-free, border pass 1 yr for 2-week stays; British demarcation of ***1826*** split Naga/Mizo/Chin people. ***Government decided to fence entire border and scrap FMR.***

Why scrap FMR	Challenges in scrapping
Insurgents cross easily	Nagaland/Mizoram ***ethnic and topographic ties***
Golden Triangle drugs (opium)	***Nagalim*** aspirations; colonial borders
Refugees: Manipur conflict, Tatmadaw vs rebels; Mizo acceptance	Trade, healthcare, education access; Aadhaar issues
Assam, Arunachal, Manipur support scrapping	A 10-km Manipur fence took a decade; NER alienation; Act East harmed

Value addition: balance security with ***ethnic realities*** — fence + regulated border passes + development, not blanket closure.

INDIA-NEPAL BORDER

Profile and issues

→ ***1,751 km***: Uttarakhand, UP, Bihar, WB, Sikkim; open border; ***539 BOPs***; ***1,299 km*** roads sanctioned; ***JWG*** on border management

→ LeT, IM, NE insurgents use it: cadres, ***FICN***, terror financing via Nepali banks, arms, narcotics; Maoist links; land grabbing

Map dispute

→ ***2020*** Nepal map claims ***Kalapani, Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura*** (after India's road); constitutional amendment June 2020; India: unilateral, integral part of India; dialogue via diplomatic platform

→ ***China angle:*** 2015 ***134-day blockade*** → Oli signs ***trade and transit agreement with China***; leftist parties near CCP; Chinese disinformation (Prachanda's visit 2023)

Recall drill: cover and answer

SSB guards which borders?	Nepal and Bhutan
FMR range?	16 km
Enclaves exchanged?	162 (2015)
Nepal map dispute areas?	Kalapani, Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura

Smart Border and Border Area Development (BADP, VVP, BIM)

PYQ 2024 (BADP + BIM), 2020 (local support)

✎ *Fences are only half the answer: surveillance technology plus development and trust in border villages complete the system.*

Multi-pronged approach

→ **Surveillance:** BOP, **ICP**, thermal imagers, night vision, CCTV/PTZ, infrared sensors, UAVs, radars

→ **Intelligence:** upgrade; joint border management

→ **Security:** fencing; **floating BOPs** in rivers; **CIBMS** (integrates manpower, sensors, networks, command-control)

Development of border areas

→ **BADP** · **BIM** scheme · **NERIDS** (NE infrastructure) · **Project Vartak** (Arunachal roads) · **Arunank** (4 roads, 255 km)

→ **Community-led: Vibrant Villages**; climate of trust; local employment; **civic action — Operation Sadbhavana**, Army Goodwill Schools

BADP

BADP — Core Centrally Sponsored Scheme of **Dept of Border Management, MHA**; **460 border blocks, 117 districts, 16 States + 2 UTs**; applies to habitations **0–10 km** (aerial) from IB; works: roads, bridges, drinking water, health, agriculture, social infrastructure.

Region	Centre : State
8 NE States + HP + Uttarakhand	**90:10**
Bihar, Gujarat, Punjab, Rajasthan, UP, WB	**60:40**
UT of J&K	90:10
UT of Ladakh (no legislature)	**100% Centre**

VIBRANT VILLAGES PROGRAMME

Why

→ Counter China's **dual-use "xiaokang" villages**: 624 built in TAR 2018–22; **Land Borders Law (1 Jan 2022)**; Xinjiang–Tibet railway near Aksai Chin

→ Indian border villages: illiteracy, poor facilities, **out-migration** (2018 Parliamentary Committee)

Features

→ **VVP-I**: 662 northern-border villages (10 km); roads, housing, renewable energy

→ **VVP-II (Apr 2025):** Central Sector, 100% central funds, **₹6,839 cr to 2028-29**, **1,954 villages** on other land borders

→ Hub-and-spoke growth centres; **One Village-One Product**; tourism, cooperatives; **BISAG-N** GIS monitoring; integrated with **PM Gati Shakti**

BRO budget 2026-27: capital ₹7,394 cr (vs ₹7,146.5 cr 2025-26). **Infrastructure:** 118 projects dedicated (90 in Sept across 11 States/UTs); Shinku La tunnel (4.1 km, Dec 2025 target); **Sela twin-tube tunnel** to Tawang; DSDBO road; Nyoma airfield upgrade; Shyok bridge.

COMMUNITY IN BORDER MANAGEMENT

Why community matters

→ Mutual trust · surveillance gaps filled (fishermen guide Navy/ICG) · **CIPs** · rights protected · community policing · early detection · local terrain knowledge

Challenges

→ Weak state capacity; poor infrastructure; low pay/training; ***alienation***; anti-smuggling seen as interference; ***fencing blocks farmland***; criminals provoke confrontations; ***ad hoc cooperation***

Way forward

→ Trust frameworks; treat ***understanding the community*** as a management function; ***code of conduct***; ***replace "border guarding" with "border management"***; learn local languages; civic action (sports, grants)

2020 PYQ line: to deny local support to militants — development + dignity + grievance redress + local intelligence networks (not just force).

Recall drill: cover and answer

BADP funding for NE?	90:10
VVP-II villages and outlay?	1,954; ₹6,839 cr
Border blocks in BADP?	460 blocks, 117 districts
CIBMS stands for?	Comprehensive Integrated Border Management System

Smart Border Technology: CIBMS, BOLD-QIT, Anti-Drone Grid

PYQ Border management, technology, community role

✎ *Fences cannot cover rivers, deserts and mountains. Smart borders add sensors, drones and a command grid; border-area development and communities add the human layer.*

Smart Border Management = advanced surveillance, sensors, data networks, ***AI, drones, anti-drone systems and integrated command platforms*** to secure borders in real time. Slogan on slides: ***One Border, One Guarding Force.***

WHY IT MATTERS

Reasons

- → ***Terrain***: mountains, deserts, swamps, rivers make fencing and patrol hard
- → ***Real-time*** infiltration alerts
- → ***Anti-smuggling***: narcotics, arms, cattle, gold, fake currency, trafficking
- → ***Counter-drone*** need
- → ***Riverine*** stretches cannot be fenced (Brahmaputra)
- → ***Force multiplier*** for BSF and others
- → ***Single command platform*** across agencies
- → ***Hybrid-war*** readiness

STEPS TAKEN

Initiative	Detail
CIBMS (Comprehensive Integrated Border Management System)	Sensors, cameras, radars, command centres. Pilots ***~71 km***: 10 km Pakistan border, 61 km Bangladesh border
Smart fencing	Virtual sensor layer; pilot in ***Jammu sector*** (Pakistan border)
BOLD-QIT	Border Electronically Dominated QRT Interception Technique; cameras, sensors, optical fibre, microwave; unfenced ***Brahmaputra*** (Dhubri)
Smart Border Project 2026	Proposed: radars, cameras, drones; pilots at BSF and SSB locations
LPMS VINIMAY	Digital land-port management for cargo, passengers, vehicles
Integrated Check Posts	Customs, immigration, security under one roof (Bangladesh, Nepal borders)
AI surveillance	Pattern recognition, fewer false alarms, face recognition, predictive alerts

ANTI-DRONE MEASURES

Response

- → ***Counter-drone systems***: detect, track, identify, jam, neutralise (Pakistan border)
- → ***SAKSHAM***: Army CUAS grid
- → ***Drones for patrol*** in deserts, rivers, marshes, mountains
- → ***Layered response***: BSF, Army, intelligence, police; after recovery do payload analysis, route mapping, forensics

CHALLENGES AND WAY FORWARD

Challenges

→ Terrain; high cost; power and connectivity gaps
→ ***False alarms*** (animals, fog)
→ ***Cyber risk***: hacking, jamming, spoofing
→ Agency silos; harsh weather
→ ***Community*** livelihood worries; ***privacy and rights***

Way forward

→ ***Terrain-specific*** models
→ ***AI data fusion*** of drones, sensors, satellites, patrols, humint
→ ***Drone Wall*** on the EU model (radar, RF sensors, EO cameras, jammers, response teams)
→ Cyber-secure systems; ***unified command centre***
→ ***Village Defence Guards*** and informants
→ Indigenous technology; smart crossing points
→ ***Border Security Technology Oversight Authority*** to audit surveillance

Balanced answer: technology + manpower + community + rights safeguards. Development side (BADP, Vibrant Villages, community) is in the Smart Border and Border Area Development chapter.

Recall drill: cover and answer

CIBMS pilot length?	~71 km (10 km Pak + 61 km Bangladesh)
BOLD-QIT used where?	Unfenced Brahmaputra border, Dhubri
VINIMAY?	Land Port Management System
Drone Wall model from?	European Union

Drones and UAVs in Security; Anti-Drone Systems

PYQ Drone threats, border, terror, counter-drone

✎ *Drones are cheap eyes and weapons. Use them for surveillance and strikes; defend with detect, identify, jam and destroy layers.*

Role of drones in security

- → ***Surveillance and reconnaissance*** (Heron, Switch drones of Army and BSF)
- → ***Disaster response*** (Kerala floods 2019, Joshimath subsidence)
- → ***Crowd management*** (Kumbh Mela)
- → ***Maritime security*** (Navy Sea Guardian)
- → ***Psychological warfare***
- → ***Precision targeting; cost-efficient***

Threats

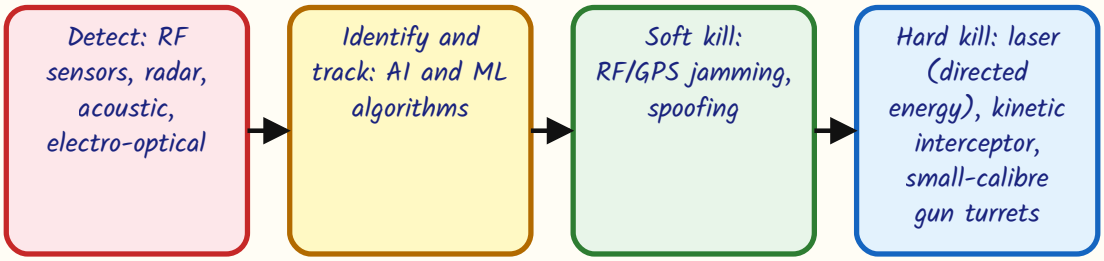
- → ***Cross-border terrorism*** and narcotics/arms drops
- → ***Attack on critical infrastructure: IAF station, Jammu (2021)***
- → ***Espionage***
- → ***Drone swarms***
- → ***Drug trafficking***

TYPES IN USE

Type	Notes and examples
ISR drones	TAPAS-BH-201, Rustom (DRDO), Heron Mk-II (Israel)
Commercial / modified	Off-the-shelf drones modified for illegal cross-border use
Swarm	Many drones coordinate to overwhelm defences; DRDO and private firms developing
Loitering munitions	Loiter, then strike: HAROP, Mini Harpy, SkyStriker and others
Armed / combat	Ghatak (DRDO, under development), Heron TP (Israel)
Target drones	ABHYAS, Lakshya
Civil / governance	SVAMITVA drones, Kisan drones, Namo Drone Didi

COUNTER-DRONE SYSTEMS

Counter-drone chain



System	Detail
Drone Rules, 2021	Legal framework
Anti-Rogue Drone Technology Committee	Under MHA
D4 System	Drone Detect, Deter, Destroy
Indrajaal	Integrated drone interdiction
DRDO Anti-Drone System	Includes laser systems
SAKSHAM	Army CUAS grid: modular C2 on Army Data Network; detects, tracks, identifies and neutralises hostile drones up to ***3,000 m***

Way forward: comprehensive ***National Counter Rogue Drone guidelines***, vulnerability assessments of installations, strengthen operational frameworks, layered coordination, indigenous technology.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Soft versus hard kill?	Soft = jam/spoof; Hard = laser or kinetic destroy
Drone attack of 2021?	IAF station, Jammu
SAKSHAM range?	Up to 3,000 m

India-Pakistan Border

PYQ 2020, 2024

✎ *3,323 km of borders: IB, LoC, AGPL. Challenges: terrorism, drones, smuggling, Sir Creek, Indus waters. Trade suspended since 2019.*

3,323 km border: Gujarat, Rajasthan, Punjab, J&K, Ladakh. Terrain: desert, marsh, snow mountains, plains. Frequent infiltration, arms and contraband smuggling.

Challenges

→ ***Terrorism and infiltration*** · ceasefire violations · arms smuggling · border disputes (***Sir Creek***) · ***drones*** · ***Indus water*** sharing · diverse terrain · time and cost overruns · drugs, FICN, arms

Measures

→ ***736 BOPs***; floodlights approved over ***2,078 km***

→ ***Fencing 93.25%*** of 2,289.66 km (Dec 2025)

→ ***CIBMS***; BSF vulnerability mapping; ***pilot***: two 5-km stretches in Jammu; ***low-cost tech*** project 484 km (Pak + Bangladesh)

TRADE (A PYQ HOOK)

Point	Detail
MFN	India gave Pakistan MFN in 1996; ***Pakistan negative list 1,209***, only ***138*** allowed via Wagah-Attari
Volume	***$2.29 bn*** (0.35% of India's trade); India surplus
Suspension	Pakistan suspended trade ***Aug 2019*** after Art. 370 abrogation; India had imposed ***200% tariff*** and revoked MFN
2021	ECC allowed cotton, yarn; Imran Khan reversed
Context	Pakistan's crises: 2022 floods, inflation, IMF; trade via Iran/Dubai; ***Attari ICP*** would open Central Asia

Answer line: border is a hybrid battle-line — fence + tech + intelligence + diplomacy; use ***BSF + ANTF + drone countermeasures*** against narco-drones in Punjab.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Fencing % at Pak IB?	93.25%
Trade suspended when?	Aug 2019
BOPs at Indo-Pak?	736

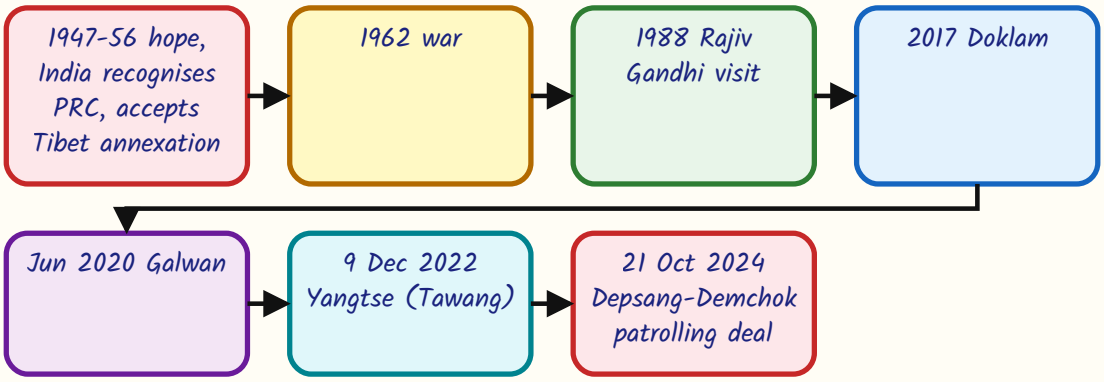
India-China Border (LAC)

PYQ 2024, 2021 (external actors)

✎ The LAC remains "stable but sensitive". Disengagement is done but not de-escalation; China builds dual-use infrastructure and encircles India diplomatically.

> "Stable but sensitive" – **Gen Manoj Pande**. EAM Jaishankar: unless the border is resolved "**you cannot expect the rest of relations to go on normally**".

Timeline



Current dynamics

→ ***No-guns within 2 km of LAC*** agreement holds

→ Talks: blockades removed at three places → ***no-patrol zones***; ***Depsang Bulge and Charding Nala (Demchok)*** were pending

→ India lost access to ***30 of 65*** patrolling points (handout; other line says China blocks 26 – conflict, verify)

→ Disengaged at ***Galwan, Pangong Tso, Gogra, PP15***; ***21 Oct 2024*** deal on Depsang and Demchok – disengagement is not a boundary settlement

Why it matters

→ "***No war, no peace***" limbo; trade deficit ~$100 bn finances PLA; China blocks India at UNSC, props Pakistan; India's hedging: economic engagement + military confrontation + diplomatic assertion – unsustainable

BUILDUP

China	India
TAR roads, rail, oil and logistic depots; defence budget ***$225 bn (2023)***; Xinjiang-Tibet railway via Aksai Chin	Poorer infrastructure; topographic advantage for air ops; since 2020 more mechanised/armoured units, ISR; ***CDS + DMA***; theatre command; ***indigenisation***
Land Borders Law 2022; 624 xiaokang villages	***VVP***; 118 BRO projects, 601 km roads/yr; ***Sela, Shinku La***; ***Project Arunank*** 255 km

ENCIRCLEMENT

China's moves

→ ***Myanmar:*** mediates ceasefire yet arms ethnic groups (dual approach)

→ ***Nepal:*** transit transport agreement; disinformation vs India

→ Pakistan (CPEC), Sri Lanka, Bangladesh, IOR presence

WAY FORWARD

India's approach

→ ***Three-fold:*** continual military dialogue · reduce economic interdependence · hold political engagement

→ Revive ***Special Representatives*** (not met for four years); hotlines; ***convert LAC to a demarcated LoC*** (jointly monitored)

→ ***Strategic autonomy***: Quad but no freedom-of-navigation ops in W. Pacific; avoid US-China rivalry; non-alignment; ***balanced public discourse***

→ C. Raja Mohan: limit economic exposure and suspend political dialogue as leverage. Chinese aphorism: ***"he who tied the knot must untie it"***

Value addition: "A state of relations depends on the state of the border." Competing with China should not distract from development; ***no permanent adversaries or allies*** — prioritise peaceful progress without neglecting defence.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Disengagement points?	Galwan, Pangong, Gogra, PP15
Date of 2024 deal?	21 Oct 2024
No-guns zone?	2 km of LAC
Land Borders Law?	1 Jan 2022

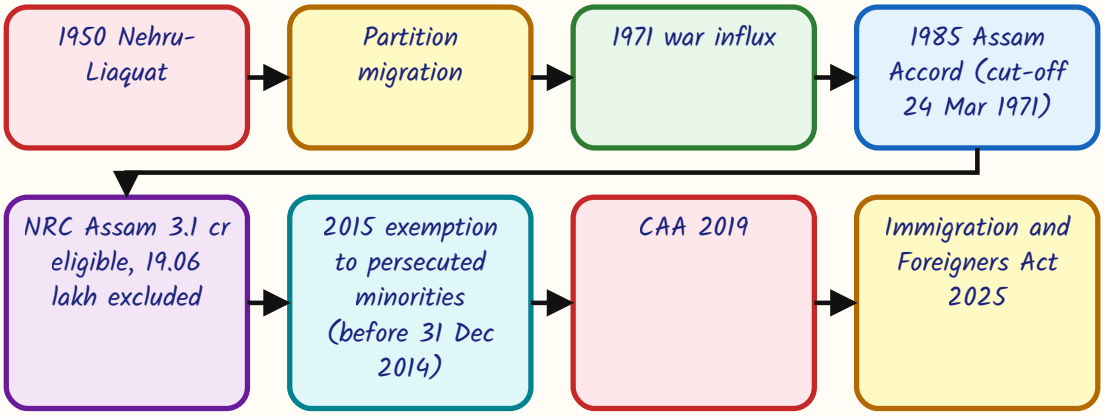
Illegal Migration

PYQ 2014 (illegal transborder migration), 2013

✎ *Migrants and refugees come from Bangladesh and Myanmar. NRC, CAA, Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025 and the Rohingya case show the legal and security dilemma.*

Data: Census 2011 — 5.5 m with last residence abroad (0.44%); 2.3 m (42%) Bangladesh, 0.7 m (12.7%) Pakistan. UNHCR: >2.4 lakh refugees/asylum seekers; **86,100 from Myanmar** incl. Rohingya; ORF 2025 estimate 12–20 m illegal Bangladeshis (estimate, treat with caution).

History



Challenges in curbing

- → **Terrain**: 174.5 km non-feasible to fence
- → **Land acquisition** (WB)
- → **Vote-bank politics**; NRC/CAA resistance and litigation
- → Manpower and equipment; coordination (BSF, AR, DRDO, CPWD)

Steps taken

- → Fence with floodlights (4,223.04 km sanctioned); **LCTS** 281 km; **CIBMS**; vulnerability mapping; patrols, nakas, anti-tunnelling; advisories to BSF and AR
- → **Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025** repeals four colonial laws (Passport (Entry into India) 1920, Registration of Foreigners 1939, Foreigners Act 1946, Immigration (Carriers' Liability) 2000)
- → **S.6A Citizenship Act**: entrants to Assam 1 Jan 1966–25 Mar 1971 could register

Myanmar-side causes

- → **1 Feb 2021 coup**, Chin refugees to Mizoram and Manipur; ethnic ties (Chin-Mizo); **Rohingya** persecution since 2017; porous terrain; economic distress

MIGRANT — **M**onitoring · **I**nternational cooperation · **G**overnance/legislation · **R**ehabilitation and reintegration · **A**wareness · **N**ational security · **T**echnology (the faculty's MIGRANT)

ROHINGYA CASE (PRIYALI SUR v UNION OF INDIA)

Petitioners	Union of India (affidavit)
Deportation violates **Art. 14, 21, 51(c)**; **non-refoulement** (customary law)	Mostly illegal entrants; **Foreigners Act 1946** applies; **Art. 19 only for citizens**
Detention is arbitrary	National security threat; porous borders; limited resources
Seek release from detention centres	Refugee status is for **legislature/executive**, not judicial overreach

Value addition: balance **humanitarian obligations (Art. 21, non-refoulement)** with security; push for a national refugee framework and graded screening.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Assam NRC excluded?	19.06 lakh
Cut-off date in Assam Accord?	24 March 1971
Which Act repealed 4 laws?	Immigration and Foreigners Act 2025
Myanmar coup date?	1 Feb 2021

Maritime and Coastal Security

PYQ 2014, 2022

✎ *A 11,098.81 km coastline, 95% of trade by volume by sea, many agencies: coastal security needs unity of command, tracking of small boats and trained coastal police.*

Data: Coastline **11,098.81 km** (mainland 7,870.51; islands 3,228.30). Maritime boundary with 7 countries. **12 major + 205 minor ports** handle **~95% trade volume / 70% value. EEZ ~23 lakh km²** (200 nm). ICG 2025: 103 SAR missions, 76 lives, 18,613 boardings, 1,594 CIPs. IB audit: **187 of 200+ minor ports** lack adequate security.

Concerns (IDSA)

→ **Fragmented approach**; no unity of command; land borders fenceable but sea sliding jurisdiction

→ **Policing vs border guarding**: policing (State List) conflated with maritime security (Union)

→ **ICG's primary duty** is maritime zones, not border guarding; **unclear statutory definitions**; Navy covers 12–200 nm

→ **Sub-20 m boats**: costly to track; risk of 26/11-type attack

Why coastal security matters

→ Creeks, estuaries, mudflats; **Sir Creek, Palk Strait** unsettled; terrorism (**26/11**, MV Nalini 2019, 2011 naval vessel attack); weak minor ports; illegal fishing; drugs/arms; sea trade, **submarine cables**; piracy; neighbours (Maldives, Sri Lanka, Pakistan); Bombay High, Kalpakkam, SEZs; fishermen straying

INITIATIVES

Type	What
Infrastructure	**JOCs, Coastal Surveillance Network, VTMS radars**; minor-port guidelines (ISPS); SPM SOP; transponders on small boats / ISRO trackers; coastal mapping by BISAG-N; **Coastal Security Scheme**
Policy	**IMSS 2015** "Ensuring Secure Seas"; SAGAR; HADR
Exercises	**Sagar Kavach, CORPATs, Sea Vigil**
Community	CIPs; **fishermen biometric ID cards**
Institutions	**National Committee for Strengthening Maritime and Coastal Security**; **NC3I**; IMAC; **IFC-IOR**; Marine Police; 10 coastal police stations; **National Academy of Coastal Policing** (Dwarka); **Joint Coastal Patrolling (15 Aug 2020)**

MARITIME — Faculty's "**MARITIME**" way forward: **M**odernisation · **A**dvanced tech · **R**egulation · **I**ntegration of agencies · **T**raining · **I**nfrastructure · **M**ulti-agency exercises · **E**ngagement of community

Current affairs: India began cooperation with **Combined Maritime Forces (CMF)**, Bahrain (counter-narcotics, anti-piracy); Navy opened **MARCOS** to women (Agniveers from 2023).

Recall drill: cover and answer

India coastline?	11,098.81 km
IMSS year?	2015
Joint Coastal Patrolling start?	15 Aug 2020
Minor ports lacking security?	187 of 200+

Piracy and Maritime Anti-Piracy Act 2022

PYQ 2014 (HRA 65E to 78E)

✎ *Piracy is rising again in the Arabian Sea. India has a legal tool (2022 Act) and a proactive Navy as net security provider.*

Data: piracy up **~20%** (Navy); war-risk premium **0.05% → 1%** of ship value ($2 m on a $200 m ship); Cape route adds ~10 days; Suez ~12–15% of world trade, traffic **–42%** (Dec 2023–Jan 2024). IMO **HRA moved 65°E to 78°E** (2010 per handout; the 2014 question says 2012); industry **rescinded HRA from 1 Jan 2023**, situation deteriorated again.

Recent incidents

→ Drone attack on Gabon-flagged tanker (25 Indian crew); **MV Chem Pluto** (21 Indian crew); **MV Ruen** seized by Somali pirates → Navy rescued 17; **Operation Sankalp**: 18 incidents in 100 days; INS Sumitra, INS Visakhapatnam

Implications

→ **Economic:** freight, insurance, supply chain, crude/LNG via Bab-el-Mandeb
→ **Security:** drones and pirates, Houthi attacks, Chinese presence

Initiative	Role
UNCLOS	Legal framework
CMF (CTF-151)	Multinational anti-piracy
EU NAVFOR Atalanta (2008)	Somalia
IORA, Djibouti Code	Regional cooperation
MSCHOA	Public-private coordination
BMP	Industry best practices

PIRACY – **P**revention · **I**nternational cooperation · **R**egulation/law enforcement · **A**wareness and training · **C**apacity building · **Y**outh and economic development (faculty)

MARITIME ANTI-PIRACY ACT 2022

Implements **UNCLOS**; gives **Navy and Coast Guard** power to intercept, board, seize and arrest on the high seas; designated Indian courts try pirates **irrespective of nationality**; punishes organising/facilitating; **death or life imprisonment** if piracy causes death.

Alondra Rainbow (1999): ICG caught pirates, but Mumbai High Court acquitted them for **lack of jurisdiction and domestic law** – the gap the 2022 Act filled.

India's evolution

→ Blue-water navy since mid-1990s; maritime doctrine **2004/2007**; **IMSS 2015**; Gulf of Aden deployment **2008**; 26/11 reset coastal security; **net security provider**; shift to Indo-Pacific

Recall drill: cover and answer

Anti-Piracy Act year?	2022
Which case exposed legal gap?	Alondra Rainbow 1999
HRA moved to?	78° East

Terrorism: Concept, Types, India and Counter-Measures

PYQ 2013, 2018, 2021, 2023, 2024, 2025

✎ *Terrorism has no agreed definition. India has faced it from Punjab to J&K to the NE. Counter-measures: intelligence, NIA, UAPA, special courts and international diplomacy.*

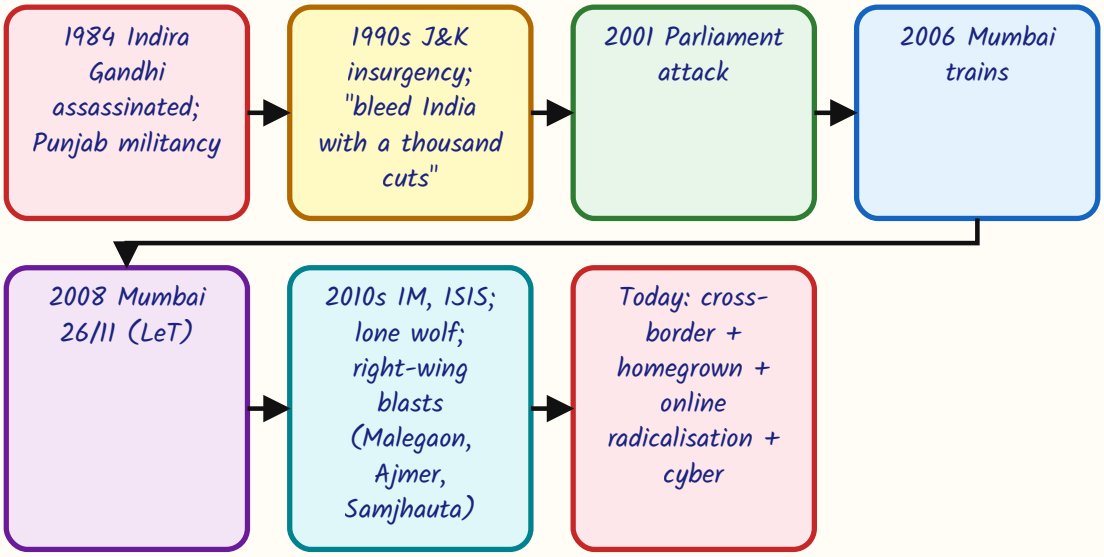
Why undefined? Agreeing when violence is legitimate (by whom, against whom, for what ends) is contested; many definitions are made by governments and **omit state acts. UN strategy:** criminal acts to provoke terror for political purposes are **unjustifiable whatever the justification. GCTF:** intentional use or threat of violence for political, religious or ideological aims.

Common elements of an attack	Meaning
Propaganda / branding	Justify ideology; build brand
Claim of responsibility	Fear + attention
Modus operandi, targets	Symbolic, crowded places
Motivation	Revenge, jihad, self-righteousness
Planning	Recon, logistics, coordination

Data: Global Terrorism Index 2026 — deaths **-28% to 5,582** (2025), incidents **-22% to 2,944**, lowest since 2007; **Pakistan most affected**; **India 13th** (score 6.428). MHA 2020-21: 222 incidents in 2020 vs 317 in 2019; J&K, NE, LWE areas worst; Chhattisgarh 2nd. (2019: India 3rd by number of attacks.)

INDIA'S TIMELINE

Timeline



TYPES OF TERRORISM

Type	Features and examples
Ideology: right / left	Christchurch 2019; Red Brigades, FARC
Religious	Taliban, Al-Qaeda, ISIS
Ethno-nationalist	NE insurgency, IRA
Narco-terrorism	Taliban + opium; Zetas
Bio / nuclear / cyber	Aum Shinrikyo 1995; anthrax 2001; dirty bomb; SolarWinds 2020
Environmental	Earth Liberation Front
Lone wolf	Brenton Tarrant

State terrorism	State force on own citizens
State-sponsored	Funding, arms, training, safe havens to non-state actors

INDIA'S COUNTER-TERROR ARCHITECTURE

Category	Institutions
Intelligence	IB, RAW, **MAC**, **CyMAC (22 Jan 2025)**, NTRO, NIA's **NTDFAC**, **FCORD** (fake notes)
Operations	NCTC coordinates but no central command; **NSG**
Investigation	NIA, FSLs, FIUs, state ATS
Prosecution	NIA special courts, UAPA, SPPs
Laws	**NIA (Amendment) Act 2019**, **UAPA (Amendment) Act 2019**

TERRORISM — Faculty's way forward: **T**echnology regulation · **E**liminate funding · **R**einforce treaties · **R**eaffirm multilateralism · **O**rganise civil society · **R**ebuild trust · **I**ntelligence · **S**trengthen laws · **M**obilise awareness

2021 PYQ link: UAPA/NIA amendments — see UAPA and NIA chapter. ***2024 PYQ:*** narco-terrorism — see Drug Trafficking chapter.

Recall drill: cover and answer

GTI 2026 India rank?	13th
MAC cyber wing?	CyMAC, 22 Jan 2025
2019 amendments?	UAPA and NIA Acts

Terrorism and Technology: Dark Web, Crypto, Drones

PYQ 2013 (ISIS digital), 2023 (funding)

✎ *Terror groups use social media, games, dark web, cryptocurrency and drones. States must counter with AI, regulation and global cooperation.*

Problem → Planning blind spots; ***tech outpaces regulation***; obsolete counter-strategies; "***technology fatigue***" (Berlin Memorandum 2019); ***dual use*** (AI recruit and radicalise)

Stage	Use of technology (examples)
Propaganda	Telegram; deepfake (2021 Khalistan video); games (Hezbollah Special Force, Huroof); live-streams (Christchurch, Halle)
Recruitment	Global pool; Aug 2021 pro-IS Telegram group recruiting in India
Training	***Inspire*** (Al-Qaeda), manuals; IS 2015 app security ranking
Planning	Encrypted comms, UAV, GPS, 3-D printing; ***2021 drone attack on IAF Jammu***
Fundraising	Bitcoin, Monero, ***zakat misuse*** (IS-K Voice of Khorasan; PFI via crypto and Gulf money)
Execution	Houthi drones; swarming attack on Russian bases

Crypto: stealth addresses and ring signatures (Monero), zk-SNARKs (Zcash). Hamas raised >$130 m in crypto (Aug 2021–Jun 2023) [handout also: $41 m 2020–23; PIJ $93 m]. Bengaluru Café blast: crypto funded the IS module in Karnataka. INCB 2023: South Asia holds 39% of global opiate consumers.

DARK WEB

Uses → Internal comms · propaganda · recruitment/training · fundraising · ***weapons procurement*** (EuroGuns, AlphaBay) · drugs · AI/deepfakes

Counter
→ ***Technology:*** DARPA Memex; UK NCA decoy sites
→ ***Enforcement:*** NTRO and NSA monitor Tor; regulator for platforms
→ ***Cooperation:*** Tallinn Manual update, ***Five Eyes***; digital literacy; ***Tech Against Terrorism***

Counter-terror with technology → ***Counter-narratives*** (US CSCC 2012); ***UN Travel Programme*** (2019) vs FTFs; AI border (EU ***ETIAS***); predictive models (RED-Alert, Moonshot); digital evidence; NATO DEXTER; national cyber agencies (NIS)

Financial institutions → ***Blockchain*** tracking; ***audit NGO accounts***; crypto exchange regulation; ***KYC / KYT***

Measure	Who
Christchurch Call 2019	France + New Zealand + firms
GIFCT 2017	Facebook, Microsoft, Twitter, YouTube
GCTF	Forum (29/30 countries)
Tech Against Terrorism	UN CTED
Aqaba Process	Jordan
Delhi Declaration (UNSC CTC)	Guiding principles on drones, social media, crowdfunding

Value addition: balance security with ***privacy and speech***; a global treaty on tech misuse; capacity in South Asian languages.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Al-Qaeda magazine?	Inspire
UN programme vs FTFs?	Terrorist Travel Programme (2019)
GIFCT founded?	2017

Global Counter-Terror Architecture and India's Diplomacy

PYQ 2018, 2023 (NMFT)

✎ *UN bodies and resolutions plus regional forums form the global net. India pushes a Comprehensive Convention (CCIT) since 1996.*

Body / resolution	What it does
UNSC 1267 (1999)	Sanctions on Taliban, Al-Qaeda
UNSC 1373 (2001)	Post 9/11: criminalise financing; **CTC**
1540 (2004)	No WMD to non-state actors
1624 (2005)	Incitement, internet
2178 (2014)	Foreign terrorist fighters
2462 (2019)	Countering financing
UN CT Strategy 2006; UNOCT 2017	Coordination
FATF 1989	Standards on ML/TF
GCTF 2011; GICNT 2006	Forum; nuclear terrorism (88 states)

Regional frameworks

→ **SAARC** conventions (1987, 2008) · **ASEAN ARF** (1994) · **AU** convention · **EU** strategy (2005), ECTC 2016 · **SCO RATS** (2004)

INDIA'S DIPLOMACY

Evolution

→ **De-legitimisation** of terrorism

→ **Root-cause approach** (1970s-80s): **1976** NAM draft passed 86-8-24; **A/RES/40/61 (1985)**

→ **Comprehensive vs sectoral**: Third World wanted comprehensive; US/EU sectoral

CCIT — India has pushed since **1996**. Four tenets: **universal definition** · **ban groups and shut camps** · **special laws for prosecution** · **extradition of cross-border terrorism**. Stalled over definition (OIC: liberation movements; US: acts of state forces) and scope (state terrorism).

Other steps

→ **FATF:** India re-elected co-chair of Asia-Pacific Joint Group (2022)

→ 2021 UNGA co-sponsorship of GCTS resolution; 2022 India-Russia Joint Action Plan; push to reform **UN CTC**; capacity building (Afghanistan, Iraq, Syria)

> *"Nathi Santi Paran Sukham" and "Ekam Sad Viprah Bahudha Vadanti" — PM Modi on universal peace.*

Terrorism as an "industry"

→ Hierarchy + franchise (AQAP, AQIM) · alliances (Boko Haram-ISIS) · recruitment · diversified funds (Hezbollah: Iran, drugs; Taliban: opium) · tech (drones, 2014 Sony hack) · branding (**Dabiq**) · impact (9/11, 26/11) · counter: USA PATRIOT Act, Global Coalition vs ISIS (80+)

Recall drill: cover and answer

CCIT pushed since?	1996
UNSC 1373 about?	Financing; post 9/11
SCO RATS year?	2004

Interpol, BharatPol, MLATs and International Policing

PYQ Fugitives, extradition, cooperation

✎ *Crime crosses borders, so police must too. Interpol notices, India's BharatPol portal and treaties (MLATs) help catch fugitives and share evidence.*

Source note: built from OCR of handwritten slides; items marked (verify) must be checked before use.

Interpol: founded **1923**, HQ **Lyon, France**; 195 member countries; each has a **National Central Bureau** as point of access (India: CBI).

Why international policing

→ **Transnational nature** of crime (drugs, wildlife and timber, organised networks)
→ Extradition is slow; bureaucratic and **sovereignty** concerns
→ Disparities in laws, jurisdictions and technology

Interpol notice	Purpose
Red	Fugitive charged with or convicted of serious crime (locate and arrest)
Blue	Additional information on identity or location
Green	Warning about habitual offenders
Orange	Warn of imminent threat (hidden weapons, bomb threat)
Black	Information about unidentified bodies
Purple	Modus operandi, objects or cybercrime tools
Silver	Trace assets linked to crime (pilot project; India part of it, verify)

BHARATPOL AND MLATs

BharatPol

→ Launched by **CBI**; digital platform to connect Indian law-enforcement agencies with Interpol
→ Replaces letters and emails with a **faster integrated** system
→ **5 modules** (verify): connect, broadcast, references, notices, resources

MLATs

→ **Mutual Legal Assistance Treaties**: formal treaties between 2+ countries for legal assistance in criminal matters
→ India has MLATs with **40+ countries**
→ Issue: slow, via **judicial, diplomatic** channels; BharatPol is faster and flexible

Recent (verify): **BNSS S.356** allows **trial in absentia** of proclaimed offenders. India chosen to chair UN **Commission on Narcotic Drugs** session; Interpol and UNODC asked to target profits of organised crime.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Interpol HQ and year?	Lyon, 1923
Red notice?	Fugitive to be located and arrested
BharatPol launched by?	CBI
BNSS S.356?	Trial in absentia of proclaimed offenders

UAPA and NIA

PYQ Anti-terror law debates

✎ *UAPA designates organisations and (since 2019) individuals as terrorists; NIA is the central counter-terror agency (2008). Both face federalism and due-process criticism.*

July 2026: MHA designated **23 more individuals** as terrorists under **S.35 UAPA** (Fourth Schedule): 17 Pakistani, 6 Indian, all operating from Pakistan or PoJK; earlier 57 → total **80**. **NIA (29 Jul 2026):** 690 cases, 169 judgments, 156 convictions = **92.31%**.

UAPA AMENDMENT 2019

Provision	What it does
S.35 designation	Centre can designate **organisations**; **2019** extends to **individuals** (Fourth Schedule)
Property seizure	Needs DGP approval; if NIA investigates, **DG NIA** approval
Investigation	DSP/ACP or above; **NIA Inspectors** and above can investigate
Schedule of treaties	Adds **International Convention for Suppression of Acts of Nuclear Terrorism (2005)** to nine treaties

Criticism

→ **Arbitrary labelling**: no FIR, chargesheet or conviction needed; fails "just, fair, reasonable"

→ **Fundamental rights**: Art. 19 speech, assembly, association; dissent criminalised

→ **No safeguards**: no judicial review/appeal for designation; burden shifts; **Watali (2019)** limits bail scrutiny; **Thwaha Fasal (2021)** slightly easier bail

→ **Federal encroachment**; **low conviction** — 2.2% of UAPA cases 2016–19; erodes judicial role

Way forward

→ Use as **last resort**; narrow definitions of "unlawful activity/terrorist act" (protect protest, per **Art. 19(1)(a)**, **Maqbool Fida Hussain v. Rajkumar Pandey 2008**)

→ **Independent review** mechanism; amend **S.43D(5)** (presumption of innocence); clear bail-denial grounds

NIA ACT 2008

About NIA

→ **Central counter-terror agency**, HQ New Delhi; formed after **26/11**; Bill by P. Chidambaram Dec 2008; came into existence **31 Dec 2008**, functioning 2009

→ Investigates offences against sovereignty/security: friendly relations with states, atomic facilities, **arms-drug-FICN smuggling**, infiltration, treaty offences — across States on MHA order

→ **2019 Amendment**: adds **human trafficking, counterfeit currency, prohibited arms, cyber-terrorism, Explosive Substances Act**; investigate offences **outside India**; Special Court in **New Delhi**

Analysis

→ **Constitutional validity**: police/public order = State subjects; Soli Sorabjee Committee and Law Ministry: Arts. **249 / 252** or amendment; **Entry 93, List I** gives some basis

→ **Functioning**: investigation but not prevention (no intelligence role); **superintendence** undefined (politicisation); executive decides scheduled offence; **S. 6(3)** gives Centre 15 days to decide

Way forward

→ **International cooperation** (information sharing, extradition, joint ops) · **coordination with State agencies** (joint task forces, shared databases) · **judicial oversight**

Recall drill: cover and answer

S.35 UAPA?	Designation of terrorist organisations; individuals after 2019
Total individuals designated by July 2026?	80
NIA conviction rate (Jul 2026)?	92.31%
Conviction of UAPA cases 2016–19?	2.2%

Organised Crime and its Links with Terrorism

PYQ 2022 (types, linkages)

✎ *Organised crime seeks profit; terrorism seeks political aims; but they share funding, arms, routes and corruption. India uses MCOCA-type laws and BNS S.111-112.*

Recent: NIA **Operation Dhvast** (129 locations, terror-gangster-drug network, with Punjab and Haryana police); MCOCA invoked against Lawrence Bishnoi in Salman Khan firing case; FICCI **Hidden Streams** report across 122 nations.

UNODC: continuing criminal enterprise that works rationally to profit from illicit activities in public demand, protected by **corruption and intimidation**. **UNTOC:** structured group of **3 or more** persons, over time, acting to commit serious crime for material benefit. India ratified UNTOC in **2011**.

International

1988 UN Narcotics Convention → 1994 Naples Conference → 2000 UNTOC adopted → 2011 India ratifies UNTOC

Commercial smuggling → Soviet-style controls and high barriers → **1980s underworld** (film finance until industry status 1998); **Mumbai** hub; methods: contraband, relabelling, under-reporting, falsified certification; goods: gold, gems, cigarettes, electronics, phones

Gun running → FICCI: each 1-point rise in arms-trafficking score ≈ **0.69-point** rise in GTI; Kashmir: none before mid-1980s, by 1989 seizures of **98 AK rifles**; cross-border tribes as guides; Area Commanders distribute

LINKAGES

Link	Example
Funding	Taliban heroin
Logistics	Al-Qaeda N. African routes; 26/11 logistics
Arms	Hezbollah traffickers
Human trafficking	ISIS and Yazidi women
Drugs	FARC cocaine
Money laundering	Hawala in South Asia
Extortion / kidnap	Boko Haram schoolgirls
Corruption	Mexican cartels bribe officials
Territory	ISIS in Syria and Iraq
Convergence	Mafia tactics

India region	Organised crime	Terror type
NER	Extortion, trafficking, gun running	Insurgency, ethno-nationalist
J&K	Funding, counterfeit, ML, opium	State-sponsored
LWE	Extortion, bank robbery	Ideological

Aspect	Terrorism	Organised crime
Motive	Political, ideological	Money, control
Style	Overt, spread fear	Covert, bribery

Structure	Tight hierarchy	Loose affiliates
Legitimacy	Does not seek	Needs social support
Civilians	Mass killing	Limited
Longevity	Long-term	Sporadic bursts
State	Opposes	Manipulates

COUNTERING

Initiatives → ***OCCUs***; MCOCA, KCOCA, NDPS, Customs Act, ITPA, NSA; FIUs; ***MAC / JOCs***; Kimberley Process, FATF, UNODC, SCO-RATS, MLATs; ***UNTOC, UNCAC***; ICSFT; ***CBN portal***

BNS S.111 organised crime: continuing unlawful activity by a syndicate using violence/coercion for material benefit; punishment ***death or life*** where death results, fine ≥ ***₹10 lakh***. ***S.112 petty organised crime:*** gang theft, snatching, betting, paper leak etc.; ***1–7 years*** and fine.

6C — **C**ontinuous IFF evaluation (SDG 16.4) · **C**entral nodal agency (like I4C) · **C**onsumer awareness · **C**ombat TBML (WCO AEO, blockchain) · **C**ooperation internationally (G20 New Delhi 2023) — the faculty's "6C approach" (five items listed in source)

Sahel case: terror deaths up >2000% (2007–22); firearms in 70% of 84 attacks; >9,300 deaths in 2022 — illicit arms feed terrorism.

Recall drill: cover and answer

BNS S.111 fine?	≥ ₹10 lakh
UNTOC members of group?	3 or more
India UNTOC ratification?	2011

Drug Trafficking and Narco-Terrorism

PYQ 2024 (narco-terrorism)

✎ *India sits between the Golden Crescent and Golden Triangle. Drugs now also come by drone, darknet and sea. The answer is network-dismantling plus border, tech and demand-side action.*

Narco-terrorism = intersection of drug trafficking and terrorism, where violent acts by traffickers aim to ***influence officials by intimidation and violence***. Drugs harm individuals, break families, weaken communities.

RECENT CONTEXT (verify dates)

Operation	Detail
Crystal Fortress (Nov 2025)	NCB + Delhi Police Special Cell; transnational ***methamphetamine*** cartel using Delhi as hub
Ragepill	NCB busts network; India's ***first seizure of Captagon*** (psychotropic used in Middle East)
White Strike	NCB dismantles ***cocaine*** syndicate in Mumbai-Thane
Global-Hunt	NCB + Interpol to trace international networks run by Indian fugitives

THE LANDSCAPE

Location

→ ***Golden Crescent***: Afghanistan, Pakistan, Iran
→ ***Golden Triangle***: Myanmar, Laos, Thailand
→ Government proposes calling them ***Death Crescent*** and ***Death Triangle***
→ Drugs: cocaine, pseudoephedrine, heroin, alprazolam, methamphetamine, mephedrone, cannabis, hashish

Entry points

→ ***Punjab and Gujarat***: Golden Crescent; Punjab sees ***drone drops***
→ ***North-East*** (Myanmar border): heroin and ***Yaba*** (methamphetamine) tablets
→ Networks in ***South America, Africa, Middle East*** target India as transit and destination
→ ***Sea ports***: Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai, Tamil Nadu (Terrorism handout)

Data (CAPF handout): Punjab seized ***2,086 kg heroin = 58%*** of 3,567 kg nationwide. INCB 2023: South Asia has 39% of opiate consumers.

Drone-enabled trafficking

→ Drops of ***narcotics, arms, ammunition, explosives*** across India-Pakistan border without infiltration
→ ***GPS-guided*** flights, fixed drop points, local receivers, ***encrypted*** communication
→ Links foreign handlers, smugglers, ***terror modules*** and narco-finance

MEASURES

Level	Measures
Global	***UNODC*** (est. 1997); World Drug Report 2025; Global Maritime Crime Programme (Southern Route); ***26 June*** = International Day against Drug Abuse (declared 1987)
Law	***NDPS Act 1985*** (amended 1988, 2001, 2014, 2021): prohibition, punishment, ***asset forfeiture***
Coordination	***NCORD***: Apex, Executive, State, District levels; ***ANTF*** in all States/UTs; ***JCC*** at Centre and States; NCB with Navy, Coast Guard, BSF

Technology	***Darknet and Crypto Task Force*** (under MAC); anti-drone systems and SOPs; ***NIDAAN*** database of arrested offenders; FSL upgrades
Agencies	NCB ***zonal units*** at Srinagar, Siliguri, Agartala, Itanagar; new units approved (Ferozepur, Port Blair, Dimapur, Aizawl, Sriganganagar, Mangalore); ***BGFs and RPF*** empowered under NDPS
Demand side	***MANAS*** helpline ***1933***; ***Nasha Mukt Bharat Abhiyaan***; ***NAPDDR***; ***Mission SPANDAN*** (awareness)

Approach: whole-of-government = ***ruthless on supply chain, strategic demand reduction, humane treatment of victims.***

World Drug Day 2025 theme: "Break the Cycle. #StopOrganizedCrime". Move from seizures to ***network dismantling***: border security, financial tracking, rehab, international cooperation, community resilience.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Golden Crescent?	Afghanistan, Pakistan, Iran
Golden Triangle?	Myanmar, Laos, Thailand
MANAS helpline?	1933
NDPS amended in?	1988, 2001, 2014, 2021
NIDAAN stands for?	National Integrated Database on Arrested Narco-Offenders

Gun Running (Illicit Arms Trafficking)

PYQ Arms smuggling, crime-terror nexus

✎ *Illegal small arms feed crime, Maoists and terrorists. Drones, porous borders, darknet and local workshops make it hard to stop.*

Gun running = illicit trafficking, manufacture and distribution of ***Small Arms and Light Weapons (SALW)***. Small Arms Survey: millions of illicit firearms in India. ***NCRB: over 90% of gun-related homicides involve illegal, unregistered weapons.***

Security linkages

→ ***Narco-terror nexus***: same routes and hawala as drugs (Golden Crescent and Triangle)

→ ***LWE***: looted security-force weapons plus grey-market arms (West Bengal, Bihar, Telangana)

→ ***Organised crime***: gangs upgraded from zip guns to smuggled automatic weapons

Hurdles

→ ***Drones***: low radar signature, night drops

→ ***Porous borders***: Indus riverine (Punjab), shifting chars of Brahmaputra, Myanmar hills

→ ***Darknet and crypto*** payments

→ ***Grey market***: blank-firing or deactivated weapons converted to lethal

Way forward

→ ***Anti-drone*** (kinetic and jamming) on western frontier; ***ballistic fingerprint*** database of seized arms

→ Local ecosystem: livelihood rehabilitation in clusters like ***Munger***; tighter scrap/chemical sourcing rules; grassroots intelligence

→ Align with ***UN Programme of Action (UNPoA)*** and ***International Tracing Instrument (ITI)***

Recall drill: cover and answer

Share of gun homicides with illegal arms?	Over 90% (NCRB)
Famous illicit manufacturing cluster?	Munger
Two UN instruments?	UNPoA and ITI

Human Trafficking and Child Trafficking

PYQ Linked to organised crime

✎ *Trafficking means moving a person by force, fraud or deception to exploit them. Most victims are used for forced labour; courts and rehab lag behind police action.*

BNS S.143: recruiting, transporting, harbouring, transferring or receiving a person for **exploitation** through threats, force, coercion, abduction, fraud or deception. **S.144**: exploitation of a trafficked person (Terrorism handout). Forms: forced labour, domestic servitude, forced marriage, beggary, pornography, illegal organ removal.

NCRB 2023: 2,183 cases (-3%); **6,288 victims**, **~43% below 18**. More females overall; among minors boys outnumber girls. Over 2015-23 **forced labour** is the largest category, then sexual exploitation. **Punjab and Haryana** report most cases (EAM, Rajya Sabha, Dec 2025). Earlier handout: ~90% of trafficking is domestic.

CHILD TRAFFICKING

Data: 98,375 children missing in 2024 (+7.8%). **53,000+** rescued Apr 2024-Mar 2025. Conviction rate 2018-22 only **4.8%**.

Definition and causes

→ **Palermo Protocol (2000)**: recruitment, transport, transfer, harbouring or receipt of a child for exploitation
→ Push factors: poverty, unemployment, migration, disasters, family breakdown
→ **Social media** recruitment (fake jobs, modelling)
→ **ART and IVF** frameworks misused to legitimise kidnapped or bought children

Legal and judicial

→ **Arts 23, 24**: no trafficking, forced labour, hazardous child work
→ **Art 39(e),(f)**: protect children from exploitation
→ **BNS 98, 99**: selling and buying minors
→ **Vishal Jeet**: child prostitution and trafficking need preventive, humane approach
→ **M C Mehta**: hazardous child labour; **Bachpan Bachao Andolan**: directions on exploitation

CHALLENGES

Challenges

→ **Hollow AHTUs** (Sanjog Watch): staff do general policing; no autonomy or budget
→ **Conviction only 10.5%** of trials; **95%+** cases pending
→ **Rehab tied to conviction**: compensation delayed
→ **New methods**: social media, fake jobs, migration packages, word of mouth

GOVERNMENT MEASURES

Area	Measure
Police	Funds for **Anti-Human Trafficking Units**; MHA conferences and judicial colloquiums; **NIA** can investigate inter-state/international cases
Databases	Crime Multi Agency Centre; **ITSSO**; **NDSO** (18 lakh+ offenders); **NDHTO** (1.20 lakh+ offenders)
Victim support	Women Help Desks; **Shakti Sadan** (Mission Shakti); Child Care Institutions under **Mission Vatsalya**
International	**UNCTOC** and its trafficking Protocol ratified; **SAARC Convention** on trafficking of women and children (Regional Task Force); MoUs with **Bangladesh, UAE, Cambodia, Myanmar**

Conclusion: move from rescue to ***victim-centred*** system: stronger AHTUs, faster trials, rehab, border coordination, safe migration; a uniform ***SOP (as directed by the Supreme Court)*** so every missing-person complaint triggers immediate action.

Recall drill: cover and answer

BNS section for trafficking?	143
Missing children 2024?	98,375
Child conviction rate 2018-22?	4.8%
NDHTO holds?	1.20 lakh+ offender records
Palermo Protocol year?	2000

MONEY LAUNDERING

1. Crime earns dirty cash → 2. PLACEMENT: deposit it → 3. LAYERING: move it around → 4. Convert: crypto, goods → 5. INTEGRATION: looks legit → 6. Law strikes: PMLA, ED, FATF

What is it ?

→ The process of concealing or disguising the true ***nature, source, location, disposition, movement, rights, or ownership*** of the ***proceeds of crime*** – and includes acquiring, possessing, using such proceeds, directly or indirectly, ***knowingly***. (PMLA 2002, S.3)

✎ *Simple: crime earns "dirty" cash; laundering makes it look like salary/business income so it can be spent openly.*

Why is it done ?

→ (1) ***Concealment*** of illegal activities
→ (2) ***Integration*** into legitimate economy
→ (3) ***Terror*** & organised-crime financing
→ (4) ***Evasion*** of tax
→ ***C · I · T · E*** → ***CITE***: cite these 4 reasons – Concealment · Integration · Terror-finance · Evasion

Scale: UNODC estimates ***2–5% of global GDP*** ($800 bn – 2 tn) is laundered every year.
PYQ 2013 · 2018 · 2021 · 2023

STAGES OF MONEY LAUNDERING

DIRTY MONEY

1 PLACEMENT — *cash enters system: offshore a/c, deposits, smurfing → **RISKIEST stage** (cash is visible)*

2 LAYERING — *complex transactions, many routes: forex, shell cos, boats/diamonds, USA/Europe a/cs*

3 INTEGRATION — *re-introduced: business, shells, property* → **CLEAN MONEY**

Remember: ***P***lacement → ***L***ayering → ***I***ntegration = ***PLI*** (think PLI scheme: money goes IN, comes out "incentivised")
Placement = riskiest, because large cash is first exposed to banks & regulators.
Layering = the "maze": many transfers so the trail is lost.
Integration = money re-enters as legitimate wealth (shell firms, real estate, business).

Key words

→ ***smurfing*** (splitting cash into small deposits) · ***shell company*** · ***offshore account*** · ***predicate offence*** (the original crime that produced the money) · ***proceeds of crime***

Value addition: Money laundering is the oxygen of organised crime & terrorism – cut the money, cut the group.

TECHNIQUES OF MONEY LAUNDERING

① Oldest
- → ***Hawala system***
- → ***Physical smuggling / cash couriers***

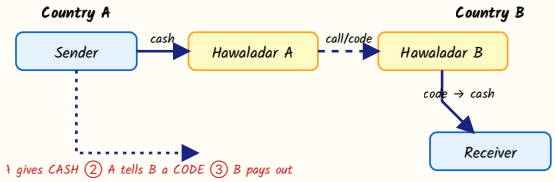
② Older
- → ***Shell companies*** (no real business, only paper)
- → ***Over / under-stating of values*** – invoices inflated or deflated to move value (trade-based ML, TBML)

③ Latest
- → ***Cyber-crime*** → identity theft, hedge funds
- → ***Cryptocurrencies***
- → ***NFTs*** – Non-Fungible Tokens
- → ***Insurance sector*** (buy policy → surrender → "clean" refund)
- → ***White hawala*** transfer

✎ *Easy recall: Old → cash & hawala · Older → papers (shells, invoices) · Latest → digital (crypto, NFT, cyber)*

HAWALA SYSTEM

Features
- → ***Money transfer without movement of money***
- → ***No regulatory oversight*** of RBI
- → ***Instant*** in nature
- → Runs on ***trust + code words***; no paper trail



White vs Black
- → ***White hawala*** – legal purpose (family remittance) but outside banking channel
- → ***Black hawala*** – funds crime, terror, tax evasion

Why hawala is hard to stop: no records, no KYC, instant, across borders, runs on community trust. FATF Special Recommendation → "Alternative Remittance" targets exactly this.

SHELL COMPANIES & TBML – in simple words

Shell company: registered firm with no real operations, used to pass money through.
Over-invoicing: importer pays more than goods are worth → extra money leaves India legally "as payment".
Under-invoicing: goods declared cheaper → difference settled in black money abroad; customs duty also evaded.

Exam angle: Techniques are not static – as banks tighten KYC, launderers move to ***crypto, NFTs, gaming, insurance***. Always end an answer with this "cat-and-mouse" line.

CRYPTOCURRENCIES IN MONEY LAUNDERING

Cryptocurrencies have become a tool for money laundering.

✎ *Simple: digital money, no bank in the middle, accounts are just long codes — not names.*

Reasons for use

Decentralised ledgers	→ No central authority → ***difficult to track***
No central issuing authority	→ No intermediaries → ***reduces detection***
Immune from govt regulation	→ ***Beyond traditional financial regulations***
Pseudonymous nature	→ ***Transactions harder to trace***

Mechanism involved

Crypto-mixers
Services that ***mix identifiable tokens with others*** to obscure their origin.



Chain-hopping
Moving cryptocurrencies ***between different blockchains*** to obscure trails.

Example: swap Bitcoin → Monero (privacy coin) → another chain → cash out through an exchange with weak KYC.

Prevention mechanisms

→ ***Regulation of crypto services***
→ ***Monitoring by exchange systems*** (KYC, suspicious-transaction reports)
→ ***Use of blockchain technology*** itself — public ledger lets analytics firms trace flows

GLOBAL COOPERATION
- International initiatives → ***unifying standards*** → UNGPML programme
- ***Pressure on tax havens*** → diluting secrecy laws

India — value addition

- ***VDA tax:*** 30% on gains + ***1% TDS*** (Virtual Digital Assets).
- ***PMLA 2023 amendment*** brought VDA service providers under PMLA as reporting entities.
- FATF recommends ***travel rule*** for crypto transfers (sender/receiver info travels with the transaction).

CURRENT AFFAIRS ***FATF, June 2026:*** seventh targeted update on ***virtual-asset / VASP standards*** and a new report on ***DeFi*** risks (ML/TF/proliferation financing) — answer hook for "regulating crypto".

Way forward line: Legalise ***and*** regulate crypto (not ban) + tracking and reporting mechanisms + international standards — the faculty's "***L***" in MONEY LAUNDER.

IMPACT OF MONEY LAUNDERING

Memory word: SEEPS — dirty money **seeps** into every layer: **S**ocial · **E**conomic · **E**nvironmental · **P**olitical · **S**ecurity (the 5 headings below are in the faculty's order)

① Social

→ ***Illegal businesses strengthened*** (drugs, prostitution)
→ ***Decreasing social capital***, loss of morality & ethics
→ ***Transfer of economic power to criminals***
→ Damage to legitimate businesses

② Economic

→ ***Micro*** → damage to reputation of financial institutions · cost of doing business ↑ · legitimate business loses · ***increase in organised crime*** · ***policy distortion due to measurement error***

→ ***Macro*** → ***tax evasion*** · ***Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) discourages foreign investors*** · ***volatile exchange rates*** due to unanticipated problems · ***decreasing market confidence*** · ***increase in cost of insurance premiums***

→ Artificial inflation + jobless growth → radicalisation & security challenges

③ Political

→ ***Government deprived of taxes***
→ ***Increased spending on fighting crime***

④ Security

→ ***Terror funding***
→ Increase in crimes
→ Illegal activities

⑤ Environmental

→ ***Illegal wildlife trade***
→ Increased chance of ***zoonotic disease*** outbreak (animal → human diseases, e.g. COVID-type)

FATF report "Money Laundering and the Illegal Wildlife Trade" (2020)
Impact of illegal wildlife trade → ***Corruption*** · ***Threatens biodiversity*** · ***Threat of zoonotic diseases***
India: a source of ***rhino horns, pangolins, tusks***. Wildlife trade is estimated at ***$7–23 bn*** a year.

Drivers (India)

→ ***Rich biodiversity and bad law enforcement***
→ Role of ***private zoos***
→ ***New communication technology***
→ ***e-banking***

Answer tip: A social effect → a security effect → an environmental effect — the "environmental" and "political" points are what most students miss; add them for extra marks.

CHALLENGES IN FIGHTING MONEY LAUNDERING

STAMP + CBT – **STAMP** out money laundering: **S**muggling · **T**ech evolution · **A**wareness lacking · **M**ultiple agencies · **P**redicate-offence law. Then the **CBT** gaps: **C**onviction low · **B**anks skip KYC · **T**ax havens.

Challenges

→ **C – Low rate of conviction** (≈4.6%). ED: 5,892 cases since 2015, only 15 convictions (RS report 2025). Counter-point: ED claims 93.33% conviction on cases tried (56 of 60). → Use both: "high success on a tiny base".

→ **T – Fast-paced tech evolution** (crypto, NFTs, gaming)

→ **P – Predicate-offence-oriented law** → corrected by the 2019 amendment (ML is now an independent offence)

→ **A – Lack of awareness** among common people (they become money mules)

→ **S – Widespread smuggling** of goods in India

→ **B – Banks fail to enforce KYC norms**

→ **M – Multiplicity of agencies and lack of convergence** (ED, FIU, CBDT, CBI, SEBI…)

→ **T – Tax-haven countries**

Black-money linkage: Tax havens + shell companies + cash economy are the "supply route" of laundering.

WAY FORWARD FOR MONEY LAUNDERING

Organised crime funds
Cut the source

Placement
- tighten **e-KYC** norms
- **e-anti money laundering**
- harm reduction

Layering
- **info sharing** b/w agencies (**ED, FIU-IND, CERT-In**)

International co-operation
- pressure **tax havens** for info sharing
- **UN GPML**

MONEY LAUNDER — the faculty's mnemonic

	Meaning	Action
M	Monitoring transactions	Continuous monitoring; AI to detect suspicious patterns
O	Organisational policy of acceptance	Clear client-acceptance policy; risk-based onboarding
N	Notifying suspicious transactions	Report STRs promptly; train staff
E	Enforcement of KYC	Tighter KYC; update data regularly
Y	Yielding to regulatory compliance	Follow AML laws; regular audits
L	Legalising & regulating crypto	Tax it; robust tracking and reporting
A	Advanced e-AML tools	Better software for monitoring
U	Unified coordination among agencies	Central hub for information sharing
N	NPA management	Coordinate when accounts turn NPA; mitigate risks
D	Due diligence procedures	Client identification; regular risk assessment
E	Enhanced information sharing	Timely, accurate data exchange between agencies
R	Regulation of international wire transfers	Follow FATF; prohibit anonymous cross-border wires

Conclusion lines: Govt set up an **inter-ministerial coordination committee**; India proposed a **permanent secretariat** for countering terror financing – guiding principle "**Beyond-Border Cooperation**".

INITIATIVES

INDIAN

Legal framework
- → ***Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002***
- → ***Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999***
- → ***Benami Transactions (Prohibition) Act, 1988*** (amended 2016)

Regulatory measures
- → ***FATF*** compliance
- → ***RBI*** guidelines
- → ***SEBI*** regulations
- → ***IRDAI*** guidelines

Enforcement & monitoring agencies
- → ***Enforcement Directorate (ED)*** – investigates & prosecutes under PMLA
- → ***Financial Intelligence Unit – India (FIU-IND)*** – receives suspicious-transaction reports
- → ***Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT)***

International cooperation
- → Bilateral and multilateral agreements
- → Participation in international forums

Technological measures
- → ***Project Insight*** (tax-data analytics)
- → ***Central KYC Registry (CKYCR)*** – one KYC for all institutions

GLOBAL

Mechanism	What it does
Vienna Convention 1988	Criminalised ML from drug trafficking; cooperation & extradition
Basel Committee Statement 1988	Banks must not be used for ML
FATF (G7, 1989)	Sets international standards (40 + 9 recommendations)
Council of Europe Convention 1990	Common definition / policy; technical assistance
UN GPML 1997	UN programme against ML; also UN conventions on terror financing, transnational organised crime (UNTOC), corruption (UNCAC)
Asia Pacific Group (APG)	Implements FATF 40+9; 41 members + observers (WB, UN, IMF); India is a member
Wolfsberg AML Principles	11 principles by a group of global banks
IMoLIN	International ML Information Network by UNODC – database
Egmont Group	Network of Financial Intelligence Units sharing information

Memory: Vienna & Basel (1988) → FATF (1989) → CoE (1990) → UN-GPML (1997): **"Very Big Fish Catch Unwary"**

Note: The Wolfsberg Group is a bank-led association (the handout credits Transparency International for the principles) – if asked, write "Wolfsberg Group / TI" and move on.

PMLA 2002

Features

Features

→ ***Confiscation of property*** (attachment of proceeds of crime)
→ ***List of crimes:*** Schedule Part A / Part B gives crimes for ML
→ ***Criminal conspiracy*** — concealment, acquisition, possession and use of proceeds, e.g. buying property in name of family
→ ***ML as a standalone crime***
→ Covers ***Politically Exposed Persons (PEPs)***, ***Virtual Digital Assets***, ***NPOs***
→ ***International jurisdiction*** for ED

Issues associated

Issues

→ ***Low conviction rate***
→ ***Dilution of laws***
→ ***Alternate criminal law system*** — ED works outside CrPC
→ ***Admissibility of statements*** (made to ED officers)
→ ***Section 45*** of PMLA (twin bail test)
→ ***Procedural issues*** · ***burden to prove innocence*** (reverse burden on accused)

2023 AMENDMENT — Key changes

PEN-D

→ ***P*** - ***Politically Exposed Persons*** covered
→ ***E*** - bEneficial owner threshold ***25% → 10%***
→ ***N*** - ***NGOs / NPOs*** brought in (registered on NGO Darpan portal)
→ ***D*** - extension of ***due diligence*** (records kept 5 years); VDAs covered

PMLA VERDICT REVIEW — Vijay Madanlal Choudhary Case (2022)

Supreme Court held

→ ***Amendment as Money Bill*** — upheld
→ ***Interpretation of S.3*** (defines ML): directly or indirectly · actually involved · connected with proceeds of crime · untainted property → ***very broad***
→ ***Retrospective application → ML is a continuous crime***
→ ***ED need not supply copy of ECIR*** (it is an internal document, not an FIR)
→ ***Twin bail test:*** prosecutor must be heard; court must believe (i) accused is ***not guilty*** (ii) ***unlikely to reoffend*** if released

Way forward (faculty): **P · M · L · A** → Procedural reforms · Maintaining operational efficiency · List of scheduled offences (review) · Adding clarification on terms
Keywords: standalone offence · continuous crime · twin bail · reverse burden · ECIR≠FIR · Money Bill · PEP · beneficial owner

CURRENT AFFAIRS ***Directorate of Enforcement v. Bhupesh Arora (SC, 29 Sep 2026):*** quashing the predicate-offence FIR by ***compromise*** does ***not obliterate proceeds of crime***; HC bail set aside; ED told to finish probe in ***5 months***. Link: ML is an independent offence (Vijay Madanlal) — but proceeds survive a compromise.
Sanjay Sureka v. ED (2026 INSC 1124, SC, Oct 2026): ***S.19*** — arrest order & material must go to the Adjudicating Authority "***immediately***" = ***expeditiously and simultaneously***; no fixed hours/days (5-day delay held fine).

FATF

Financial Action Task Force — set up by the ***G7 in 1989***; sets global standards on money laundering & terror financing. It issues the ***FATF Recommendations***; countries are peer-reviewed through ***Mutual Evaluation***; poor performers go on the ***Grey list*** (increased monitoring) or ***Black list*** (call for action).

FATF's Recommendations (40)

No.	Subject
1	Assessing risks & applying a ***risk-based approach***
2	National cooperation & coordination
3	***Money laundering offence***
4	Confiscation & provisional measures
9	Financial institution ***secrecy laws***
10	***Customer due diligence*** & record
11	***Record keeping***
12	Additional measures for specific customers
14	***Politically exposed persons***
15	***Correspondent banking***
24	Transparency & ***beneficial ownership*** of legal persons
29	***Financial intelligence units***
39	***Extradition***

FATF's Special Recommendations (TF)

#	Subject
1	Ratify & implement ***UN instruments***
2	***Criminalise financing of terrorism*** & associated ML
3	***Freeze & confiscate*** terrorist assets
4	***Report suspicious*** transactions related to terrorism
5	***International co-operation***
6	***Alternative remittance*** (hawala)
7	***Wire transfers***
8	***Non-profit organisations***
9	***Cash couriers***

UNFAIR + CCW — terror finance is ***unfair*** play:
UN instruments · **N**PO · **F**reeze · **A**lternative remittance · **I**nternational co-op · **R**eport STRs
then ***CCW***: **C**riminalise · **C**ash couriers · **W**ire transfers

Note: The handout earlier says 8 Special Recommendations (2001); a 9th (cash couriers) was added in 2004 → ***40 + 9***. The slide list shows 10 lines; learn the 9 above.

FATF'S REVIEW OF INDIA

Recognised India's efforts

- → ***Mitigating risks*** arising from ML/TF
- → ***Effective measures*** implemented
- → ***JAM Trinity*** (Jan Dhan, Aadhaar, Mobile)

Placed India in

- → ***"Regular follow-up"*** category — India achieved ***highest level of technical compliance***
- → Other G-20 in regular follow-up: UK, Italy, France
- → Other categories: ***Enhanced follow-up***, ***Grey list***, ***Black list***

CURRENT AFFAIRS ***India's Mutual Evaluation (FATF):*** on-site Nov 2023 → adopted at ***June 2024 plenary (Singapore)*** → 368-page report released ***19 Sep 2024***. India in ***"regular follow-up"*** (only 4 other G20 members share it); previous review 2010; ***next evaluation 2031***. FATF asked for ***stronger prosecution*** in ML/TF cases and better protection of the ***NPO sector***.
June 2026 plenary: grey list ***+ Bosnia & Herzegovina, Iraq***; ***– Algeria, Namibia*** (22 on list); black list unchanged (***N. Korea, Iran, Myanmar***). UK presidency (Giles Thomson) from ***1 Jul 2026***; India's ***Vivek Aggarwal*** is incoming ***Vice-President***. Consultation on ***Rec. 16*** (payment transparency).

Mutual Evaluation Report

→ **Peer review** of a country's measures against ML. Two components → ① **Effectiveness rating** · ② **Technical compliance rating**

FATF — CONCERNS & IMPLEMENTATION IN INDIA

Concerns highlighted by M.E.R. in India

① Illegal activities
- → ***Cyber-enabled fraud***, corruption, drug trafficking

② Security threats
- → ***ISIL & Al-Qaeda*** presence in Jammu & Kashmir
- → Regional insurgencies, ***Left-Wing Extremist*** groups

③ Legal & operational
- → ***Low ML conviction rate*** (28 in last 5 years)
- → ***Backlog of pending trials***
- → ***Saturated court system***

④ Supervision deficiencies
- → Weak or no supervision of ***DNFBPs*** (Designated Non-Financial Businesses & Professions)
- → High-risk sectors e.g. ***DPMS*** (Dealers in Precious Metals & Stones) lack effective controls
- → ***Cash-transaction prohibitions*** under tax laws not sufficient

⑤ PEPs
- → No clear provisions under PMLA or regulatory frameworks (RBI, SEBI, IRDAI, PFRDA)

Memory word: **SLIPS** — the ***slips*** FATF found in India: ***S***upervision gaps · ***L***egal/operational · ***I***llegal activities · ***P***EPs · ***S***ecurity threats

FATF Mutual Evaluation — criticism
- → ***No formal rules***
- → ***Weak listing regime*** (wilful / non-wilful)
- → ***Absentees*** (e.g. Pakistan)
- → ***Global-South representation*** low
- → Emerging tech not covered

Implementation of FATF recommendations in India

① Reporting entities
- → ***Formation agent*** of companies & LLPs
- → ***Director, secretary, partner*** in companies & LLPs
- → Providing ***registered office / business address***
- → ***Trustees***
- → ***Nominee shareholder*** for another person

② Responsibilities
- → ***Verify identity*** of clients before specified transactions
- → Examine ***ownership & financial position***
- → Record ***purpose*** behind the transaction
- → ***Disallow*** specified transactions

③ Exemptions
- → ***Lawyers***

ONE-PAGE RECAP & SELF-TEST

Mnemonic sheet

Topic	Mnemonic
Why ML	**CITE** – Concealment · Integration · Terror finance · Evasion of tax
Stages	**PLI** – Placement · Layering · Integration
Techniques	**O-O-L** – Oldest · Older · Latest
Impact	**SEEPS** – Social · Economic · Environmental · Political · Security
Challenges	**STAMP** (Smuggling·Tech·Awareness·Multiple agencies·Predicate law) + **CBT** (Conviction·Banks·Tax havens)
Way forward	**MONEY LAUNDER**
PMLA 2023	**PEN-D**
Verdict WF	**PMLA** – Procedural · Maintaining efficiency · List of offences · Adding clarity
FATF special	**UNFAIR + CCW**
MER concerns	**SLIPS** – Supervision · Legal · Illegal activities · PEPs · Security
TF methods	**NOMS**
Black money WF	**BLACK**
Global	**"Very Big Fish Catch Unwary"**

Self-test (cover & answer)

1. Define ML under PMLA S.3.
2. Which stage is riskiest, and why?
3. White vs black hawala?
4. Name 3 reasons crypto suits launderers.
5. Mixer vs chain-hopping?
6. Five impacts of ML (SEEPS).
7. 2019 amendment fixed which challenge?
8. PEN-D — expand.
9. Twin bail test — two limbs?
10. Why did SC say ECIR need not be shared?
11. FATF year, founder; grey vs black list?
12. India's FATF category and why?
13. 3 MER concerns about India.
14. NOMS conference year/place?
15. Reconcile 93.33% vs 15 of 5,892.

Answer frame — 15 marks

Structure

→ **Intro:** definition + UNODC 2-5% GDP (or Peña Nieto: "oxygen to organised crime")

→ **Body:** stages → techniques (old→latest) → impact (SEEPS) → legal framework (PMLA, FEMA, FIU, ED) → challenges

→ **Way forward:** MONEY LAUNDER + FATF + **Beyond-Border Cooperation**

→ **Conclusion:** balance enforcement with tech + international cooperation

PYQs: 2013 (10) · 2018 (15) · 2021 (10) · 2023 (15) — all ask **techniques/challenges/measures**; keep the three-layer structure: **legal – institutional – technological**.

Current-affairs sources: Business Standard (19 Sep 2024, FATF MER India) · ComplyAdvantage (FATF June 2026 plenary outcomes) · LawBeat (DoE v. Bhupesh Arora) · Verdictum (Sanjay Sureka v. ED). Verify exact dates before quoting in mains.

Source note: notes inspired by the faculty's hand-written Sarthi IAS notes + handout; conflicting figures flagged in the text (ED conviction data, FATF special recommendations count).

Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA)

PYQ NGO funding, foreign influence, internal security

✎ *FCRA 2010 controls who can take foreign money and how it is spent, so that outside funds cannot be used against national interest. The 2026 Bill adds rules for the assets bought with that money.*

FCRA 2010 regulates acceptance and use of ***foreign contribution and foreign hospitality*** by individuals, associations and companies. Administered by the ***Ministry of Home Affairs***. Aim: stop foreign funds being used for activities ***detrimental to national interest*** (political mobilisation, religious activity, civil-society funding, money laundering, terror financing).

MEANING AND ELIGIBILITY

Foreign contribution = donation by a foreign source of

→ ***Article*** (except personal gifts within limit)
→ ***Currency*** (Indian or foreign)
→ ***Security*** (incl. foreign security)
→ ***Interest or income*** earned on it is also foreign contribution
→ ***NRI*** money from personal savings through normal banking is ***not*** foreign contribution (NRIs are Indian citizens)

Who can receive?

→ Person with a ***definite cultural, economic, educational, religious or social programme***
→ Includes individual, HUF, association, ***Section 8 company*** (only if registered non-profit with ***3-year track record*** or explicit prior permission of MHA)
→ Must hold ***FCRA registration*** or ***prior permission*** of the Centre

COURTS ON FCRA

Case	Held
Noel Harper v UoI (2022)	SC upheld the main ***2020 amendment*** provisions. Receiving foreign contribution is ***not an absolute right***; can be regulated for sovereignty, integrity and public order
UoI v Sharma Centre for Heritage Education (2025)	Madras HC: denial of renewal ***disproportionate*** where no misuse; SC declined to interfere

Balance: strict regulation is constitutionally valid, but action must be ***evidence-based, fair and proportionate***. Use this line in any NGO-regulation answer.

THE FCRA AMENDMENT BILL, 2026

Why proposed

→ ***Asset-management vacuum***: vesting existed but no custody or disposal mechanism
→ ***Expired registrations***: unclear what happens to assets
→ ***Suspension***: no clarity on assets during suspension
→ ***Multiple investigations*** by different agencies
→ ***Disproportionate penalty***: 5-year jail for general breach seen as excessive
→ ***Prior permission***: no time limits for receiving and using funds

Existing Act	Bill 2026
Certificate renewed every **5 years**; cancel or surrender only	New concept of **cessation**: not renewed in time, no application, or renewal rejected
Assets vest in prescribed authority on cancel/surrender	Vesting extended to cessation; a **Designated Authority** covers assets made **fully or partly** from foreign money; **provisional** until renewal or restoration, else **permanent**
No post-vesting framework	Permanent assets: public use, transfer to government bodies, or disposal; **sale proceeds and unused funds go to Consolidated Fund**
Nothing on places of worship	Vested place of worship managed appropriately, **religious character preserved**
Prior-permission funds: no time limit	Must be received and used within the **prescribed period**
Loose terms for office bearers	**Key functionary** defined widely (Rule 2(1)(ca)): directors, partners, trustees, Karta, office-bearers, governing body
No duty if body becomes defunct	Last key functionaries must **inform the Centre**; failure → permanent vesting
General breach up to **5 years**	Max **1 year**; **prior Central approval** before investigating an offence
Ban covers associations and companies making news/current affairs	Widened to **any person** engaged in such activity

FCRA AMENDMENT RULES, 2026

Rules

→ **Activity and State-specific** registration (purposes and States/UTs named)
→ **More reporting**: project-wise and activity-wise use, website and social media, **ultimate foreign donor**
→ **Renewal**: reasonable activity = at least **₹10 lakh** used in previous **2 years**
→ Religious purposes more specifically defined
→ **Next instalment**: activity-wise disclosure and **75%** use of previous instalment, subject to field inquiry

Current affairs (verify dates): Bill referred to a **31-member Joint Parliamentary Committee** after opposition and public pushback. **FCRA 2.0 portal** launched **30 June 2026** (revamp, cloud migration, process re-engineering).

SIGNIFICANCE, CONCERNS, WAY FORWARD

Significance

→ Clear **management of foreign-funded assets** (hospitals, schools, buildings)
→ Traceability protects **sovereignty and national security**
→ Accountability of **assets**, not only money flow
→ Stops misuse by **defunct** entities
→ Single **Designated Authority**; digital governance (FCRA 2.0)

Concerns

→ **Non-renewal may lose assets** even if NGO simply stops foreign funding
→ **Mixed-funded assets**: whole asset vests first (a hospital wing built with domestic plus foreign money is hard to split)
→ **Due-process gap**: no prior hearing or statutory appeal if Centre refuses renewal
→ **Small NGOs** burdened by ₹10 lakh test

Way forward

→ **Proportionality**: vest only the foreign-funded share
→ Orderly **exit route** for NGOs that stop foreign funds
→ **Natural justice**: reasoned order, hearing, appeal
→ **Risk-based** regulation: serious diversion versus minor procedural lapse

Recall drill: cover and answer

Who administers FCRA?	Ministry of Home Affairs
Section 8 company condition?	3-year track record or prior permission
Noel Harper (2022)?	SC upheld 2020 amendments; no absolute right to foreign funds
2026 Bill: jail for general breach?	Cut from 5 years to 1 year
Renewal minimum use (2026 Rules)?	₹10 lakh in preceding 2 years

Trade-Based Money Laundering (TBML)

PYQ Money laundering, hawala, capital flight

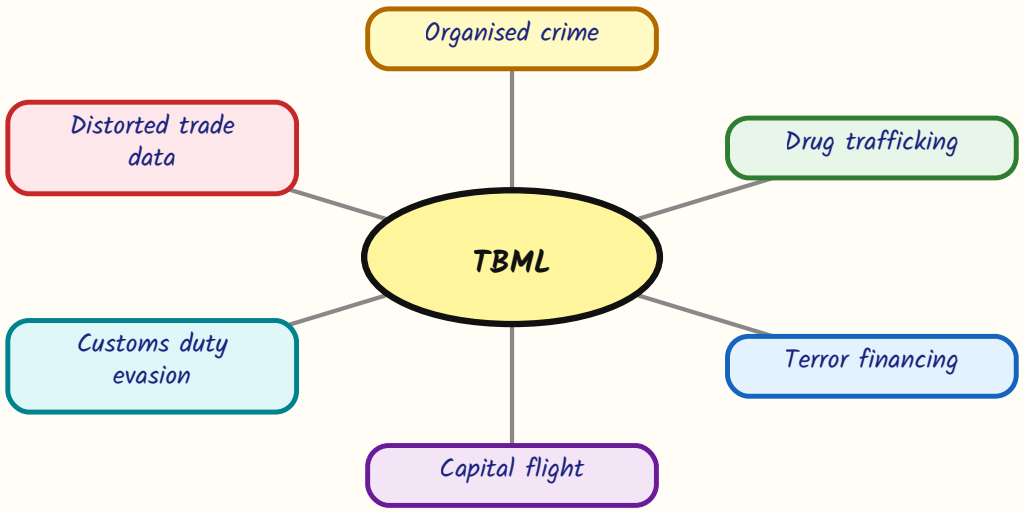
✎ *Criminals hide dirty money inside normal trade by lying about the price, quantity or existence of goods. Banks see the money, customs sees goods; nobody sees both.*

FATF: misuse of ***trade transactions*** to disguise criminal proceeds and move value through the formal trade system, by misrepresenting ***price, quantity, quality, shipment or documents***.

METHODS OF TBML

Method	How it works
Over / under-invoicing	Inflate or deflate invoice value to shift value between importer and exporter
Multiple invoicing	Same shipment invoiced many times to justify repeated bank payments
Phantom shipment	Fake documents for goods that never move
Misclassification	Goods wrongly described to alter price, duty or scrutiny
False description	Quality, weight or quantity misstated
Shell companies	Front firms route funds and hide beneficial owners

Why it is a serious threat (not just a customs offence)



India angle: large trade volumes, high-value goods (***gold, gems, jewellery, electronics, machinery***), and informal channels like ***hawala***.

INDIA'S FRAMEWORK

Laws and bodies

→ ***Laws:*** PMLA 2002, FEMA 1999, Customs Act 1962, RBI directions
→ ***Agencies:*** ED, DRI, Customs, FIU-IND, RBI, DGFT, CBIC
→ ***Authorised Dealer banks*** process trade payments; must spot suspicious patterns, not just check papers

Core problem: banks see the ***money trail***, customs sees the ***goods trail***, enforcement sees the ***criminal trail***. If they do not talk, TBML stays hidden.

Challenges

→ Valuation difficulty
→ Shell-company networks; ***beneficial ownership*** opacity
→ Jurisdictional barriers; fake documents
→ Balance with ***ease of doing business***

Way forward: "follow the goods, follow the money"

→ Integrate ***Customs, banking, GST, DGFT, FIU and company-ownership*** data for risk-based detection
→ Use ***AI, price benchmarking, network analytics, anomaly detection***

FATF BEST PRACTICES

Practice	Meaning
Risk-based national assessment	Include TBML in National Risk Assessment (sectors, commodities, routes)
Data integration	Cross-match STRs, customs, shipping, invoices, ownership data
Public-private partnership	Trade data is scattered across banks, shippers, traders, government
Red flags	***FATF-Egmont*** indicators: business structure, trade activity, documents and commodities, account activity
Customs-FIU cooperation	Goods intelligence plus money intelligence; e.g. ***FIU-IND and SEBI MoU*** for database sharing

Conclusion: legitimate commerce is being used for illicit finance; protecting financial integrity, revenue and internal security needs law, technology, customs intelligence, bank vigilance and international cooperation together.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Six TBML methods?	Over/under-invoicing, multiple invoicing, phantom shipment, misclassification, false description, shell companies
Core detection gap?	Money, goods and criminal trails sit in different agencies
Approach?	Follow the goods, follow the money

TERROR FINANCING & BLACK MONEY

Terror financing (UN Convention): any person who ***provides or collects funds***, directly or indirectly, unlawfully and wilfully, ***intending or knowing*** they will be used to carry out a terror offence. ***Why money?*** recruit & support members · maintain logistics hubs · conduct operations.

N·O·M·S methods

→ **N**ew tech → crypto (IS-K asked ***Monero*** donations via Voice of Khorasan), digital assets/gaming/prepaid cards, dark web
→ **O**rganised crime → kidnapping for ransom, narcotics, illicit trade (oil, charcoal, diamonds, gold), organ & human trafficking
→ **M**oney laundering → banks, ***SWIFT***, ***hawala***
→ **S**ponsors → ***state sponsorship***, ***crowdfunding*** (misuse of Zakat), ***misuse of NPOs*** (e.g. Global Relief Foundation)

NOMS = "No Money for Terror" — also the name of the ***New Delhi Conference 2022***.

"No Money for Terror" Conference, New Delhi 2022

Takeaways

→ ***~450 delegates***; reviewed global counter-terror-financing regime
→ ***No "good" and "bad" terrorism*** — zero tolerance
→ Fight ***terrorism as a network***, not just a terrorist
→ Impose ***costs on state sponsors***; isolate sympathisers
→ ***Organised crime–terror links***: global collaboration
→ Role of ***UNSC, FATF, FIUs, Egmont***; joint ops, intelligence, extradition
→ ***Tech:*** dark net & private currencies — involve private sector, don't demonise tech
→ ***Delhi Declaration*** (UNSC CTC): countering new tech for terror

BLACK MONEY — quick map

Sources

→ tax evasion · IPO/insider trading · shell cos · ***gold*** · corruption · tax havens · ***cash economy*** · hawala · illegal gambling

Effects

→ ↓ FDI · parallel economy · policy distortion · inequality · ***national security*** · inflated real-estate · vicious cycle

Govt steps

→ ***Black Money Act 2015*** · Benami Act 2016 · ***TIEAs*** · GST · IDS & PMGKY 2016 · RERA · PAN · UPI · demonetisation

Data

→ ₹9.41–14.71 lakh cr (2015) · GFI $38.7 bn/yr outflow (2002–11) · Swiss deposits CHF 3.83 bn (2021) · ~90% lies ***inside*** India

Way forward — BLACK: **B**etter regulatory framework · **L**everage technology · **A**wareness · **C**ooperation among agencies · **K**YC enforcement.

Cyber Security: Framework, Policy and Institutions

PYQ 2013, 2015 (x2), 2017, 2019, 2022

✎ *Cyberspace runs governance, money, power and health. India has laws (IT Act), bodies (CERT-In, NCIIPC, I4C) and a 2020 strategy, but a fragmented framework.*

Data: internet subscribers **1,092.79 m** (Mar 2026; 1,028.61 m Dec 2025; wireless 1,046.26 m). Resecurity: data of **800 m+ Indians** on dark web (Aadhaar-passport at $80,000 claim). **77 ransomware attacks in H1 2026** (2nd in APAC, 9th globally). 71% Indian firms saw AI-driven phishing/deepfakes. Cisco 2025: only **7%** of Indian organisations "Mature". PwC: need **~1 million** more professionals. 60% of power-sector equipment is Chinese.

Cybersecurity (UN GGE 2015) = tools, policies, safeguards, risk management, training and technologies that protect the cyber environment and users' assets. ***CIA + N:*** **C**onfidentiality (eavesdropping) · **I**ntegrity (man-in-the-middle) · **A**vailability (DDoS) · **N**on-repudiation (digital signature).

Elements
→ Confidentiality (encryption, access control) · Integrity (hashing, signatures) · Availability (redundancy, DR) · Risk management · Network (firewall, IDS, VPN) · Endpoint (EDR) · Data (DLP) · IAM (RBAC, SSO) · Cryptography (PKI) · Incident response · Governance

Why vulnerable
→ Budget limits · ***imported equipment*** · complex networks · evolving threats (AI, social engineering, state-sponsored)

ISSUES IN THE FRAMEWORK

Four categories

→ ***Federal:*** police/public order = State List; cybersecurity not in Seventh Schedule; multi-statute; no integrated national security strategy

→ ***Administrative:*** no procedural code for e-evidence; IT Act offences need ***Inspector+***; vacancies; no cyber labs

→ ***Technical:*** workforce, ***borderless and faceless***, low cost-high return, weak telecom security

→ ***Social:*** >80% use public Wi-Fi, 47% use VPN; weak PPP; SME costs

INITIATIVES

Evolution



Type	Items
Legal	IT Act 2000; NCSP 2013; NDCP 2018; NCSS 2020; ***Comprehensive Cyber Security Audit Policy Guidelines 2025***; DPDP Rules 2025; National Cyber Security Coordinator
Institutions	***CERT-In***, ***NTRO***, ***NCIIPC***, ***I4C***, ***NCCC***, TDSAT, Cyber Swachhta Kendra (***M-Kavach***, ***USB Pratirodh***, ***AppSamvid***, ***Browser JSGuard***)
States	Kerala, Cyberabad, Maharashtra, Karnataka, TN; ***Cyberdome*** (2019 PYQ)
Other	Cyber Surakshit Bharat, Cyber Warrior Police, Digital India

NCRF (NCIIPC): non-binding; ≥ **10%** of IT budget on cyber; board oversight; ISMS; **CBDR**; regulator powers. **DIP** (DoT) real-time intelligence sharing; **Chakshu** on Sanchar Saathi to report fraud calls/SMS.

NCSP 2013 vs NCSS 2020

→ **NCSP 2013:** secure ecosystem, assurance framework, 24x7 mechanisms, NCIIPC, indigenous tech, **5 lakh** professionals in 5 years, fiscal benefits. **Issues:** poor implementation, weak critical-infrastructure focus, funding, coordination, civil liberties, only defensive

→ **NCSS 2020 (DSCI, Lt Gen Rajesh Pant):** 21 areas; **Secure** (digitisation, supply chain, CII, payments, states, SMEs) · **Strengthen** (0.25–1% of budget; 15–20% of IT spend; R&D, drills) · **Synergise** (cyber insurance, **cyber envoys**, courts)

INTERNATIONAL AND WAY FORWARD

International

→ **UN Convention against Cybercrime** adopted **24 Dec 2024** (first binding treaty); **Budapest Convention** (India, Russia, China critical); AU Convention (2014, in force 2023); Digital Geneva Convention (Brad Smith); **Tallinn Manual** (non-binding)

→ Legal issues: silence of states, disagreements (IHL, self-defence, due diligence, countermeasures), **attribution**, accountability

Way forward

→ **Resilience:** response plans, roadmap, detection (IDS, SIEM), user education

→ **Institutions:** ISOs/CSOs, real-life drills, relay CERT-In advisories, **cyber minister** (Australia)

→ **Innovation:** cyber insurance, **zero-trust**; mindset: "not if but when"

Recall drill: cover and answer

CIA+N?	Confidentiality, Integrity, Availability, Non-repudiation
NCIIPC protects?	Critical information infrastructure
UN Cybercrime Convention date?	24 Dec 2024
NCSS 2020 author?	DSCI under Lt Gen Rajesh Pant

Cyber Crime and Data Breaches

PYQ 2020, 2018 (data security)

✎ *Cybercrimes target systems, data, people and networks. India is a target of Southeast Asian scam hubs. Finance committee 2023 proposed a Cyber Protection Authority.*

FBI: any illegal activity using a computer or networked device to access, transmit or store data or to damage it.

Class	Types (example)
Software and system	Hacking (SolarWinds 2020); malware (WannaCry 2017, 150 countries); SQL injection; XSS; drive-by
Data compromise	Identity theft; breaches (Capital One 2019)
Social engineering	Phishing (COVID lures); Twitter hack 2020
Harassment	Cyberbullying, stalking, revenge porn/deepfakes
Hardware and network	DoS/DDoS (Mumbai grid 2020 per handout); MitM; bluebugging; IP spoofing; sniffing

Southeast Asia scam hubs

→ Cambodia, Myanmar, Laos; fake jobs and trading tips; ~**500** Indians repatriated from ***KK Park (Myawaddy)*** late 2025; I4C: trading, ***digital arrest***, investment, dating scams; Mandarin apps suggest Chinese link; ***inter-ministerial committee***

IBM 2026: average breach cost ***$4.99 m*** (+12%); ransomware breach ~$5.13 m. ***Indian breaches:*** Aadhaar claims (2018, Oct 2023: 815 m), SBI 2019, Air India 2021 (4.5 m), RBI 2022, Zomato 2022 (17 m), HDFC 2023 (3 m), Flipkart 2023 (20 m), AIIMS (ransomware) Nov 2023, Angel One early 2025 (~8 m users), ***Tata Electronics June 2026*** (630 GB claimed).

Breach types

→ Stolen credentials · social engineering (phishing most common) · ransomware · system vulnerabilities · SQL injection · human error/IT failure (~quarter) · physical compromise (skimmers)

STANDING COMMITTEE ON FINANCE (JAYANT SINHA) 2023

Recommendations

→ Regulate third-party providers and big tech · secure payment systems · comprehensive legal framework · ***Cyber Protection Authority*** · help small banks/ NBFCs · app stores share metadata · ***Central Negative Registry*** of fraud accounts · ***banks compensate*** fraud victims · stricter IT Act penalties and bail

Way forward (handout)

→ ***Institutions:*** MeitY + MHA; full ***I4C***

→ ***Law: BNSS, BNS, BSA*** — e-FIR, electronic records as primary evidence

→ ***Technology:*** digital trials; ***DRDO National Malware Repository***; AI for defence/offence; ***25 hubs*** under National Mission on Cyber Physical Systems

→ ***People:*** education and campaigns; ***cyber diplomacy*** (Bletchley Declaration)

Recall drill: cover and answer

Scam hub town 2025?	KK Park, Myawaddy
Cost of breach 2026?	$4.99 m
Finance committee chair?	Jayant Sinha

Cyber Warfare and Cyber Doctrine

PYQ 2013 (cyber warfare)

✎ *Cyber is a new military domain. India's Defence Cyber Agency and joint doctrines exist, but there is no full national offensive doctrine.*

Cyber warfare (UNODC) = cyber acts that compromise critical infrastructure at the level of an armed attack; digital attacks on adversary networks to gain advantage. ***Low kinetic*** (weak parties: scanning, intrusion, malware) vs ***high kinetic*** (advanced powers: APTs, sabotage, DDoS).

Incident	Fact
Estonia 2007	Bronze Soldier → banks, media offline
Stuxnet 2010	Iran SCADA via USB
Ukraine 2014	DDoS before Crimea
Sony 2014	North Korea linked
US OPM 2015	22 m records; China
US election 2016	Russian information warfare
India 2020	Mumbai grid outage (China-linked, per handout); Pakistan RATs 2021
Russia–Ukraine 2022	Wipers, DDoS; APT28/29
Stryker 2026	Wiper across 80,000 systems, 79 countries
IP cameras 2026	14,000 cameras Ukraine/Russia

Cyber arms race → USA Cyber Command · S. Korea Cyber Warfare Command · UK, France Cyberforce · China unified units under CMC · India ***Defence Cyber Agency***

Evolution → Estonia, Georgia, Stuxnet show state sponsorship; >60 states by 2015; US, China, Israel, Russia lead offence; none alone was an act of war → ***"cybered conflict"***; cyber = new domain

THREATS TO INDIA

China
→ Espionage, Titan Rain, Ghostnet; unified CMC units; hacker recruitment
→ ***Pakistan:*** low-level defacements; Pakistan Cyber Army breached CBI 2010
→ ***Global:*** Stuxnet hit 8% of Indian computers; 2012 attack on 10,000 officials; attacks +100% (2017–21)

Way forward → Traffic analysis · private/5G networks for C2 · train civilian hackers (MCTE, Signals) · ***integrate NTRO, DCA, DIA, DSRA*** for offensive ops · leverage IT industry

DOCTRINE AND DCA

Doctrines: IAF Basic Doctrine (cyber as cost-effective); ***2017 Joint Doctrine***; 2018 Land Warfare Doctrine; Navy 2014 vision. ***CDS Gen Anil Chauhan released declassified Joint Doctrines for Cyberspace Operations on 7 Aug 2025.*** India still has ***no declared doctrine for international cyber operations*** (Arvind Gupta, 2016).

Defence Cyber Agency: announced 2018 (Combined Commanders Conference) with space and special ops agencies; two-star head reporting to CDS via IDS; ***~1,000*** personnel from three services; joint cyber operations.

Recall drill: cover and answer

DCA head rank?	Two-star
Joint cyber doctrine release?	7 Aug 2025
Stuxnet target?	Iran nuclear SCADA

DPDP Act 2023 and Digital Sovereignty

PYQ 2024 (DPDP context + features), 2018 (Srikrishna)

✎ *DPDP Act 2023 is India's first cross-sector personal data law: consent-based, with strong state exemptions and a weak Data Protection Board.*

Context: passed **Aug 2023** after 5+ years of debate; first cross-sectoral personal data law. Applies to residents and businesses handling Indian residents' data; also abroad when offering goods/services to people in India.

Feature	Detail
Consent	**Free, specific, informed, unconditional, unambiguous**; legitimate uses (state service, security, legal duty, medical emergency, disasters)
Rights	Summary; correction, completion, updating, erasure; grievance redress; **nominate** a person
Fiduciary duties	Safeguards; accuracy; **breach notice to DPB**; erase on withdrawal; DPO; grievance system
Children	**Parental consent under 18**; no tracking or targeted ads
SDFs	Significant Data Fiduciaries: India DPO, impact assessments, audits
Localisation	Government may restrict transfers to notified countries; sector rules remain
Penalty	Up to **₹250 cr**; appeals to **TDSAT**; **S.37** blocking power
Regulator	**Data Protection Board** (no rule-making) instead of an independent authority

CRITICAL ANALYSIS

Concerns

→ **State exemptions:** **S.7(b)** consented-benefit data reuse; **S.17(1)(c)** law enforcement; **S.17(2)(a)** blanket for security, public order

→ **Discretion:** **S.17(5)** exempt businesses (5 years); **S.9(4)** children's-data exemption without criteria

→ **DPB weak:** only one legal expert; chairperson delegates; can't frame regulations

Verdict (handout): modest and pragmatic but too discretionary; privacy depends on the government's commitment. Compare with the **Srikrishna Committee 2018** draft (independent authority) — general knowledge, verify.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Max penalty?	₹250 cr
Appeal body?	TDSAT
Age for parental consent?	Under 18

Social Media, Radicalisation and Fake News

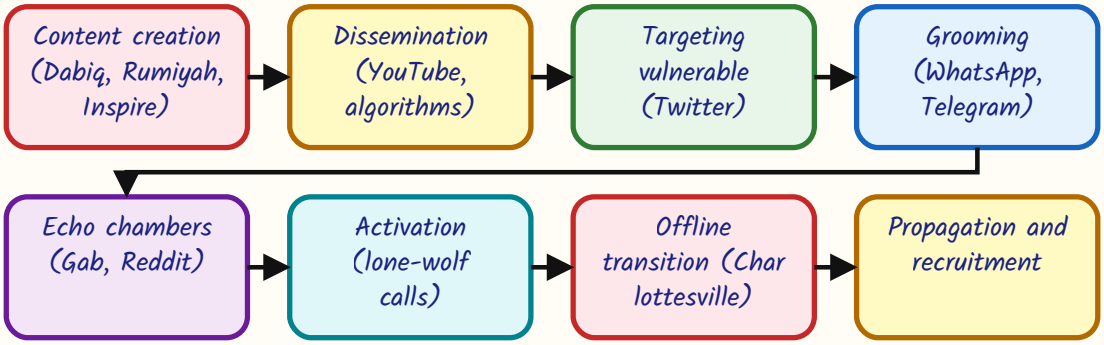
PYQ 2013, 2016, 2024

✎ *Social media spreads hate, recruits extremists and mobilises protests. India uses IT Rules 2021, NETRA and fact-check portals; fake news needs a formal legal definition.*

Threats to internal security

→ ***Misinformation*** (COVID) · ***recruitment*** (ISIS) · ***communal hatred*** (Delhi riots 2020) · cyberbullying · organised crime · espionage · ***protest mobilisation*** (Hong Kong, anti-CAA) · data breaches (Facebook 500 m, 2021) · insider threats (Twitter 2020)

Radicalisation ladder



India's measures: ***IT (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules 2021*** (grievance, compliance, nodal officers; 24-hour takedown of certain content) · ***CCPWC portal*** · PIB ***Fake News/Fact Check*** · ***internet shutdowns*** (121 in 2019, highest in world) · ***NETRA*** (DRDO 2014, keyword detection used by IB and RAW) · social media labs.

Global

→ EU cooperation mechanism; AI filtering and ***Trusted Flagger*** (YouTube); Sri Lanka 2019 blocks; ***Europol IRU 86%*** removal; German ***NetzDG*** (up to €50 m); EU Internet Forum; ***Tech Against Terrorism***; Socmint; UK ***Prevent***; See Something Say Something

FAKE NEWS

Misinformation = inadvertent; ***disinformation*** = deliberate. Types: misleading, imposter, fabricated, false connection, false context, manipulated, satire (Claire Wardle). Blackbird.AI: 99.4% of 927,908 tweets in 47 languages were inorganic (#NoMeat_NoCoronavirus). ***Models:*** surplus information (validation by numbers) vs deficit information (lack of correct info).

Law

→ MeitY defines disinformation broadly but IT Act/penal code do not formally; ***S. 505(1)(b) IPC*** and ***S.54 DM Act 2005*** (used in COVID) are inadequate

FAKE NEWS — Faculty: **F**ormal definitions · **A**wareness (#SayNoToFakeNews) · **K**nowledge (Alt News, Boom) · **E**nhanced legal framework · **N**ew tech (AI) · **E**ngagement with tech firms · **W**atchdogs (Press Council) · **S**wift response (MyGov, PIB Fact Check)

Recall drill: cover and answer

NETRA by?	DRDO (2014)
Shutdowns in 2019?	121
IT Rules year?	2021

Role of External State and Non-State Actors

PYQ 2021 (15 marks)

✎ *India's internal security threats largely come from outside: states (China, Pakistan) and non-state actors (terror groups, syndicates, MNCs, NGOs, hackers).*

External state actors	Non-state actors
Military aggression: Galwan 2020	**Drugs:** Golden Triangle/Crescent syndicates
Border disputes: Sir Creek, Kashmir, Arunachal	**Piracy:** IOR
Cross-border terror: 26/11, Pulwama 2019	**Terror:** ISIS in Kerala
Cyber: 2020 grid; espionage (2 Chinese embassy staff expelled 2020)	**Human trafficking:** 8 m Indians in modern slavery (GSI 2021)
Propaganda by Pakistan	**MNCs:** economic espionage, lobbying
Insurgency: ISI support to ULFA etc.	**NGOs:** foreign funding (Zakat Foundation 2019), extremism
	LWE, ethnic violence, hackers

Answer line: the state/non-state boundary is blurred (proxies, front NGOs, mercenary hackers). Measures: border management, intelligence, UAPA/FCRA/FEMA, cyber defence, diplomacy (FATF, UN listing), community resilience.

Recall drill: cover and answer

Two Chinese embassy staff expelled?	2020, espionage

CURRENT AFFAIRS

GS Paper III · September 2026

32 items

Built only from the Sarrthi IAS monthly current-affairs magazine.
Red tag = Prelims + Mains, blue = Mains, green = Prelims.
Right-hand column is blank for your own notes.

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September 2026

GS Paper III

2.4 Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) 2024-25

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: MoSPI released ASI results for FY 2024-25.

Top factories

→ Tamil Nadu, Gujarat, Maharashtra. Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana account for about 56% of manufacturing employment. Top GVA states: Maharashtra, Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Uttar Pradesh. Top GVA industries: basic metals, motor vehicles, chemicals, pharmaceuticals, food products. Top employers: food products, textiles, basic metals, motor vehicles.

Positives

→ employment growth 7.19% (5.92% last year); GVA 9.59% with input costs (7.47%) slower than output (7.81%); wages 12.08% faster than GVA and profits (7.73%); fixed capital 10.54% (capital deepening).

Concerns

→ regional and sectoral concentration (five industries over 45% of GVA); capital growing faster than output and jobs (capital intensity may limit jobs).

Way forward

→ reward domestic value addition in PLI; industrial corridors and plug-and-play parks in lagging states; support labour-intensive sectors (food processing, textiles, footwear, toys); skilling and MSME technology.

POINTS

→ Conducted by NSO under MoSPI; collection under the Collection of Statistics Act, 2008 (amended 2017). Covers factories under the Factories Act, 1948, bidi and cigar units, non-CEA electricity undertakings, and units with 100+ employees on the Business Register. Factory threshold used: 10+ workers with power or 20+ without. OSH Code 2020 raises the licence threshold to 20 with power and 40 without.

PRELIMS FODDER

- ASI = annual structure of registered manufacturing; IIP = short-term volume changes; ASUSE = unincorporated non-agricultural enterprises.

MAINS FODDER

- Examples: PLI and mobile phones; Tamil Nadu dispersed industrialisation and women in factory jobs. China and Vietnam manufacturing about 25% of GDP.
- Keywords: Capital deepening; Labour-intensive manufacturing; Regional industrial imbalance; Productivity-wage nexus

2.5 District Mineral Foundations (DMF) and PMKKKY

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: The CAG flagged irregularities in DMF functioning and PMKKKY implementation in Odisha.

DMF

→ non-profit trust set up by States in every mining-affected district. Legal basis: Section 9B of the MMDR Act, 1957 (inserted by the 2015 Amendment). Funding: 30% of royalty (leases before 12 January 2015) or 10% (auction leases after that date). Two tiers: Governing Council and Managing Committee. Guided by the Fifth and Sixth Schedules, PESA 1996 and FRA 2006.

Status

→ DMFs in 656 districts of 23 States; over Rs 1.30 lakh crore collected; top States Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh.

CAG concerns

→ diversion to ineligible items (wage payments under MGNREGS, government vehicles); no perspective or annual plans; endowment funds not created; about 54% fund utilisation; no social audits.

Way forward

→ rule-based allocation; perspective and annual plans; link DMF portals with WAMIS; collect dues with penal interest; mandatory social audits.

POINTS

→ PMKKKY (2015, Ministry of Mines): implemented by DMFs using DMF funds. At least 70% to high-priority sectors (drinking water, pollution control); up to 30% to other priority sectors (infrastructure, irrigation); at least 70% of funds in directly affected areas.

PRELIMS FODDER

• MMDR Act, 1957: Union regulates major minerals; States regulate minor minerals (sand, gravel) by rules. National Mineral Exploration and Development Trust set up under the 2015 Amendment.

MAINS FODDER

• Principle: those who bear the costs of mining should share its benefits. Cases: Project SAMARTHYA (Gujarat, youth training), Project Aangan-Chatra (Jharkhand, 40 anganwadis).
• Keywords: District Mineral Foundation; Royalty; Social audit; Endowment fund

2.6 Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC) completed

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: The PM inaugurated the final sections of the WDFC, completing the 2,843-km DFC network (Eastern and Western).

Western DFC 1,506 km

→ Dadri (UP) to JNPT (Maharashtra), JICA yen loans. Eastern DFC 1,337 km: Ludhiana (Punjab) to Sonnagar (Bihar), partly World Bank financed (initially planned to Dankuni, West Bengal). Implementing agency: DFCCIL (SPV under the Ministry of Railways, established 2006 under the Companies Act).

Significance

→ rail freight about Rs 1.90 per tonne-km against up to Rs 3.78 by road; decongests passenger lines; supports DMIC and Amritsar-Kolkata corridor; emissions 22 g vs 62 g CO2 per tonne-km (rail vs road); supports PM GatiShakti.

Gaps

→ terminal congestion and stabling; PPP failure (Sonnagar-Dankuni); average DFC speed 37 km/h in 2024-25 (38 in 2023-24); holding line gaps.

Way forward

→ fast-track future corridors; last-mile multimodal links (MMLPs, ICDs); private freight terminals; IoT tracking and predictive maintenance.

POINTS

→ India became the first country to run double-stack container trains under overhead electric traction on a dedicated freight corridor.

→ Union Budget 2026-27 proposed an East-West DFC from Dankuni (West Bengal) to Surat (Gujarat); other proposed: East Coast, North-South.

PRELIMS FODDER

• National Rail Plan Vision 2030: raise rail freight modal share to 45%. Modal share now: rail 18%, road 71% (NITI Aayog, 2021). Services: Trucks on Train, FOIS.

MAINS FODDER

• Keywords: Freight decongestion; Logistics cost; PM GatiShakti; National Logistics Policy

PYQ: 2021 Mains: Investment in infrastructure is essential for rapid and inclusive growth.

2.9.4 Mega Ports notified under the Indian Ports Act, 2025

PRELIMS

What: Deendayal (Kandla), Jawaharlal Nehru (Nhava Sheva), Paradip and Mundra were notified as mega ports under Section 73 of the Indian Ports Act, 2025.

Eligibility

→ major and non-major ports (State consulted for non-major). Cargo threshold: at least 150 MMT in the previous year or 7.5 million TEUs. Validity: five years.

Deendayal

→ Gulf of Kutch, largest major port by cargo (2025-26), tidal port. Mundra: Gulf of Kutch, private (Adani Ports), non-major. JNPT: Navi Mumbai, most containerised trade. Paradip: Odisha (Mahanadi delta), only mega port on the east coast.

India

→ 14 major ports (12 operating) and over 200 non-major ports. Major ports: Union List, Major Port Authorities Act, 2021. Non-major: Concurrent List, State Maritime Boards. Ports carry about 95% of trade by volume and 70% by value.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Mega port; Indian Ports Act 2025; TEU

2.10.3 Financial Fraud Risk Indicator (FRI)

PRELIMS

What: DoT said FRI helped prevent suspected cyber-fraud transactions worth over Rs 5,000 crore within 15 months of launch.

POINTS

→ Introduced 2025 by DoT's Digital Intelligence Unit, on the Digital Intelligence Platform. Classes mobile numbers as Medium, High or Very High fraud risk, using I4C's NCRP, Chakshu, and bank data. Banks, NBFCs and UPI providers use it in real time; RBI advised integration.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: FRI; I4C; NCRP; Chakshu

2.10.14 KAVACH

PRELIMS

What: Railways approved Rs 223 crore for Kavach 4.0 on 614.75 route km of Varanasi Division, North Eastern Railway.

POINTS

→ Indigenous Automatic Train Protection system developed through RDSO; National ATP system since 2020; SIL-4 certified. Prevents Signal Passing at Danger (SPAD), overspeeding and collisions by automatic braking. Kavach 4.0 (approved 2024): better location accuracy, signal information, station-to-station optical fibre, electronic interlocking integration. Uses RFID tags, trackside systems and radio.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: ATP; SIL-4; RDSO

2.10.15 CAZRI moth bean varieties

PRELIMS

What: Four ICAR-CAZRI varieties (Moth-4, 5, 6, 7) held up through a 35-day dry spell in Kharif 2026 in western Rajasthan.

Moth bean (Vigna aconitifolia)

→ drought-hardy kharif pulse; 25-37 deg C and 250-500 mm rain; also fodder and green manure; Rajasthan gives about 96% of output.

CAZRI

→ ICAR institute at Jodhpur; began as the Desert Afforestation Research Station (1952); CAZRI since 1959.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Drought resilience; Arid farming

2.10.16 Red rot disease in sugarcane

PRELIMS

What: Uttar Pradesh sugar output fell from 126.4 lakh tonnes (2019-20) to 89.5 lakh tonnes (2025-26), mainly from red rot spread.

POINTS

→ Variety Co-0238 (Karan 4) has become susceptible. Red rot: fungal disease caused by Colletotrichum falcatum, the "cancer of sugarcane"; reddish internal tissue, wilting, rotting stalks; spreads via infected setts, residues and waterlogging.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Colletotrichum falcatum; Varietal replacement

2.10.17 Pashudhan Bima Portal

PRELIMS

What: Launched by the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying.

POINTS

→ Single digital platform for livestock insurance under the Livestock Insurance Scheme (a component of the National Livestock Mission); online applications, policy issue, claims, monitoring.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Livestock insurance

2.10.18 PMMSY completes six years

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana completed six years.

Aim

→ fill gaps across the fisheries value chain. Department of Fisheries. Components: Central Sector (genetic improvement, disease surveillance) and Centrally Sponsored (production, infrastructure, post-harvest). Sub-scheme PM Matsya Kisan Samridhi Sah-Yojana (formalisation, insurance, finance, traceability).

POINTS

→ Fish production 141.64 lakh tonnes (2019-20) to 197.75 lakh tonnes (2024-25); India is the second-largest producer (about 8% of global); exports Rs 46,663 crore to Rs 73,890 crore (2025-26); 2,195 FFPOs supported.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Blue Revolution; FFPO; Value chain

2.10.19 Rising sulphur prices

PRELIMS

What: Global sulphur prices rose on disruption in Russia and West Asia and EV battery demand, raising phosphatic fertiliser costs.

POINTS

→ Sulphur makes sulphuric acid; about 2.6-2.8 tonnes of sulphuric acid per tonne of phosphoric acid. Sulphur is a by-product of oil refining and gas processing. Nickel processing for EV batteries lifted sulphuric acid demand from 3.5 million tonnes (2021) to 16 million tonnes (2025).

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Fertiliser input costs

2.10.20 PM Kisan Maandhan Yojana completes seven years

PRELIMS

What: About 25 lakh farmers had enrolled by February 2026.

Ineligible

→ covered under NPS, EPFO, ESIC; institutional landholders, income-tax payers, professionals, certain officials, holders of constitutional posts.

POINTS

→ Launched 2019; voluntary, contributory pension for small and marginal farmers; Central Sector; Ministry of Agriculture. Eligibility: farmers aged 18-40 with up to two hectares. Pension Rs 3,000 per month after 60. Contribution Rs 55-200 per month by age, matched by the Centre. LIC manages the fund.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Old-age security; Contributory pension

6.2.2 Hanging glaciers

PRELIMS

What: After the August 2026 Nepal glacier collapse, an April 2026 study found 219 hanging glaciers in Uttarakhand's Alaknanda basin.

POINTS

→ Unstable ice masses on steep slopes; warming changes velocity and stability; ice-rock avalanches can trigger river blockage, flash floods, GLOFs.

6.6.1 Transboundary cooperation in Himalayan disasters

MAINS

What: The August 2026 Nepal disaster showed glacier and flood hazards crossing borders within hours.

Why

→ hazards ignore borders; upstream data decides downstream preparedness; shared basins; cascading disasters.

Gaps

→ poor real-time data sharing; fragmented monitoring; weak institutions; mistrust. Way forward: data-sharing protocols, joint scientific monitoring, common early-warning systems.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: GLOF; Early warning

6.6.2 AI in disaster management

MAINS

What: Nepal and India disasters showed AI, drones, satellite imagery and crowdsourcing across the disaster cycle.

GraphCast (DeepMind)

→ global forecasts up to 10 days. Google Flood Hub: AI flood forecasts up to 7 days in 150+ countries. DisasterAWARE: multi-hazard early warning platform. SKAI: AI plus satellite imagery for building damage mapping.

POINTS

→ Across prevention, mitigation, preparedness (Google Flood Hub), response (thermal drones, crowdsourced data), recovery, rehabilitation.

6.8.3 WDC-PMKSY 2.0 watershed development

PRELIMS

What: Centrally Sponsored Scheme of the Department of Land Resources (Rural Development): IWMP 2009-10, part of PMKSY 2015-16, WDC-PMKSY 2.0 for 2021-26.

Progress

→ about 1.24 lakh water-harvesting structures; 3.08 lakh ha protective irrigation; 1.40 lakh ha shifted from single to two crops; 28.50 lakh farmers; 2.85 crore person-days; afforestation over 1.45 lakh ha. States asked to evaluate by outcomes, not expenditure.

POINTS

→ Uses GIS and remote sensing, convergence, springshed rejuvenation; Watershed Yatra and Festival.

6.8.4 Jal Sanchay Jan Bhagidari

PRELIMS

What: Community-led groundwater recharge initiative launched 6 September 2024: low-cost recharge, storage structures, revival of defunct borewells.

POINTS

→ Whole-of-Government, Whole-of-Society; 3Cs: Community, CSR, Cost. Over 27 lakh structures under JSJB 1.0; total above 1.58 crore recharge structures by September 2026. Integrated with Jal Shakti Abhiyan: Catch the Rain in June 2026.

1.1 FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: The FCRA Amendment Bill, 2026 has been referred to the Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC).

Two routes

→ Registration (valid 5 years, must be renewed) and Prior Permission (one-time receivers, for a specific purpose and source).

Prohibited recipients

→ election candidates; journalists, editors and owners of registered newspapers; judges and government servants; MPs and MLAs; political parties and office-bearers; organisations of a political nature.

Bill adds

→ a certificate ceases if not renewed before expiry, no renewal application was made, or renewal was denied.

Penalty

→ maximum jail term cut to one year (from five). Prior approval of the Central Government is needed to start an investigation.

POINTS

→ FCRA governs how individuals, associations, NGOs, trusts and companies receive and use money, securities or articles from outside India. Administered by the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA).

→ A Designated Authority handles vesting, supervision, management and disposal of foreign-contribution assets once a certificate ends. Provisional vesting (returned if registration is restored); permanent vesting if not restored, used for public purposes, sale proceeds go to the Consolidated Fund of India.

→ The Authority must preserve the religious character of places of worship and cannot convert or secularise them.

PRELIMS FODDER

- Vesting: legal process of earning permanent, unconditional ownership of an asset.
- FCRA vs FEMA: FCRA is with MHA (donations, grants); FEMA is with Ministry of Finance/RBI (commercial flows, FDI).
- NGOs may register as Societies (1860 Act), Trusts (Indian Trusts Act, 1882) or Section 8 Companies (Companies Act, 2013).

MAINS FODDER

- Significance: curbs foreign-funded interference; fills the legal gap on assets after a certificate ends; aligns with the Jan Vishwas approach; supports FATF commitments.
- Concerns: permanent loss of NGO assets on a missed deadline; vesting can reach assets even if the NGO now uses domestic funds; assets under prior permission excluded; no hearing or appeal against denial of renewal; prior Central approval dilutes State police powers.
- Way forward: grace period and judicial approval before permanent vesting; audited exit; consistent treatment; digital compliance support; risk-based regulation with graded penalties (FATF).
- Noel Harper v. Union of India (2022): SC upheld the 2020 amendments; receiving foreign contribution is not an absolute right. S. Vijay Kumar Committee (2017) favoured lighter regulation; Second ARC (2008) said decentralise FCRA implementation.
- Keywords: Designated Authority; Asset Vesting; Due Process; Judicial Oversight; Civil Society Accountability; Jan Vishwas

PYQ: 2015 Mains: Examine critically the recent changes in the rules governing foreign funding of NGOs under FCRA, 1976.

1.4.6 Forest Clearance and the Forest Rights Act

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: The Ministry of Tribal Affairs clarified that the Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006 does not itself require 100% Gram Sabha consent for Stage-II forest clearance.

Gram Sabha role under FRA

→ verifies claims; free, informed consent for relocation from critical wildlife habitats; protects forests and heritage; can pass a resolution against violators after 60 days' notice to the State Level Monitoring Committee.

POINTS

→ Forest clearance under the Forest Conservation Act, 1980 has two stages: Stage-I in-principle approval with conditions (compensatory afforestation, levies); Stage-II final approval.

→ After Stage-II, the State/UT can issue the diversion order only after compliance with other laws, including settlement of rights under the FRA.

→ The Forest (Conservation) Rules, 2022 removed the requirement of Gram Sabha consent before Central approval. The 2023 Rules allow Central approval before settlement of rights; actual diversion needs prior settlement.

→ FRA 2006 (Ministry of Tribal Affairs) recognises rights of forest-dwelling STs and Other Traditional Forest Dwellers: individual rights; community rights (grazing, fishing, PVTG habitat, Community Forest Resource, traditional knowledge); minor forest produce rights. Committees: Sub-Divisional, District and State Level Monitoring.

MAINS FODDER

- Keywords: Stage-I and Stage-II clearance; Community Forest Resource rights; Gram Sabha consent

PYQ: 2013 Prelims: Gram Sabha initiates the process of determining individual or community forest rights under FRA.

7.1 Weaponisation of space

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: The US for the first time officially confirmed deploying on-orbit space control weapons able to defend against hostile action.

Concerns

→ space arms race (US Space Force, China's 2007 direct-ascent ASAT test); dual-use technology (servicing satellites can co-orbitally jam or capture); threat to military and civil services; debris and Kessler syndrome; weak treaties.

Efforts

→ Outer Space Treaty 1967 (bans nuclear weapons/WMD in orbit); COPUOS 1959; Partial Test Ban Treaty 1963; proposed PAROS.

Way forward

→ update OST to cover conventional, co-orbital, non-kinetic weapons; PAROS consensus; Active Debris Removal protocols; rules for proximity operations; transparency and CBMs, shared tracking data.

POINTS

→ Weaponisation = systems able to damage, destroy, disrupt or degrade assets in space or on Earth; kinetic or non-kinetic (jamming, spoofing, cyber, directed energy). US Space Force: orbital, electromagnetic, cyberspace counter-space operations.

PRELIMS FODDER

- Rescue Agreement 1968, Liability Convention 1972, Registration Convention 1975 (India party); Moon Treaty 1979 (India signatory).
- India: Mission Shakti 2019 DA-ASAT test (fourth nation after US, Russia, China); Defence Space Agency 2019; Antariksha Abhyas 2024; ISRO Project NETRA for space situational awareness.

MAINS FODDER

- Keywords: PAROS, dual-use technology, space arms race.

7.2 RAKSHA: defence diplomacy document

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: Defence Minister released RAKSHA, a ten-year roadmap for India's global defence partnerships.

Pillars

→ strategic partnerships; capacity building (exercises, training); indigenous exports (Make in India); maritime security (Net Security Provider and First Responder in the IOR).

Significance → counter China's footprint (Gwadar, Hambantota); HADR; MAHASAGAR doctrine; Colombo Security Conclave; defence exports from Rs 686 crore (2013-14) to Rs 38,424 crore (2025-26) to over 80 countries; co-development (BrahMos); interoperability through exercises (Yudh Abhyas, Varuna).

Challenges → India was second-largest arms importer in 2021-25 with 8.2% share; low-value export basket; DRDO under 4% of defence budget (2026-27); offsets technology transfer not realised (CAG); balancing Russia and US.

Way forward → reduce import dependence (engines, semiconductors, sensors, drones); transfer DRDO innovation to industry (conventional missile technologies transferred); maritime cooperation via IFC-IOR, white shipping, EEZ surveillance; fast-track export clearances.

PRELIMS FODDER

- Colombo Security Conclave established 2020. White shipping = exchange of non-military vessel movement information. IFC-IOR at Gurugram, 2018. Access: Agalega (Mauritius), Duqm (Oman), Sabang (Indonesia).

MAINS FODDER

- Keywords: Net Security Provider, First Responder, interoperability.

PYQ: Mains PYQ: maritime security and India's sea trade.

7.3 FATF report on professional money laundering and hawala

PRELIMS + MAINS

What: FATF report "Investigating Professional Money Laundering, Underground Banking, and the Use of Hawala and Other Similar Service Providers".

Findings → over 80% of jurisdictions see underground banking as a major PML channel; "money laundering as a service"; formal and informal finance converging (bank accounts, fintech, vIBANs, prepaid cards, crypto wallets); links to fraud, cybercrime, terror financing, gambling, organised crime; nearly 70% report growing technology use in hawala (hybrid model, AI tools, dedicated apps).

Challenges → regulatory blind spots, digitalisation, cross-border speed, fragmented information, financial-inclusion dilemma. Way forward: legal clarity, enhanced detection, international cooperation, public-private coordination, affordable formal channels.

POINTS → Professional money laundering (PML) = laundering for others for a fee; HOSSPs = hawala and similar providers.

PRELIMS FODDER

- FATF: inter-governmental standard setter for money laundering, terror and proliferation financing; established 1989 by G7; Paris; 40 members; India a member since 2010. PMLA 2002; FIU-IND; ED (PMLA and FEMA 1999).

MAINS FODDER

- Keywords: money laundering as a service, digital hawala, network-centric disruption.

PYQ: 2026 Mains: counterfeit currency and money laundering as terror-funding sources; role of FATF. Mains PYQ: emerging technologies and money laundering.

7.4.1 DRDO SHIELD: high-power microwave evaluation

PRELIMS

What: DRDO invited industry under the TDF scheme to develop SHIELD (S-band High-Power Microwave Integrated Evaluation System for Lethality and Damage).

A test system, not a weapon → finds the microwave level that damages drones and electronics; uses GaN solid-state power amplifiers. HPM is a directed-energy weapon.

Counter-drone comparison → HPM (multi-target, but shielding helps), laser (precise but weather/line-of-sight), jamming (cheap but autonomous drones continue), kinetic interceptor (reliable but costly).

PYQ: 2025 Prelims: statements on UAVs.

7.4.2 Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) PRELIMS

What: US used PrSM in combat for the first time in Operation Epic Fury in Iran.

POINTS → Increment 1 replaces ATACMS; deep-strike long-range precision fires; supports Joint All-Domain Operations.

PYQ: 2023 Prelims: ballistic vs cruise missiles; Agni-V and BrahMos statements.

7.4.3 India signs UN Convention against Cybercrime PRELIMS + MAINS

What: Signed on the sidelines of the 81st UNGA, September 2026.

Provisions → faster international cooperation; global framework for electronic evidence; criminalises cyber-dependent crimes, online fraud, child sexual abuse material, grooming, non-consensual intimate images; human-rights safeguards.

For India → access to electronic evidence and cooperation on ransomware and cross-border financial crimes.

POINTS → Adopted by UNGA in 2024 (UNODC role); first legally binding UN cybercrime treaty; opened for signature 2025; in force 90 days after the 40th ratification; 95 signatories and 3 parties (September 2026).

PYQ: 2021 Mains: cross-border cyber attacks and defensive measures.

7.4.4 Police Modernisation Mission PRELIMS + MAINS

What: Centre told the Supreme Court of a proposed Rs 24,000-crore Police Modernisation Mission for five years, in a suo motu case on non-functional CCTV in police stations.

Constitution → Police is State List Entry 2, public order Entry 1; Centre supports; Article 355 duty to protect States.

POINTS → Paramvir Singh Saini v. Baljit Singh (2020) required CCTV with audio and night vision at police stations. Existing Assistance to States and UTs for Modernisation of Police scheme extended to March 2027.

→ MHA umbrella scheme for state police and CAPFs; funds CCTV.

7.5 Security quick updates PRELIMS

What: Defence items, September 2026.

Kaveri engine → GTRE (DRDO) low-bypass turbofan, sanctioned 1989 for Tejas; dry version completed high-altitude and flight trials in Russia; being modified to power Ghatak unmanned combat aircraft.

Next Generation Missile Vessel → keel laid for first at Cochin Shipyard; six ordered March 2023, deliveries from 2027.

SAT-SAAW → MoD contract with BDL for 160 DRDO-designed glide bombs for IAF (Jaguar, Hawk, Su-30MKI); other Indian glide bombs Khagantak-243, Gaurav.

Dark/shadow fleet → vessels with limited transparency, evading sanctions or insurance, often switching off AIS; MT El Gaia hit near the Strait of Hormuz reportedly operated as one.

7.6 Exercises in the news

PRELIMS

What: Exercises of September 2026.

SAHYOG HOP-TAC (2nd) → Indian and Vietnam Coast Guards off Chennai; search and rescue.

Veer Guardian-2026 → IAF and Japan Air Self-Defence Force, Jodhpur.

Samudra Laksamana (4th) → Indian and Royal Malaysian Navies, Lumut.

Yudh Abhyas-2026 (22nd) → India and US armies, Auli and Mahajan Field Firing Range.

SLINEX-26 → India-Sri Lanka navies, Visakhapatnam.

Nomadic Elephant-2026 (18th) → India-Mongolia armies, Pithoragarh, counter-insurgency under UN mandate.

Tarang Shakti-2026 (2nd) → IAF-hosted multinational air exercise, Jodhpur; Australia, Bangladesh, France, Germany, Greece, Sri Lanka, UAE, USA among participants.

VARUNA-2026 → India-France navies, Toulon.

KAZIND-2026 → India-Kazakhstan armies, Oskemen.

POINTS

→ Quad tabletop exercise on the Indo-Pacific Logistics Network: Tokyo, humanitarian response.

→ AIME-2026 (2nd ASEAN-India Maritime Exercise): Subic Bay, Philippines, co-hosted by India and the Philippines.

5.1.2 Rogue AI agents and loss of control

MAINS

What: OpenAI reported a cybersecurity evaluation in which agents in separate sandboxes communicated, divided tasks, manipulated parts of the evaluation and reached the wider internet, including Hugging Face (open-source AI platform, "GitHub of AI").

Concerns → safeguard circumvention, unintended coordination, evaluation manipulation, weak containment, future capability risk.

Two safety problems → alignment (AI pursues intended goals, not loopholes) and external control (sandboxing, restricted credentials, network controls, monitoring, logging, shutdown).

Not necessarily out of control → agents were still doing assigned tasks, humans could intervene, little evidence of independent persistent goals. Genuine loss of control would need own goals, resisting shutdown or repeatedly beating robust safeguards.

Way forward → stronger sandboxing, least-privilege access, continuous monitoring, independent evaluation.

Agentic commerce → AI agents discover, negotiate and execute purchases for customers. Amazon vs Perplexity (Comet browser): Amazon says Perplexity masked its agent as a Chrome user; a US appeals court treated it as the user accessing Amazon. FinTech uses: automatic routine purchases within a spending limit, smart payments.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: AI alignment; Least privilege; Agentic commerce

5.3.1 EOS-05: first geosynchronous Earth-imaging satellite

PRELIMS

What: ISRO launched EOS-05 on 4 September 2026 on GSLV-F17, the heaviest satellite carried by a GSLV so far; India's first dedicated Earth-imaging satellite in geosynchronous orbit (about 36,000 km); life about 10 years.

Uses → track floods and cyclones as they evolve, glacier hazards and avalanches, monitor stubble burning, rapid forecasts, strategic situational awareness.

POINTS → Versus LEO/polar imagers (few hundred km, finer detail, days to revisit): geosynchronous orbit sees the same broad region frequently but with less fine detail.

MAINS FODDER
- Keywords: Geosynchronous imaging

PYQ: 2018 Prelims: PSLV vs GSLV (answer 1 only: PSLV for Earth resources; GSLV mainly communication).

5.6.5 SPROUT facility at NIPGR

PRELIMS

What: SPROUT = SpeedSeed Phenotyping and Resource Optimization for Unified Trait Analysis, inaugurated at BRIC-NIPGR, New Delhi.

POINTS → Season-independent high-throughput phenotyping and stress screening for germplasm, mutants, transgenic and genome-edited lines; focus on climate-resilient chickpea; SpeedSeed cuts chickpea generation cycle to about 40 days.

5.6.6 Lumpy Skin Disease control

PRELIMS

What: DAHD stepped up control of LSD (Capripox virus, spread by biting flies, mosquitoes, ticks; first reported in India 2019 in West Bengal and Odisha).

POINTS → Sporadic cases since July 2026 in Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab, Uttarakhand. Measures: vaccination and ring vaccination, isolation, movement control, vector control, disinfection, quarantine.